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IN BRIEF


Rajnath pays tribute to 1857 icon in Lucknow

Boy ‘assaulted’ at Jaffrabad day care; one held

NEET-PG held across country; power glitch at 2 centres; 2,445 candidates to take retest

LUCKNOW
Senior BJP leader and Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Sunday paid tribute to 1857 freedom fighter Rani Avanti Bai Lodhi at an event in Lucknow. » [Page 4](#)

NEW DELHI
An employee at a day care in Jaffrabad was arrested on Sunday based on a complaint alleging that a three-year-old boy was physically assaulted and sexually harassed at the facility. » [Page 2](#)

EDUCATION PLUS » [PAGE 2](#)

India, Uzbekistan upgrade ties, agree on uranium deal

Uzbekistan is at the heart of India's engagement in Central Asia, says PM as the two nations elevate relations to comprehensive strategic partnership and set a \$5 billion annual trade target by 2030

Press Trust of India
TASHKENT


Hand in hand: Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Uzbekistan President Shavkat Mirziyoyev in Tashkent on Sunday. ANI

India and Uzbekistan on Sunday decided to elevate their ties to a comprehensive strategic partnership and set a target of \$5 billion in annual trade by 2030 following talks between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Uzbek President Shavkat Mirziyoyev.

The two sides inked 11 agreements for boosting engagement in several key sectors, including mining and tourism, and agreed to establish a framework for long-term supply of uranium from Uzbekistan to India in line with cooperation in the civil nuclear energy sector.

The talks focused on expanding cooperation in areas of trade, investment,

infrastructure, critical minerals, mining, defence and security, agriculture, pharmaceuticals, health, information technology, ayurveda, digital public infrastructure, including UPI, and education.

“We are celebrating the 15th anniversary of our strategic partnership. I am

delighted that, on this special occasion, we are elevating our ties to the level of a comprehensive strategic partnership,” Mr. Modi said.

“We will move forward by setting concrete goals within this framework,” he said. Mr. Modi said both sides would also elevate

their existing joint commission from the level of secretaries to that of ministerial level.

Mr. Mirziyoyev said Uzbekistan was determined to boost ties with India in diverse sectors. “We are aiming to advance cooperation in sectors such as energy, culture, critical minerals, pharmaceuticals, jewellery, and agriculture,” the Uzbek President said. The current volume of bilateral trade between the two nations is over \$1 billion.

“Uzbekistan is at the heart of Central Asia and is at the heart of India’s engagement in the region,” Mr. Modi said.

CONTINUED ON

PM VISITS MEMORIAL

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Nepal floods: 788 dead, over 2,500 still missing; efforts under way to rescue those trapped in tunnels

Sanjeev Satgajanya
KATHMANDU


Nature's fury: A house lies partially submerged following the flash flood in Nuwakot district of Nepal. PRABHAT KHANAL

Four days after the flood in Nepal, the death toll in the disaster touched 788, and 2,502 people remained missing even as the preservation of recovered bodies became a challenge for the authorities who continued with the rescue efforts.

‘Need freezer units’

Foreign Secretary Amrit Bahadur Rai said Nepal urgently required freezer units and DNA-testing kits, warning that the bodies must be preserved and identified quickly to prevent decomposition and contain public-health risks.

Mr. Rai said the government is “putting all our resources at disposal in relief and rescue operations.”

“We have requested several countries,” he said.

“Some other immediate requirements, like airtight

bags for storing bodies, have started to arrive and other equipment are expected to arrive soon,” he added. More than 900 workers are missing from hydropower sites, and officials believe around 100 people trapped inside tunnels are alive.

Mr. Rai said experts from India, China, and South Korea have joined the Nepal Army’s efforts in rescuing these workers.

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‘WARNING TO INDIA’

PAGE 6

DATA POINT

PAGE 7

NEET-PG held across country; power glitch at 2 centres; 2,445 candidates to take retest

Bindu Shajan Perappadan
NEW DELHI

The National Board of Examinations (NBEMS) conducted the National Eligibility cum Entrance Test (NEET)-PG on Sunday.

The examination was scheduled for 2,73,096 candidates at 1,111 examination centres across 339 cities, covering all 36 States and Union Territories. A total of 2,65,980 candidates appeared for the examination and 2,527 faculty members were appointed as Independent Appraisers to oversee the conduct of the examination. In addition, more

A total of 2,65,980 candidates appeared for the examination on Sunday. ANI

than 700 senior faculty members, including Deans, Directors, Medical Superintendents and senior professors, were deployed in flying squads.

The exam was disrupted

at two centres in Jaipur following an internal power failure.

Panel to investigate

The NBEMS said a three-member committee had been constituted to investigate the incident.

In an official release, the Union Health Ministry stated that a “technical disruption occurred at ION Digital Zone iDZ Sitapura Centres, Jaipur, Rajasthan (TC Nos. 41682 and 41683), where the examination could not be completed for 2,445 candidates due to internal power supply issues at the test centres, attributable to TCS Ltd., the examination conducting agency”.

The re-examination for the affected candidates will be conducted on Saturday, September 5, at 3 p.m. in Jaipur.

The committee has been constituted to examine the circumstances leading to the power supply failure and ascertain the reasons for the disruption. It includes a senior official from the Government of Rajasthan, a Joint Secretary-level officer from the Ministry, and a senior engineering official from the Central Electricity Authority.

The committee will submit its report within the stipulated timeframe, the sources said.

In deep water

The Sangam area inundated with floodwaters from the swollen Ganga and Yamuna rivers in Prayagraj, Uttar Pradesh on Sunday. PTI

VITAL QUESTION

Should CJP be a political party?

Success of movement should be judged by active participation of youth

OPINION » PAGE 7

HONOURING A LEGEND

Federer inducted into tennis Hall of Fame

SPORT » PAGE 15

All workers shifted to VB-G RAM G; e-KYC not mandatory, says Rural Development Ministry

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Union Rural Development Ministry on Sunday said that every worker registered under the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA), irrespective of whether e-KYC of their job cards has been completed, has been migrated to Viksit Bharat Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) [VB-G RAM G].

In a statement, the Ministry also underlined that pending e-KYC does not prevent a worker from demanding or receiving employment.

The statement was issued in response to *The Hindu's* report on Saturday, which flagged that the

So far, e-KYC has been completed for 15.89 crore workers, including 10.27 crore of 10.84 crore active workers. FILE PHOTO

job cards of 57 lakh active workers have not yet completed the e-KYC process.

95% e-KYC completed

So far, e-KYC has been completed for 15.89 crore workers, including 10.27 crore of 10.84 crore active workers, which is approximately 95%.

While not disputing the numbers given in *The Hindu* report, the government said that e-KYC is a database-authentication measure and not a precondition for exercising the statutory right to demand employment under VB-G RAM G.

“Every worker regis-

tered under MGNREGA, irrespective of whether e-KYC has been completed, has been migrated to VB-G RAM G. Pending e-KYC does not prevent a worker from demanding or receiving employment. An appropriate exception mechanism is also available to facilitate employment demand and the provision of work for workers whose e-KYC is pending,” the statement said.

Simple process

The Ministry further said that e-KYC of workers is the responsibility of the concerned State and Union Territory governments and is being undertaken to strengthen authentication and maintain an accurate and credible worker database.

“The process is simple and can ordinarily be completed in less than 30 seconds,” the statement said.

2.11 cr. offered jobs

The government further underlined that every worker who has demanded employment has been offered work as per demand, and around 2.11 crore workers have so far been offered employment under VB-G RAM G. Simultaneously, the Centre has advised States to expeditiously complete e-KYC of all active workers.

“The Ministry is continuously supporting and monitoring States/UTs in this exercise while ensuring that no willing worker is deprived of employment merely because e-KYC is pending,” it said.

Manipur CM supports NRC, but not via shutdowns

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

Manipur CM Yumnam Khemchand Singh on Sunday said he favoured updating the National Register of Citizens (NRC) in the State, but insisted that shutdowns and blockades were not the way to seek the exercise.

The remark comes a day before the Campaign for Just and Fair Delimitation, an umbrella group of 14 civil society organisations, has threatened a 24-hour shutdown from midnight on August 31 if the Centre does not defer the Census exercise and start the NRC process in the State.

DETAILS ON
» [PAGE 10](#)

CM

K

A ND-NDE



Major fire at garment shop in Gandhi Nagar; no casualties

A major fire broke out at a garment shop in east Delhi’s Gandhi Nagar area on Sunday, prompting the deployment of six fire tenders, a Delhi Fire Services official said. No casualties have been reported. Firefighters faced difficulty reaching the spot due to congested lanes lined with shops and residential buildings. The fire was subsequently brought under control, the official said, adding that the cause and extent of damage are being ascertained. PTI

Lakshmi Yojana recurring deposit to mature in 2029

The maturity date of the recurring deposit (RD) under the Delhi Lakshmi Yojana is set for July 31, 2029, with the Council of Ministers authorised to change it after reviewing the scheme two years post-launch. This falls in the Lok Sabha election year. Applicants without an Aadhaar card can register under the scheme using an enrollment slip and an alternative ID such as a PAN, ration or voter ID card. The scheme provides ₹2,500 per month to eligible women, targeting 17 lakh beneficiaries. The RD has a lock-in period until July 2029, earning interest at the current rate. PTI

Boy ‘assaulted’ at day care; principal, 3 others booked under POCSO; 1 arrested

Search on for director, others at Jaffrabad playschool; 3-year-old has swelling on thigh, abrasion near left eye, notes report; CCTV footage shows my son tied, beaten in classroom: complainant

Shrimansi Kaushik
NEW DELHI

The Delhi police on Sunday arrested an employee of a private day care and playschool in north-east Delhi’s Jaffrabad, two days after the father of a three-year-old boy filed a complaint alleging that the child had been physically assaulted and sexually harassed at the facility, a senior police officer said.

A case was registered against the staff member, the school director, the principal and a teacher on August 28 under Sections 115(2) and 126(2) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, Sections 75 and 82 of the Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act, 2015, and Section 12 of the Protection of Children



I could only access the footage for three days. I don’t know for how long they had been torturing my child like this

VICTIM’S FATHER

from Sexual Offences Act, 2012. Efforts are under way to arrest the other three accused, the officer said, adding, “Appropriate legal action will be taken after reviewing the CCTV footage and other evidence.”

According to the father’s complaint, the child had been refusing to go to school for several days and was having difficulty using the washroom. On August 18, he began vomiting, following which his parents took him to an ENT special-

ist, who found severe swelling in both his eardrums. “The doctor said he had been beaten. We asked the facility to give us access to the CCTV footage. The school director made us pay ₹1,500 to access it,” the father stated in the complaint.

The CCTV footage from August 16 to 18, which the father received on August 25, purportedly showed the child being tied to a chair, slapped, having his ears pulled and the chair being kicked by the teacher and the support staff member.

“This was happening inside the classroom where all the other children were present. During playtime, when the other children were playing, he was always kept with the teachers, tied to the chair,” the

father told *The Hindu*, adding, “He is still having difficulty hearing.”

On August 27, the child was medically examined at GTB Hospital. The medico-legal case (MLC) report recorded “physical assault” and noted swelling on his left thigh and an abrasion near his left eye.

‘School ignored abuse’

The father said when he confronted the school director, he was told, “*Aise to bachche roz pit te hain* (Children are beaten like this every day).”

“I could only access the footage for three days. I don’t know for how long they had been torturing my child like this,” the father said. “He immediately starts crying at the mention of using the washroom,” he added.

100 acres freed from legacy waste at three landfill sites, says CM

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Sunday said the Delhi government has taken several scientific measures to tackle the Capital’s legacy waste problem and reclaimed approximately 100 acres of land at the Okhla, Bhalswa, and Ghazipur landfill sites so far.

In a video statement, Ms. Gupta said 70 lakh metric tons of waste had been processed at the Okhla landfill and about 35 acres reclaimed. At Bhalswa, 102 lakh metric tons had been processed and about 45 acres reclaimed, while at Ghazipur, 44 lakh metric tons had been processed and about 20 acres reclaimed.

‘Better quality of life’

The inert material generated during waste processing is being used for road construction and to fill low-lying areas, she said. “The lifestyle of those who live around it has improved



CM Rekha Gupta said four new plants will be set up to prevent garbage pile-up. FILE PHOTO

and property rates in the area surrounding the landfills have also gone up,” the Chief Minister said.

To prevent garbage from piling up again, the government is introducing four new waste-to-energy plants to ensure that the waste generated in the city is processed immediately, Ms. Gupta added.

Mayor Pravesh Wahi had announced last month that the Okhla and Bhalswa landfills have a December 2026 deadline for clearance, while the Municipal Corporation of Delhi aims to clear the Ghazipur landfill by the end of 2027.

J&K should focus on retaining talented youth, says Mattoo

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Jammu and Kashmir (J&K) must become a place where talented youth can thrive rather than a region from which ambition must permanently depart, Amitabh Mattoo, Dean of the School of International Studies at Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU), said on Sunday. He also called for restoring J&K’s Statehood.

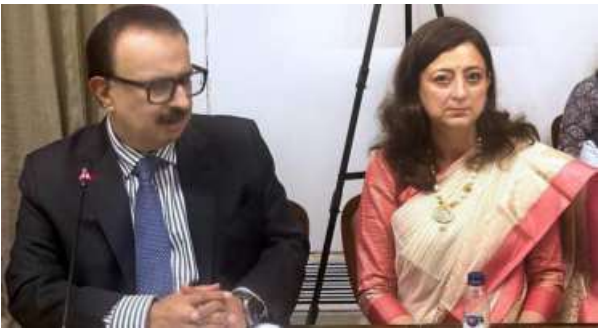
Delivering the third V.N. Bahadur Memorial Lecture on ‘Jammu and Kashmir today: opportunities and challenges’, Professor Mattoo said the focus over the next decade must be on retaining local talent in the UT. He called for building universities, supporting entrepreneurs, promoting technology and investing in horticulture, tourism and creative industries.

He said the challenge in

J&K is no longer merely to integrate territory but to consolidate belonging.

“Nowhere in India has the relationship between state and citizen been more intense, more complicated or more consequential than in Jammu and Kashmir,” Professor Mattoo said.

He said seven years after the dilution of Article 370, substantial gains must be acknowledged.



Amitabh Mattoo, Dean of the School of International Studies at JNU, with Etee Bahadur, Assistant Proctor at Jamia Millia Islamia, during the event on Sunday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

DDA posts FAQs online to simplify city’s 2047 master plan for citizens

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi Development Authority (DDA) on Sunday published a comprehensive set of frequently asked questions (FAQs) on its website to make the Master Plan for Delhi-2047 (MPD-2047) easier for citizens and stakeholders to

understand, enabling their active participation in the city’s development.

The directions to make the MPD-2047 more accessible to people came from Lieutenant-Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu, who is also chairperson of the authority.

“The initiative reflects DDA’s commitment to

making the implementation of the master plan a participatory and inclusive process, with greater awareness, dialogue and collective stakeholder engagement contributing towards building a more sustainable, connected, inclusive and future-ready Delhi,” the DDA stated in an official release.

EDUCATIONPLUS

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Ponmythili Muralidharan

Degrees have become central to how we understand educational progress. Colleges are expanding, enrolments are growing, and more youngsters enter the workforce every year with certificates in hand. By that measure, we should be more educated than we have ever been.

Yet most of us would have met someone whose qualifications gave them real authority, but who used it to intimidate rather than to help. Someone who knew more than the person in front of them and made sure that person felt small for not knowing it.

We recognise this the moment we see it. We rarely stop to ask what it means. It means the qualification arrived, but something else did not.

Distinctions

That something else is education. It is not the same thing as literacy or certification. Literacy gives us access to knowledge. Certification records that we have completed a prescribed course of study. Education is different. It is supposed to change what we do with what we know. A person may be literate, highly qualified and professionally successful but use knowledge to set themselves apart from others or above them. An educated person uses the same knowledge with greater responsibility, humility



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Education or certification?

Why we need to differentiate between literacy, certification, and education

and awareness of others. This is not a small distinction. It decides what kind of society we are actually building.

I see this shift happen quietly, every year, in my own classroom. I once asked a class to discuss a case without telling them whether it would be assessed. The first question was not about the dilemma in the case. It was, “Ma’am, will this come for the exam?” It was an honest

and revealing question. Somewhere along the way, learning had become valuable only when it could be converted into marks.

This is why, over the years, I have tried to create more space for experience alongside assessment. A mark tells you what a student memorised for three hours. It does not tell you what changed in them. When learning is designed to be lived and not just re-

called, students stop asking, “What will be asked?” and start asking, “What does this mean?” That shift captures an important difference between literacy and education within a single classroom.

What is missing

But this is not only a story about individual students or individual professionals who lost their way. It is also a story about a system that has gradually evolved in

ways that often produce this outcome.

Schools and colleges under pressure to place students, to show results, to stay relevant in a competitive market, have increasingly prioritised the job at the end over the person being shaped along the way. Students are prepared to be employable. They are not always prepared to be transformed. That is not a small oversight. It shapes an entire

generation’s relationship with knowledge itself.

The growing interest in experiential and alternative forms of schooling may also reflect this unease. Many parents appear to be looking for learning environments that develop curiosity, independence, and social awareness alongside academic achievement. Whether or not these alternatives offer a complete answer, their appeal tells us something about what families feel is missing from conventional education.

So, perhaps, the more useful question for all of us is not whether our institutions are failing us. It is whether we know what we are actually asking of them. What are we asking for when we choose a school, a college, or a course? Are we asking to be made employable or to be transformed? Once we know the answer, what does that require of us as students, parents, teachers, and educational institutions?

We cannot place the responsibility for this only on the system or the individual. Both have a role in what gets built and both have a role in fixing it. The first step is simply to stop confusing the certificate with the change it was supposed to represent and to start asking, honestly, which one we have actually been given.

The writer is Junior Faculty Organisation - Behaviour and Human Resource at Great Lakes Institute of Management, Chennai.

SCHOLARSHIPS

JK Tyre Shiksha Sarthi Scholarship

An initiative by JK Tyre and Industries Ltd.
Eligibility: Students enrolled in general or professional UG or Diploma courses with 55% in the previous academic year and who are residents of Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Karnataka, or Tamil Nadu and are daughters of heavy vehicle drivers and have an annual parental income not exceeding ₹500,000.
Rewards: Up to ₹25,000
Application: Online
Deadline: September 10
www.b4s.in/edge/JKTS4

IDFC FIRST Bank Engineering Scholarship

An initiative by IDFC FIRST Bank.
Eligibility: Students who are Indian citizens in the first year of a B.Tech or B.E. programme (2026-27)

academic year) in one of the FIRST IMPACT empanelled colleges and have an annual family income less than or equal to ₹600,000.

Rewards: ₹100,000 a year up to four years.
Application: Online
Deadline: September 20
www.b4s.in/edge/IFBES2

Mahindra EmpowerHer Scholarship

An initiative by Mahindra & Mahindra Limited.
Eligibility: Girl students from the SC, ST or OBC communities in school (Classes 9 to 12) or college (general UG or PG programmes) and have got at least 50% in the previous academic year or semester and have an annual family income should not exceed ₹400,000.
Rewards: ₹5,500
Application: Online
Deadline: September 21
http://www.b4s.in/edge/MNM3

Courtesy: Buddy4study.com

Yuva Yodha

Schneider Electric has launched Yuva Yodha, a national tech hackathon to create innovative, practical, and scaleable solutions for India’s growing energy and sustainability need across four key areas critical to India’s growth and energy transition: Sustainable Agriculture, Smart

Buildings, Grid Reliability and Renewable Interconnectivity, and Smart Manufacturing
Eligibility: Indian citizens or residents who are full-time students of UG or PG STEM programmes. Participants can compete individually or in teams of up to four members.
Deadline: October 4
Details at yuvayodhatech.com



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INBRIEF



AAP leader Gurpreet Singh shot dead in Punjab's Ferozepur

Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) leader Gurpreet Singh alias Gopi, 45, was shot dead by four armed assailants in Ferozepur district, with police on Sunday saying the killing was linked to an election-related dispute. The police said four car-borne assailants got down from their vehicle in the main bazaar of Mamdot on Saturday evening and opened fire at Singh and Harpreet alias Happy, 22. They were rushed to the Civil Hospital where Singh was declared brought dead, while Mr. Harpreet was referred to a private hospital in Ludhiana, the police said. PTI

Bihar boy stages protest over 'police excesses' against parents

A six-year-old boy, who made headlines earlier this week for joining the student protest in Patna, on Sunday initiated a sit-in at Gardanibagh area alleging that his parents were "beaten up by the police while he was taken into custody". The boy had joined the protests led by Bihar Public Service Commission exam aspirants on August 25. During the stir, the protesters intended to gherao Chief Minister Samrat Chaudhury's residence over a range of demands, including a single-tier test for the Teacher Recruitment Examination. "My parents were beaten up while I was kept separated from them in custody for eight hours. My parents are not criminals, so why did the police beat them up?" the boy said. PTI

Signs of thaw in CPI-CPI(M) ties after squabble over Dy. LoP post

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

A thaw in the strained relations between the Kerala's Communist Party of India (CPI) and the Communist Party of India (Marxist) [CPI(M)] over the Deputy Leader of the Opposition (LoP) post in the State Assembly was apparent on Sunday, with veteran CPI(M) leader A.K. Balan trying to soothe frayed nerves by stating

that the two Left parties "are the heart and brain of the Left Democratic Front (LDF) and will remain so". Both parties have their individual stances on whether to follow precedents in some cases, which are communicated to their cadre and followers, he said. He also criticised the United Democratic Front (UDF) and the Indian Union Muslim League (IUML) for ostensibly believing they could fish in troubled

waters. The mood for reconciliation was visible in a piece written by CPI leader Rajaji Mathew Thomas in the party mouthpiece, *Janayugam*, on Sunday.

'Changing landscape'
Mr. Thomas argued that the CPI only wanted collective leadership and responsibility for the alliance in the State in the wake of the changing political landscape across the country, including Kerala.

IISER students' protest in Pune enters 4th day

Yohan Varghese
MUMBAI

Students at the Indian Institute of Science Education and Research (IISER), Pune, continued their protest for the fourth consecutive day on Sunday following the death of a third-year student on August 16.

The students have raised five demands, including improvements to mental health infrastructure, an end to "oppressive"

gender-based hostel restrictions, adequate space and access to campus facilities, protection from disciplinary action for peaceful protests, and revocation of the suspension of student representative and general secretary Raj Bagwe. The students said the protest will continue until the institute responds to their demands.

(Those in distress can contact Tele MANAS at 14416 to seek help)

No protests as 'anti-national' graffiti removed from Jadavpur University

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

Grffiti at Jadavpur University (JU) was whitewashed following West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari's stern warning on August 28 to weed out "anti-national" elements from the campus in Kolkata.

The university authorities said the drive was part of the regular cleaning process and that the university did not want to be drawn

into any controversy. The process of putting white paint on the graffiti started on Saturday and continued till Sunday.

Some speak out
There have been no protests against the development, though some students, particularly those associated with Left students' unions, have spoken out against the move.

Grffiti in support of Palestine and Maoist leader

Kishenji was whitewashed from the walls of the JU Arts hostel. A slogan on the open-air theatre that read, 'Fascists do not deserve democracy. They deserve a bullet in the head,' was also covered with white paint. Also erased was a portrait of American civil rights activist Audre Lorde.

Grffiti and poster culture have been prevalent at the university for decades and are inseparable from the politics on campus.

SPOTLIGHT

Amit Bhelari

It has been just six days since the students' protests ended in Ranchi, and Devendra Nath Mahto, 34, is out on a yatra. The student leader went on a hunger strike for 16 days, along with five others, demanding accountability and reforms in the recruitment exam system in Jharkhand.

On August 24, Mahto launched the Bharti Vyaastha Sudhar Yatra (Recruitment System Reform Journey), from Nemra village in Ramgarh district. Nemra is the birthplace of former Chief Minister Shibu Soren, co-founder of the Jharkhand Mukti Morcha that is currently in power in a coalition government in the State.

"My body is weak, but my soul is stronger than anybody else. You just need willpower and the support of the people, which will keep moving you ahead. I never cared about my health during the hunger strike for the students," he tells the crowd at Nemra.

The yatra, across Jharkhand's 24 districts, is to garner public support for transparency and fairness in government recruitment examinations.

Mahto, who hails from Kapdih village in Ranchi district, has two MA degrees, one in Sanskrit, one in Kurmali, both from Dr.

Shyama Prasad Mukherjee University in Ranchi. He graduated with a B.Ed degree from Vinoba Bhave University in 2017.

He began his protest on July 2 this year by staging a dharna at Morabadi ground in Ranchi, under the banner of the Jharkhand Public Service Commission (JPSC)-Jharkhand Staff Selection Commission (JSSC) Abhyarthi Nyay Manch. However, after the State police disallowed him, he shifted to the Jaipal Singh Munda Stadium, joining the stir by the JPSC-JSSC Reform Manch, led by student leader Ravindra Paswan.

Both wanted the cancellation of JPSC and JSSC exams, a CBI investigation, and also cancellation of all exams conducted by a blacklisted agency. They demanded prosecution of officials, besides the reconstitution of commissions and a complete examination calendar.

Chief Minister Hemant Soren called an emergency meeting of the Cabinet on August 17 and agreed to most of the demands made by the students, except the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) probe.

The next day, the State government issued a notification cancelling 22 exams over irregularities and handed over 23 additional exams to be investigated by the Crime Investigation Department.

The students then ended their protest, including

Taking reforms to the road

The students' protest in Ranchi over alleged irregularities in recruitment examinations for government jobs remained in the news for most of the month of August. A look at the fallout of the decision by the Jharkhand government led by Chief Minister Hemant Soren to cancel several exams



Devendra Nath Mahto and supporters at the launch of his yatra seeking reforms in recruitment exams at Nemra, birthplace of former CM Shibu Soren in Ramgarh district, Jharkhand. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

the 16-day hunger strike.

The Supreme Court on August 24 issued notice to Jharkhand for a CBI probe into the alleged malpractices in the Jharkhand Combined Civil Services Preliminary Examination.

The CBI is still investigating the first and second JPSC examinations, held in 2003 and 2006.

The reforms' yatra took shape after the Jharkhand

High Court stayed the State government notification of cancelling recruitment exams, including the JSSC-CGL exam, which hires for mid-level government jobs.

After the order, the students who had protested for 26 days, alleging irregularities in recruitment exams, felt "cheated" by the government.

They allege that to end their protest the govern-

ment intentionally cancelled the exams, knowing it would not stand in court.

A trip across Jharkhand

Mahto goes from village to village, stopping for students to gather around him. Children come too, but most of the crowd is aged between 20 and 25.

People line the streets to welcome him, showering him with flowers, garland-

BJP hails 1857 icon at Lodhi sabha event; SP questions 1 lakh jobs vow

Patriotism, bravery of freedom fighter Rani Avanti Bai Lodhi transcend social, gender barriers, says Rajnath; govt. to provide 50,000 scooters to women; Akhilesh says promise of jobs for youth made in run-up to U.P. poll; MCC to kick in from Jan. '27

Press Trust of India
LUCKNOW

Senior Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) leader and Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Sunday paid tribute to the 1857 freedom fighter Rani Avanti Bai Lodhi, saying her patriotism and bravery transcended all social and gender barriers.

"Avanti Bai Lodhi taught that patriotism and bravery can't be confined to the boundaries of any caste, class or gender," Mr. Singh said at the event in Lucknow organised by the Lodhi Kshatriya Rajput Sabha.

Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, who was also present at the event, said no single individual, party or region can claim credit for India's freedom movement. He also hit out at Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav for allegedly not offering condolences in August 2021 on the death of former Chief Minister Kalyan Singh, a Lodhi leader.

Meanwhile, the SP chief took a swipe at Mr. Adityanath over his remark that his government will provide jobs to 1 lakh youth in



Defence Minister, senior BJP leader and party MP from Lucknow Rajnath Singh paying tribute to 1857 freedom fighter Avanti Bai Lodhi; SP chief Akhilesh Yadav addressing a press conference in Lucknow. PTI

the next six months.

"Now, with only a few days left, they are saying that 1 lakh jobs will be given. After January, the Model Code of Conduct will come into force," he said.

The Assembly election is due in early 2027.

Growing presence

The Defence Minister, who is an MP from Lucknow, and the Chief Minister hailed the role of women in different spheres, from

bagging sports medals to defending the country.

Avanti Bai not only challenged British rule but also confronted a system that underestimated women, Mr. Singh said, adding that her life is an example of women's empowerment.

"In the Army, sports ... India's women are demonstrating their capabilities. From the heights of Siachen to the depths of the seas, they are playing an important role in strengthening the country," said the Defence Minister.

Mr. Adityanath attacked the SP, alleging that its government had tried to close the Provincial Armed Constabulary (PAC). Three all-woman PAC battalions have been formed, with one each stationed in Lucknow, Gorakhpur, and Badaun. The battalion in Badaun is named after Avanti Bai Lodhi, he added.

The CM said his government will provide scooters



to 50,000 women as a tribute to freedom fighter Rani Lakshmi Bai.

'Govt. failed the poor'
Addressing a media briefing at his party headquarters, the SP chief hit out at the BJP-led regime in U.P., accusing it of corruption and "failing the poor".

The Kannauj MP also reiterated his promise of reopening 26,000 primary schools, which he said had been closed down during the Adityanath government. He also underlined the Opposition party's demand for a caste census and equitable rights for disadvantaged groups.

Last week, Mr. Yadav had announced a 'Stree Samman Samridhhi Yojana' under which each woman would receive assistance of ₹40,000 every year. Mainpuri MP Dimple Yadav, who was also present at the announcement, had said, "Women's power will develop not merely by talking about it, but by giving true representation to women. Respect and prosperity of every woman included in the PDA as 'Aadhi Abadi (half the population, or women)' is our resolve."



Divya Mittal announced her resignation on Sunday.

U.P. IAS officer resigns, terms her journey 'unforgettable'

Mavank Kumar
LUCKNOW

Uttar Pradesh-cadre IAS officer and former Deoria District Magistrate Divya Mittal announced her resignation on Sunday. She described her 13-year journey in the service as "unforgettable".

"After studying at IIT Delhi and IIM Bangalore, I worked day and night and landed a job in London. But even after having everything, something felt incomplete... So I returned and was fortunate to become an IAS officer," Ms. Mittal wrote on X.

"A single scene is etched in my heart: the elderly woman from the Lahuriya Dah Hills, who, seeing water in her village for the first time, said nothing but touched my head with trembling hands and blessed me," she added.

T.N. moves SC, seeks release of Cauvery water backlog

Karnataka must release balance quantity of 17604 tmc ft of water, T.N. tells top court; highlights plight of Cauvery Delta farmers; says CWRC, CWMA failed to consider backlog

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Tamil Nadu government approached the Supreme Court on Sunday, seeking a direction to Karnataka to release 17,604 tmc ft of water from the Cauvery river, the balance quantity as on August 27, based on the *pro-rata* formula.

The State, in a supplementary affidavit settled by senior advocate G. Umapathy and re-settled by C.S. Vaidyanathan, also urged the court to order Karnataka to release 9,000 cusecs of water between August 26 and



The exposed rocky bed of the Cauvery at Hogenakkal in Tamil Nadu earlier this month. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

September 8, as directed by the Cauvery Water Management Authority (CWMA). It further sought the top court's intervention to direct Karnataka to make good the shortfall between the flows ensured at Billigundulu, a riverside village on the border between the two States, and the

flows that the CWMA had directed to take place between August 27 and August 30. "The farmers of Cauvery Delta are prejudiced as Kuruvai season is almost over and Mettur (dam) could not be open for irrigation," Tamil Nadu submitted in the affidavit. A Bench is scheduled to hear the case on August 31.

Tamil Nadu said that CWRC had fixed 9,000 cusecs for the next 15 days with effect from August 25, without considering the accumulated backlog of 17,415 tmc as on August 23.

Tamil Nadu said it had raised its grievance before the CWMA, at its meeting the very next day on August 25, about the "gross inadequacy" of the CWRC order for release of water. "CWMA directed Karnataka to ensure only 9,000 cusecs per day from August 25 to September 8," the affidavit said.

THE HINDU

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JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in



Hue and Cry Notice Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Kalbir Singh S/O Manjit Singh Caste Sikh R/O Talab Tillo, Jammu is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 263/1991 U/S 406/409 RPC, of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name : Kalbir Singh
S/O : Manjit Singh
Caste : Sikh
Address : Talab Tillo, Jammu.
Age : 70-75 Years

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1. DPO, Jammu : 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu : 0191-2605949
4. SP City South : 0191-2430002
5. SDPO City East : 01912433778
6. P/S Bahu Fort : 0191-2475133

Sr. Superintendent of Police
Jammu

DIP/J- 8983/26, Aug 29 2026

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

BIRTH CENTENARY



In Memory of our dear mother
Smt. Rajalakshmi Rangaswamy
(Abbi) & celebration of
100 years of her life
1926 - 2026

Our loving mother who nurtured us
throughout her life.

Nagalakshmi Satyan
Choodamani Anand
Shantha Rangaswamy
Padma Sundareshan
Harini Sreekanth
Hemamalini Sridhar

Her Daughters
Sons-in-law
Grandkids
Great Grandkids

Accused gets seven-year jail term in terror module case

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

A special National Investigation Agency court in Bengaluru has sentenced a man over the 2020 Al-Hind ISIS terror conspiracy case to seven years of rigorous imprisonment.

A fine of ₹48,000 has also been imposed on Syed Fasiur Rehman. Investigators said that the Al-Hind module planned targeted killings to trigger communal riots.

Timings

DELHI

MONDAY, AUG. 31		
RISE	05:59	SET 18:44
RISE	20:25	SET 08:47
TUESDAY, SEP. 01		
RISE	05:59	SET 18:43
RISE	21:01	SET 09:50
WEDNESDAY, SEP. 02		
RISE	06:00	SET 18:42
RISE	21:41	SET 10:54

Delhi Weather	max	min
Delhi City	36	28
Safdarjang	36	28
Palam	35	25

Delhi Palam Today
36°C The weather will be mostly dry. Day will be very warm with uneasy afternoon. Night will be comfortable.

Delhi Palam Tomorrow
36°C The weather will be dry. Day will be very warm and uneasy. Night will be comfortable.

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Indian Bank

CORPORATE OFFICE,
254-260, AVVAI SHANMUGAM SALAI,
ROYAPETTAH, CHENNAI - 600014

PUBLIC NOTICE FOR ACTIVATION OF INOPERATIVE ACCOUNTS

Our Bank has observed that in some accounts there is no customer-induced transactions for over two years. Account holders of such Inoperative accounts are hereby requested to reactivate their accounts by visiting their home branch or any Indian Bank branch by submitting fresh KYC documents like Aadhar / Driving License/Voter ID /etc

For any queries or assistance, please contact your nearest Indian Bank branch.

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NEW DELHI MUNICIPAL COUNCIL

PALIKA KEDRA : NEW DELHI
SECRETARY'S ESTT. BRANCH

FILLING UP SIX (06) POSTS OF SENIOR AUDIT OFFICER AND TWELVE (12) POSTS OF ASSISTANT AUDIT OFFICER IN NEW DELHI MUNICIPAL COUNCIL ON DEPUTATION BASIS REG.

The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) proposes to fill up the following posts, on deputation basis for the period of three years. The period of deputation can be extended/ curtailed as per requirement/performance of the individual. The details are as under:-

Sl. No.	Name of Post	Number of Post	Pay Level	Eligibility
1.	Senior Audit Officer	06	Level-10 of 7th CPC Pay Matrix (Rs.56,100-1,77,500)	Holding analogous post, or with 03 years regular service as Audit Officer/ Accounts Officer in Pay Level-09 of 7th CPC Pay Matrix (Rs. 53100-167800).
2.	Asstt. Audit Officer	12	Pay Level- 08 of 7th CPC Pay Matrix (Rs.47600-151100)	Holding analogous post.

1. The format of the application and the details regarding age, qualifications, experience and other conditions of eligibility etc. for the posts are available in our website www.ndmc.gov.in./Public Notices/.
2. The last date of submission of application 05.10.2026.

Jt. Director (Establishment)



UT OF LAKSHADWEEP ADMINISTRATION

Warmly welcomes

HON'BLE VICE PRESIDENT OF INDIA

SHRI C. P. RADHAKRISHNAN

AT THE

FISHERIES OUTREACH PROGRAMME

Key Initiatives for Fisheries Development & Livelihood Support
(Under the Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana - PMMSY)

- Deep Sea & Recreational Fishing Vessels
- Safety & Communication Systems
- Livelihood & Credit Assistance

Organised by
UT Administration of Lakshadweep

Under leadership of

SHRI PRAFUL PATEL

Hon'ble Administrator
UTs of Dadra & Nagar Haveli & Daman & Diu and Lakshadweep

In the Gracious Presence of

SHRI RAJIV RANJAN SINGH (LALAN SINGH)

Hon'ble Union Minister for Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying
Government of India

PROF. S. P. SINGH BAGHEL

Hon'ble Minister of State for Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying
Government of India

 31st August 2026 |  10:00 AM |  Agatti, Lakshadweep

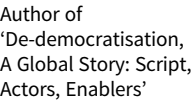
CM YK        A ND-NDE



Given these issues and the fragmented resource available, the lack of suitably disaggregated data on disenfranchised communities, including due to a much-delayed Census and the slow release of NCRB data, has transcended the bounds of administrative lethargy to actively impeding independent checks of India's claims about fighting caste- and faith-based discrimination. In fact, India has been implementing "special measures" based on 2011 Census data, which could mask a regression in the socioeconomic status of Scheduled Tribes and Adivasis. Together with the Global Alliance of National Human Rights Institutions recommending the downgrade of the NHRC last year, following the government appointing police officers to investigative roles and a lack of pluralism, CERD is effectively stepping into a vacuum. The road ahead remains clear, from restoring the NHRC's independence and criminalising hate speech to supportive affirmative action, collecting and publishing disaggregated data, and improving the transparency of the electoral roll revisions, and strengthening enforcement overall. But if the government's attempted use of a technicality to keep the issues of 200 million Dalits a "domestic matter" and avoid international accountability – and its dismissal of CERD's concerns as politically motivated is any guide, the task continues to fall to civil society to exert influence in multilateral fora and sustain political, legal, and administrative resistance to government choices that normalise India's sadly widespread culture of discrimination of all sorts.

Stepping into the Emerald Isle and hamstringing by the injured Jasprit Bumrah's absence, India did its homework. A warm-up fixture was won, while some of its players had earlier turned out for India A against Sri Lanka A and were ready. When the series commenced with the first Test at picturesque Galle, India led from the front and won by 165 runs to secure a 1-0 lead. Devdutt Padikkal's 167 and 44 led the run charts and most importantly it also meant that the critical number three spot in the batting order had found an apt occupant for now. This is the same position that in the past had featured pedigree men such as Dilip Vengsarkar, Rahul Dravid and Cheteshwar Pujara. Left-arm spinner Manav Suthar too did well and his classical mode is a throwback to a gentle past. Sri Lanka's brief resistance hinged on Sonal Dinusha, who registered a ton. Soon he would become an immovable personality at the batting crease and India learnt it the hard way at Colombo. His twin hundreds helped Sri Lanka erase the ignominy of suffering a follow-on and also survive a tense final day to wrest a draw. The conclusion felt like a victory for the host and India is now placed in a must-win corner in its future Tests.

Operation Demonise *Dimaag* began a decade



The examples Mr. Modi cites are unconvincing. Defending refineries from aerial bombardment and banks from cyber attacks cannot be left to 'civilian volunteers' – these would need enhanced air defence and cyber-security systems comprising experts. We already have the Civil Defence Act 1968 and the Home Guards to organise civilians for non-combat roles. Is Mr.

The new
labelling is an
escalation of
the
government's
attitude
towards dissent
and democracy

Former administrator
who has held
diplomatic and
constitutional offices

Will these mobs, together with the moral policing mobs and the anti-Muslim lynch mobs, be elevated to the ranks of Mr. Modi's 'civilian defence force'? This is a real danger, given that his supporters believe he is the 'Hindu Hitler' of Moonje's and Hedgewar's dreams.

T.S. Karthik,
Chennai

Letters emailed to
letters@thehindu.co.in
must carry the postal address.

Should the CJP be a political party?

A glimpse at India's recent history suggests that while some protest movements became successful political parties, others did not. The success of the recent youth movement started by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) should not be judged by whether it would become a successful political party nor by its forcing the former Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan to resign. Rather, the success of the CJP movement should be judged by the enthusiastic participation of young students for a cause which concerned them; the success of which has raised confidence in them.

They now believe that they can make the government hear their voices even if it is raised from a non-political platform.

Movements to parties

Very often the success of a movement is judged by not only what the movement was able to achieve but whether it was able to become a successful political party or not. The 1979 student's agitation in Assam led by the All Assam Students Union transformed into a successful political party, the Asom Gana Parishad (AGP), which formed the government in 1985 in Assam. The India against corruption movement also transformed into a political party – the Aam Adami Party (AAP) which came to power in Delhi for the first time in 2013. Not only did the India against corruption movement draw large support, the AAP also enjoyed massive electoral gains; it won 67 and 62 seats out of a total of 70 Assembly



Sanjay Kumar

Professor and election analyst. Views expressed are personal

seats in Delhi with a 54.3% and 53.5% vote share during the 2015 and 2020 Assembly elections respectively.

The AAP also formed a government in Punjab in 2022.

In the success story of both the AGP and AAP, the youth played an important role. During the 2015 Assembly elections, the AAP's vote share among young voters (18-22 years of age) was 63%, almost 10% higher compared to its average vote share. The AAP went on to draw 60% of the votes among young voters (18-22 years) during the 2020 Assembly elections as well – 7% higher compared to its average vote share.

If the CJP does turn into a political party, there is hardly any doubt that the new party will attract young voters, as has been the case with other newly formed parties. The newly formed Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK), led by actor-turned politician C. Joseph Vijay, formed the government in Tamil Nadu in the very first election it contested in 2026, replacing the two established formations mainly the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam and the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam. The youth played a very important role in the victory of the TVK. While the overall vote share of the TVK was 34.9%, its share among young voters (18-22) was significant at nearly 70%.

Nationally, the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) has an advantage among young voters, its vote share being 4% higher amongst voters in the age group of 18-22 years. Therefore, the rise of the CJP may affect the BJP more than any other party.

But the question remains, can the CJP attract young

voters across the country?

Strong challengers

There have also been successful social movements which have failed as political parties. The movement for a separate State of Uttarakhand resulted in the formation of a new State and a new political party, the Uttarakhand Kranti Dal (UKD). However, it failed to make an electoral impact. During the 2002 election, which was the first election held after the formation of Uttarakhand, the UKD polled only 5.4% votes and won just four Assembly seats. There have been similar groups which have led protest movements, demanding Statehood and the like, but most of them could not become successful political parties.

However, there have been movements led by the youth, with the participation of larger social communities, which resulted in a change of the national government. The Jayaprakash Narayan led anti-emergency movement of 1977 dethroned the powerful Indira Gandhi-led government. Similarly, the anti-corruption movement led by Anna Hazare contributed to the defeat of the Congress-led coalition government in 2014.

It should be of no concern whether the CJP becomes a political party or not as the movement has already been able to achieve some noticeable milestones. It emphasised that issues take importance and not leaders as this movement was largely leaderless without the active support of any political party.

It also gave a large number of people the hope that their voices can be heard if they come together in a sustained manner.

Adopt policies for reuse of treated water

The recently notified treated wastewater reuse policies for Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand offer an instructive example of what contextualised policymaking can look like. Developed through an extensive consultative process, these policies do not apply a one-size-fits-all template. They account for the stark geographical diversity within each State, the distinct needs of hill communities versus densely populated plains, and embed principles such as fit-for-purpose reuse approaches, integration with urban planning and river rejuvenation, community participation, blended finance and public-private partnership pathways, and digital monitoring systems that make reuse accountable.

However, examples such as these remain the exception rather than the rule. Every summer, Indian States make headlines grappling with water scarcity and yet, the story never seems to change. Rampant groundwater extraction, and the relentless tug-of-war between agriculture, industry, and urban demand have become a recurring script. The real question is no longer whether India needs to rewrite this narrative, but how much longer it can afford not to.

Hidden opportunity

Treated wastewater is an untapped resource waiting to be mainstreamed. For agriculture, industry, urban landscaping, and ecological restoration, it offers something increasingly rare: a reliable, drought-proof supply. India's water future may hinge less on



Sonia Grover

Water policy expert at Mu Gamma consultants



Girija Bharat

Water policy expert at Mu Gamma consultants

discovering new freshwater reserves and more on the intelligence with which the country recycles what it already has. National missions such as the Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation have done commendable work in scaling sewage treatment infrastructure, but pipes and plants alone do not close the loop. A treatment facility that discharges into a drain rather than feeding a farm or a factory is infrastructure without purpose.

What India needs is an ecosystem that converts capacity into practice: institutional coordination across departments, pricing signals that make reuse economically rational, quality standards that inspire confidence in end-users, and city-level roadmaps that translate national ambition into local action. The National Framework on Safe Reuse of Treated Water (SRTW), 2022 offers precisely the canvas India needs to navigate this transition. More than a guiding document, it represents a policy signal that reuse is no longer peripheral – it is a national priority. By mandating States to develop their own reuse policies, the Framework acknowledges that water solutions must ultimately be local, even when the vision is national. Several States have already responded, putting in place policies that set reuse targets and chart a path toward measurable milestones.

Treated wastewater, reframed correctly, is not a waste management problem; it is an economic opportunity. Its case rests on hard, computable value – building climate resilience, drought-proofing cities,

reducing costly dependence on freshwater, enabling industrial and urban growth without straining existing supplies, and supporting low-carbon urban development at scale. Until this economic case is made clearly and credibly to State governments and planners, the policy will remain an aspiration.

Reuse succeeds only when utilities, urban departments, irrigation agencies, and industries stop working in silos and start working in an integrated manner. The financial momentum needed to hit reuse targets is rarely found in new budgetary allocations alone; it is unlocked by identifying synergies with existing schemes and convergence opportunities across programmes that are already funded and moving.

Need for awareness

There is one more constituency that cannot be overlooked: the public. Misconceptions about the safety of treated water run deep. The National SRTW Framework as well as the reuse policies for Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand have chosen to call treated water *Apna Jal* (our water), signalling something that no document can fully capture: that the shift India needs is not just infrastructural but psychological.

Experts working with State governments are witnessing a quiet shift in thinking – that the safe reuse of treated water is not just a policy consideration but a strategic imperative. Yet, several States remain on the sidelines. States that have not yet adopted a clear plan for water security through reuse are not just falling behind, they are running out of time to catch up.

Nepal disaster a grim reminder to rethink preparedness

The flash floods in Nepal have made it imperative for countries to be better prepared for natural disasters that are becoming unpredictable and frequent

DATA POINT

Sambavi Parthasarathy

The dire human and economic cost of the catastrophic flash floods in Nepal on August 26, serves as a stark reminder to countries of the urgent need to strengthen their disaster resilience and preparedness.

Nepal, which bore the brunt of the latest glacial collapse, was already identified as being increasingly vulnerable to Glacial Lake Outburst Floods (GLOFs). As per the UN Development Program, the country had experienced 26 GLOF events since the 1970s. Data show that the world has lost over 9,500 gigatonnes of its glacier mass since 1975 (**Chart 1**). Several mountain ranges in the Himalayan region such as Central Himalaya (which includes Nepal and India's Uttarakhand) have recorded over 20% decline in glacier area in three decades (**Chart 2**).

With natural disasters becoming frequent (**Chart 3**), it is imperative for governments to assess and be better prepared for disasters. Just this month, Indonesia witnessed a 7.7 magnitude earthquake, China battled typhoons, and several European countries combated wildfires.

Massive death tolls aside, they displace millions of people (**Chart 4**). Further, the economic cost of damages spans several billions (**Chart 5**). Nepal's Finance Minister told *Reuters* that the country would require about \$4 billion to \$5 billion to rebuild, nearly a tenth of their economy.

Climate change impacts countries disproportionately. An assessment of vulnerability (exposure, sensitivity, and ability to adapt) and readiness (ability to leverage investments to adaptation actions) of countries show that several low- and lower-middle income countries remain highly vulnerable and less ready to deal with such disasters (**Table 1**).

Stark warning

The data for charts were sourced from Our World in Data, EM-DAT, International Centre for Integrated Mountain Development (ICIMOD)'s "Changing Dynamics of Glaciers in the Hindu Kush Himalayan Region 1990–2020", Notre Dame Global Adaptation Initiative scores (2024) and Copernicus Climate Change Service (C3S)

CHART 1: Annual change in glacier mass globally. Figures in gigatonnes

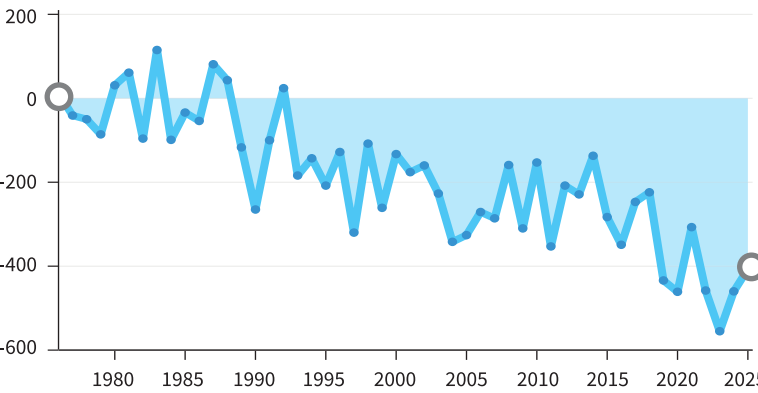


CHART 2: Changes in glacier area between 1990 and 2020 across mountain ranges in the Hindu Kush Himalaya region, as mentioned in ICIMOD's report. Figures in %

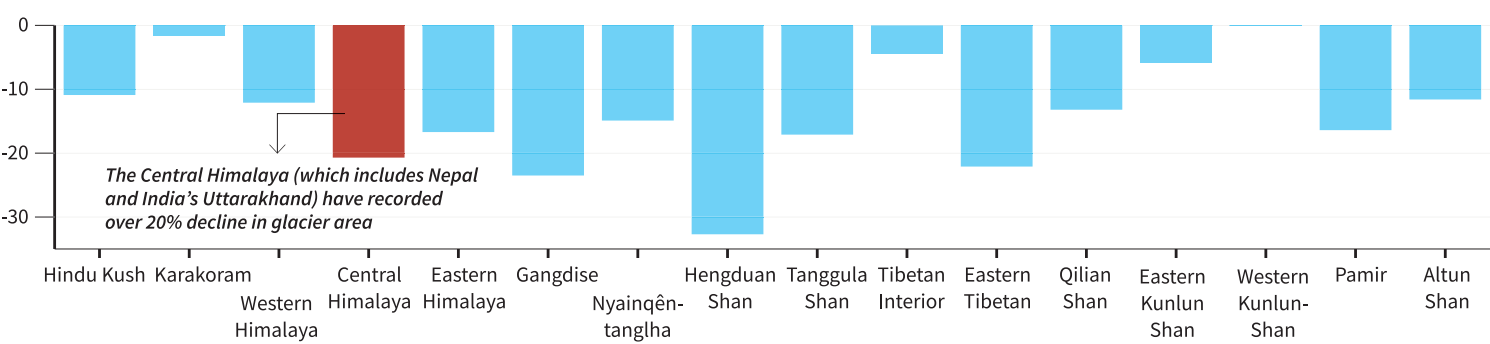


CHART 3: Reported number of natural disasters across the world since 1990

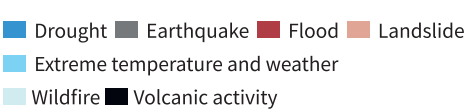


CHART 4: People displaced internally due to natural disasters each year. Figures in million

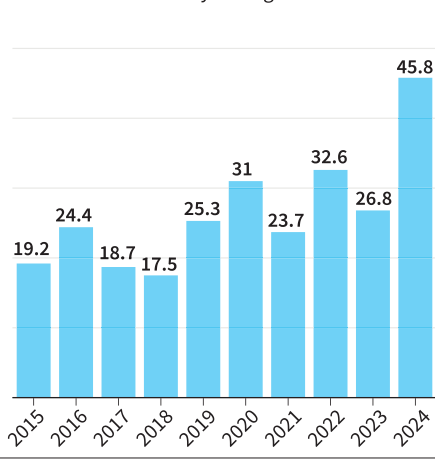
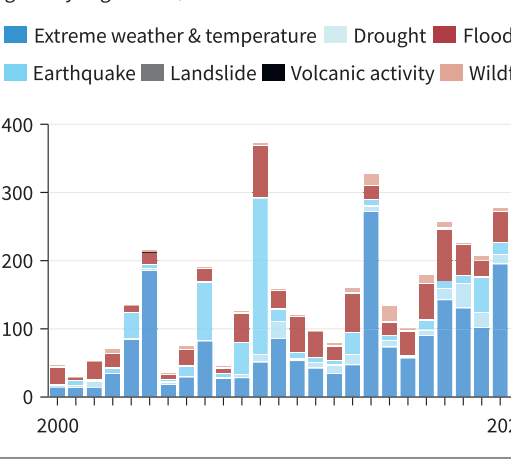


CHART 5: Economic damage caused by natural disasters globally. Figures in \$ billion



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu

FIFTY YEARS AGO AUGUST 31, 1976

China supports India for Security Council seat

New Delhi, August 30: The Chinese Ambassador-designate, Mr. Chen Chao Yusu, is expected to arrive in Delhi in the next two weeks and present his credentials well before October 1 to make his first public appearance at the Embassy's national day reception.

As a happy augury to the restoration of Ambassador-level representation, China has fallen in line with the rest of the Asian Group in the United Nations in supporting India's candidature for one of the two Asian seats on the Security Council to be vacated by Japan on completion of its two-year term.

At the Asian Group meeting in New York on August 16, which incidentally was presided over by the Bangladesh representative, China went along with the other members in supporting Japan's suggestion that India should be nominated for this seat. The other two countries in the field, the Philippines and Mongolia, withdrew in India's favour after several countries spoke in support of its candidature.

In accordance with the normal practice, the Bangladesh Chairman of the 34-member Asian Group has formally notified the other regional groups of its decision to nominate India.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO AUGUST 31, 1926

The right of pathway bill

Mr. Saldanha presented the report of the Select Committee on the Bill to amend the Madras District Municipalities Act 1920 and moved that the Bill be taken into consideration at once. He said that the right of public pathway should be given to all classes in respect of roads and streets maintained at the expense of the municipality. The principles of this Bill were the same as the principles of Mr. Veerian's Bill.

Some of the members opposed the motion on the ground that the Bill as amended was not received by them in time and pointed out that material alterations had been made by the Select Committee and asked the President not to suspend the operation of the Standing Order.

The Chief Minister admitted that there had been a change and left the question to be decided by the President. The Hon. Mr. Marjoribanks wished to know if the Bill in its present form had received the previous sanction of the Governor-General.

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Rehabilitation centres in Mizoram for drug addicts

48 Mizoram has 48 centres and homes providing care and rehabilitation services to 5,224 people affected by drug addiction, officials said on Sunday. The State government provided ₹42 lakh as financial assistance to these centres and homes. PTI

Number of doctors to be recruited by Himachal govt.

650 Speaking at the inauguration of a health camp, Himachal Pradesh CM Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu said that the government is going to recruit 300 medical officers, 200 specialist doctors and 150 super-specialist doctors. PTI

Heat-related deaths seen in Austria in June and July

646 Austria saw its highest-ever recorded number of heat-related deaths this June and July, the country's health agency said on Sunday. The AGES agency said those two months saw 646 heat-related deaths. AFP

Amount sanctioned by J&K govt. to repair migrant flats

82 in ₹ crore. The Jammu and Kashmir government has approved a ₹82.45-crore repair project for 5,000 flats across Jammu's migrant camps. Public Works Department officials said that repair and renovation would be taken up soon. PTI

People aboard ferry that capsized off coast of northern Cyprus

267 At least seven people have died after a ferry carrying at least 267 passengers and crew capsized off the coast of northern Cyprus on Sunday, Turkish media reported. AP
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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OBC creamy layer and the income test

Why is the Centre finding the ruling difficult to implement? What exactly did the Supreme Court rule on the creamy layer? Why is the Centre seeking clarification? What are its concerns over implementing the ruling? What happens next in the creamy layer case?

EXPLAINER

Abhinay Lakshman

The story so far:

The Supreme Court has said it will consider setting up a Bench to hear the Centre's application seeking clarification over its March 11 judgment on the income test component of the OBC creamy layer exclusion criteria. Retrospectively implementing the judgment on the income/wealth test for OBC creamy layer determination is "extremely difficult" and will cause a "cascading effect" in the settled services from 2012 till now, with the impact extending to "all categories, including the Unreserved category", the Centre said in a batch of applications.

Why does the Centre call the ruling 'extremely difficult' to implement?

The Supreme Court on March 11 delivered its judgment in a batch of cases pending for close to a decade, relating to how the Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT) should interpret the crucial income/wealth test, which is one of the layers through which the "creamy layer" (or relatively socially and economically forward) among the Other Backward Classes communities is excluded from availing the benefit of reservation.

The cases that eventually came before the court involved claims by at least 50 OBC candidates who had appeared in Civil Services Examinations (CSE) since 2015 and were excluded from consideration for an OBC-reserved post after the DoPT classified them as part of the creamy layer solely based on their parents' income.

The Supreme Court found that the DoPT was incorrectly applying the income test for this category of OBC candidates and directed the government to create supernumerary posts for the OBC candidates to whom the income test had been applied with what it called "hostile discrimination," and allot them services according to their ranks in their respective CSE years.

What are the criteria for exclusion?

The creamy layer concept among OBCs emerged from the Supreme Court's 1992 ruling in the *Indra Sawhney* case, which paved the way for the implementation of OBC reservations. The idea was to exclude OBC candidates whose families had accumulated social and economic privileges over the years from the benefits of reservation. Such candidates came to be described as belonging to the "creamy layer".

To clarify which categories of OBC candidates would fall under the creamy layer, the DoPT issued an Office Memorandum [(OM), a guiding charter] in September 1993, laying down the criteria for exclusion.

The OM prescribed several categories of exclusion, including children of senior constitutional, judicial, government and armed forces officers.

Besides this, the DoPT also prescribed a crucial income or wealth test, applicable to people in the salaried professional class or engaged in trade; people holding plantations, vacant land and/or buildings in urban areas; and people whose parents held posts in Central or State PSUs where the equivalence of these posts with government service posts had not yet been established. It is this last category, that is, children of parents holding posts in Central or State PSUs or in private employment, that the court delivered its March 11 judgment.



GETTY IMAGES

What was the problem with the 1993 OM and 2004 letter?

Under the 1993 DoPT OM on the income/wealth test for OBC reservations, a candidate would be considered part of the creamy layer if their parents' gross family income exceeded the prescribed limit for three consecutive years, or if they possessed wealth above the exemption limit prescribed under the Wealth Tax Act, 1957. The income limit, which was ₹1 lakh when the 1993 OM was issued, was revised several times and now stands at ₹8 lakh, with the last revision having come in 2017. Importantly, the 1993 DoPT OM specified that income from salaries and agricultural land should be excluded when applying the income/wealth test, with income from other sources such as property, business, or capital gains being considered.

However, in October 2004, the DoPT issued a letter meant to clarify issues that had arisen in interpreting the 1993 OM. In paragraph 9 of this letter, the DoPT took up the issue of how to calculate income for the income/wealth test for OBCs whose parents were in Central or State PSUs where equivalence of posts had not yet been established. The DoPT seemed to suggest that income from salaries was to be counted to determine if the income was above the prescribed threshold for three consecutive years. The threshold was subsequently revised to ₹8 lakh per year in 2017.

In the 2026 ruling, the Division Bench noted that until the government establishes equivalence between the posts of Central or State PSUs and government services, the income/wealth test must continue to apply equally.

How did the Supreme Court interpret the income test?

The March 11 *Union of India vs Rohith Nathan* judgment said that OBC candidates whose parents work in PSUs or the private sector, where the government has yet to establish equivalence of posts with government services, cannot be treated differently from OBC candidates in other categories under the creamy layer exclusion criteria.

Significantly, the Supreme Court ruled that the income/wealth test component of the exclusion exercise must be seen and operated as a "residual filter", adding that salaries and agricultural incomes had been consciously left out while applying this test under the 1993 OM. The court found that while the 1993 OM was clear about excluding income from salaries from the calculation of the income/wealth test, the 2004 letter appeared to call for its inclusion in circumstances that were

not clearly specified.

The court went on to note that the interpretation of the 1993 OM, read with the 2004 letter, had led to "hostile discrimination" between the children of those in government service and those in PSUs or private employment.

Without establishing equivalence of posts, the income test, including salaries, was being applied to rule out OBC candidates whose parents were not in government service, while OBC candidates whose parents were in government service were being subjected to a test that did not include salaries. This is what the court had described as "hostile discrimination".

The court said, "Treating the children of those employed in PSUs or private employment, etc., as being excluded from the benefit of reservation only on the basis of their income derived from salaries, and without reference to their posts (whether Group A or B, or Group C or D) would certainly lead to hostile discrimination between parties who are similarly placed and would amount to equals being treated unequally."

The court had directed the Centre to implement this reading of the income test within six months by creating supernumerary posts for the petitioners, who were OBC candidates in the Civil Services Examinations and had been excluded from the creamy layer on account of their parents' salaries alone. The parents were working in public sector undertakings or the private sector.

Did the Centre try to implement the Supreme Court's directions?

The Supreme Court's ruling in the *Rohith Nathan* case was a watershed moment for this category of OBCs, who had said that the issue had been pending for more than a decade. As per the Supreme Court's direction, the Union government was supposed to issue further instructions in pursuance of the court's reading of the income test component – on how the supernumerary posts must be created and how the existing strength of the services must be adjusted to accommodate them.

According to government records, the Union Ministry of Personnel, Pensions and Public Grievances wrote to the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment on June 3, seeking advice on implementing the directions of the *Rohith Nathan* judgment. The Personnel Ministry told the Social Justice Secretary that the Allocation of Business Rules provide for the Social Justice Ministry to formulate policy on reservations and that it was therefore seeking

"clarification/action" in this regard. The Personnel Ministry further sought "advice on instructions to be adopted or notified" by the DoPT.

As of August 19, the Centre's position before the Central Administrative Tribunal in a matter identical to that of the aggrieved OBC candidates in the *Rohith Nathan* case was that it was in the process of implementing the March 11 judgment.

However, a few days later, the DoPT filed an application highlighting why it was seemingly impossible to follow the Supreme Court's directions and the issues that were arising in implementing them retrospectively. In this application, the Centre said that despite its efforts to create the supernumerary posts as called for in the *Rohith Nathan* judgment, it was facing an increasing number of claims for adjustment, issues of seniority arising from such adjustments, and concerns that even this exercise could be "unfair" to a different category of OBC candidates and candidates of "all categories, including the unreserved category".

The Centre noted that since the March 11 judgment, 22 other judgments have been issued by courts applying the principles laid out in *Rohith Nathan*. In addition, the DoPT said that 12 new cases have been filed seeking reconsideration of OBC non-creamy layer status under the Rohith Nathan principles, by candidates who had not previously approached the courts.

However, OBC candidates who spoke to *The Hindu* argued that the Centre's reluctance to implement the directions does not appear to make sense. These candidates have asked why the DoPT had not mentioned these larger issues with implementation earlier.

These candidates have noted that the older reading of the income test – the one that the court said practised "hostile discrimination" – was being applied only by the DoPT, and that too arbitrarily.

What happens next?

Along with the application that the DoPT has filed setting out the difficulties it was facing in implementing the *Rohith Nathan* judgment's directions, especially retrospectively, the Union government had filed a separate application, seeking that it be allowed to continue allotting services as per the old reading of the income test for CSE 2025 candidates, and seeking clarification on how to implement the directions. The Centre said that more than 950 CSE 2025 candidates were about to start their Foundation Course and that they had been recommended based on the old reading of the income test.

The DoPT argued, in this application, that the retrospective application of the judgment was specifically running into the issues mentioned above.

The Supreme Court has now said it will consider setting up a Bench to hear the Centre's request for clarification on how to implement its directions and its request to allow the allotment of services to CSE 2025 candidates to continue as settled for the time being.

However, in the other application filed along with this, the Centre has asked for clarification on how to implement the direction overall. It has further argued that there might be some value in including income from salaries, as in some cases it might be the "sole intelligible differentia" between two OBC candidates from "similar social backgrounds". It has also argued that, in the absence of salary consideration, some cases might lead to OBC candidates with parents earning up to ₹1 crore being considered non-creamy layer.

Now, the question is: how far will the Supreme Court's March 11 verdict reach?

THE GIST

The Supreme Court's March 11 ruling held that salary income should not be used to exclude OBC candidates from the creamy layer where their parents work in PSUs or private employment without established equivalence of posts with government service.

The Centre says retrospective implementation could have a 'cascading effect' on settled services, while triggering fresh claims from candidates who were previously denied OBC non-creamy-layer status.

The Supreme Court will consider setting up a Bench to hear the Centre's plea for clarification on implementing the ruling, including its application to CSE 2025 candidates.

CACHE



Even without Meta’s new controls, parents and educators can work with children to fight social media addiction. REUTERS

Can Meta’s safety controls make Facebook and Instagram less addictive for teens?

Meta has agreed to an \$18-billion settlement with U.S. states and will introduce stricter controls for teen users; but enforcing these safeguards could prove difficult as children can evade age checks, while the measures also raise concerns over privacy and the role of rival platforms

Sahana Venugopal

The story so far: On August 26, Meta agreed to an approximately \$18 billion settlement with dozens of U.S. states in annual instalments over 10 years, and announced stricter controls in its apps for teen users. The settlement is the culmination of a lawsuit brought by California and 28 other U.S. states alleging that Facebook and Instagram are harmful for children and that they illegally collect personal data. While several parents and child health advocates welcomed the new child protection controls, enforcing them will be a lot more challenging.

What child protections is Meta rolling out? The social media giant is both rolling out new features and building on existing features designed to create a safer and less addictive experience for Facebook and Instagram users under 18. These measures are set to automatically apply in participating U.S. states and territories. 52 attorneys general covering U.S. states, territories, and the District of Columbia have joined the agreement.

Arguably, the biggest win for parents and the biggest concession by Meta is a default two-hour daily time limit across Facebook and Instagram. Teens can only turn this off with a parent’s permission. Furthermore, a ‘Night Mode’ will block app users between 12 AM and 6 AM, so teens cannot post or view their Feed, Stories, Reels, or the Explore section. Similarly, the School Mode between 8 AM

and 3 PM will mute notifications by default. However, these limits do not apply to direct messages (DMs). Teens are set to receive multiple prompts after every 15 minutes of continuous screen time on Facebook/Instagram, apart from prompts that come after their total daily usage reaches 60 minutes and 90 minutes. To directly address addictive video features, Meta is giving teens (and their parents) the ability to choose a non-algorithmic feed as their default, as well as the ability to turn off Autoplay. As for ways to combat unhealthy comparisons and anxiety over appearances and popularity, teen users will no longer see the number of likes and reactions on posts by default. Meta is also expanding its policy to block teens from using “extreme makeup filters,” adding to a previous block against cosmetic surgery filters for teens. Meta reaffirmed its commitment to strengthening existing controls in order to catch underage account users, as well as teens falsely entering adult birthdays. The company claimed it will continue placing teens into private accounts on Instagram and activating private default settings on Facebook, apart from restricting “potentially suspicious adults” from reaching out to them. Meta also said it would encourage parents to set up its supervision tools, and give them new controls and insights.

Can these safety controls be effectively enforced? This is the crux of the matter. Safety controls for teens work only as well as the technology that verifies users’ ages and

detects rule-breakers. Take Australia, for example; the country was the first to enforce a strict blanket ban on social media for children under 16. While many parents lauded the idea and Meta reported this month that it removed over 750,000 accounts that it suspected were held by under-16s, a study by the University of Newcastle there reported that the ban did not appear to have significantly impacted under-16s who were using social media. As other platforms and administrations explore age restrictions, critics have pointed out how easily children can fake their ages – even in video selfies and live camera tests. What’s more, these data collection tactics raise additional questions about how children’s private information is being harvested. In its settlement announcement, Meta pointed out that all platforms – and not just its apps – should have teen safety measures in place to prevent children from moving to less restricted apps. So as to not be held back in isolation, Meta called on rival social media apps YouTube and TikTok to adopt the “new standard.” Meta stated that around 30% of its settlement, or \$5.3 billion, would be released only after rival apps YouTube and TikTok implement similar controls and pay a stipulated amount of money. To sweeten the deal, Meta said that if industry peers signed the agreement, it would further reduce the daily limit to one hour per app and expand night mode limits. In other words, this increases the incentive for U.S. regulators to also bring Meta’s rivals in line with the new policies. Separately, the social media giant said it supported laws requiring app stores to

verify users’ age and obtain parental approval before teens can download an app. This shifts the responsibility of age verification to companies such as Apple and Google.

How can parents elsewhere make Facebook, Instagram less addictive? Even without Meta’s new controls, parents and educators can work with children to fight social media addiction. Most smartphones come with built-in parental controls that allow adults to set time limits for individual apps, as well as curtail overall device use. Furthermore, many of Meta’s existing safety controls – such as Teen Accounts on Instagram – can be used by children across borders who enter their ages correctly. For more advanced settings, adults can research and download parental control apps that allow them to set up different usage limits for multiple children and monitor their activity remotely. Some apps allow parents to remotely lock devices and apps during sleeping hours and/or school hours. Meanwhile, teachers can communicate with their students via email, or send alerts through non-addictive digital forums during daytime hours. Students should be strongly discouraged from conducting school assignments or group projects via social media apps. Enabling parental controls for teen social media users is a constantly evolving challenge. After all, these young internet and AI-native users are often more tech-savvy than the very adults trying to restrict their time online

THE DAILY QUIZ

A quiz on Malaysia which is celebrating its Independence Day on August 31

V.V. Ramanan

QUESTION 1 Malaysians celebrate ‘Hari Merdeka’ on August 31 to commemorate the independence of the Federation of Malaya from British rule. On what date do they celebrate Malaysia Day, which marks the formation of Malaysia?

QUESTION 2 What is the monarch, who is elected from nine hereditary Malay Rulers for a five-year term, called and who is the present ruler?

QUESTION 3 If the Indian currency notes carry the image of Mahatma Gandhi, whose portrait is

featured on the Malaysian Ringgit?

QUESTION 4 Name the famous archipelago with 99 islands and geological formations that became Malaysia’s first UNESCO Global Geopark.

QUESTION 5 Name the Malaysian-born actress who became the first Asian woman to win the Best Actress Oscar in 2023.

QUESTION 6 In which sport did Nicol David win a record eight World Open titles between 2005 and 2014?

QUESTION 7 Which Bornean primate is known for its large, pendulous nose in males?



Visual Question: Name the place where this famous statue of Lord Muruga is located. AFP

Questions and Answers to the previous day’s daily quiz: 1. In politics, he was the first PM of his newly independent country while she became the first woman President of the UN General Assembly in 1953. Name the famous siblings. **Ans: Jawaharlal Nehru and Vijayalakshmi Pandit** 2. This famous 1807 work that narrated the works of a famous English playwright was authored by a brother-sister duo. Name them and the work. **Ans: Charles and Mary Lamb’s ‘Tales of Shakespeare’** 3. According to historians, Ptolemy XIII and Ptolemy XIV were consorts and ruled alongside their sister, who is considerably more famous and legendary than the two men. Name her. **Ans: Cleopatra** 4. In later Ramayana traditions, what was the name of Rama’s elder sister. **Ans: Shanta, wife of Rishyasyringa** 5. Name the Russian siblings who have not only won titles at a tennis Major but are the only brother and sister to reach the No.1 ranking in singles. **Ans: Marat Safin and Dinara Safina** 6. The National Bravery awards given by the Indian government are named after two teenagers who were murdered in 1978. Name the two. **Ans: Geeta and Sanjay Chopra** 7. In Greek myth, name the twins born to Zeus and Leto. **Ans: Apollo and Artemis** Visual: Name these siblings who have also won Oscars apart from the Grammys and other leading awards. **Ans: Billie Eilish and Finneas O’Connell** **Early Birds:** Siddhartha Viswanathan | Tamal Biswas | Sukdev Shet | Piyali Tuli | Arun Kumar Singh



KNOW YOUR ENGLISH

No amount of rest could ease her fatigue

The children were tired after their two-hour trek

S. Upendran

What is the difference between ‘fatigue’ and ‘tired’? (S Jayanthi, Mysore) There is a tendency among some people to use the two words interchangeably – especially in informal contexts. It is wrong to do so. Of the two, ‘tired’ is the more frequently used. When we say we are tired, what we mean is that we are running low on energy. We all get tired from time to time – for example, after playing a couple of sets of tennis, after a long day’s work, etc. We don’t panic when this happens because we know why we are tired. We can overcome our tiredness either by eating something that will give us the energy back or by getting some rest - a good night’s sleep, perhaps! The lack of energy that we experience when we are tired is only temporary. *The children were extremely tired after trekking for two hours. You look very tired. Get some rest before tomorrow’s big game.*

It is possible for one to be both physically and mentally tired. ‘Fatigue’ is a little more serious than being tired. Unlike ‘tired’, it is not a temporary phenomenon. One can feel fatigued for days together; it is long-lasting, and what is more alarming is that we may not always know the cause. It could be your diabetes or your heart condition that leaves you fatigued. No amount of rest helps in the recovery, and the constant tiredness often prevents you from doing your work. It interferes with your daily routine. This constant fatigue is your body’s way of telling you that something is wrong. *Is something wrong? You’ve been looking fatigued for a week now.* The word consists of two syllables; the ‘a’ in the first sounds like the ‘a’ in ‘china’, while the following ‘i’ is like the ‘ee’ in ‘fee’, ‘bee’ and ‘see’. The word is pronounced ‘fe-TEEG’ with the stress on the second syllable.

Why do we say ‘litter of puppies’ and ‘litter of kittens’? (L Rachna, Secunderabad) Today, when we hear the word ‘litter’, the first thing that comes to mind is the trash we see everywhere in our cities. This meaning of the word, however, came much later. ‘Litter’ comes from the Latin ‘lectus’ meaning ‘bed’, and it was originally used to refer to the portable chair or bed carried on poles – in the past, royals like Julius Caesar and Cleopatra used to be carried from one place to another in these. With the passage of time, the meaning of the word took on a broader meaning, and soon ‘litter’ began to be used to refer to any kind of bed – including the layer of straw that owners sometimes spread on the floor when their pet cat or dog was ready to give birth. It was not long after that the focus changed from the bed to the newborn that were lying on the bed. The animals born to the same mother around the same time began to be called a litter. The term is normally used with animals which give birth to several offspring – dogs, cats, pigs, etc. *Manisha’s dog gave birth to a litter of seven puppies.* upendrankye@gmail.com

Word of the day

Compeer: a person who is of equal standing with another in a group

Synonyms: associate, colleague, accomplice, peer

Usage: She was respected by her compeers for her expertise.

Pronunciation: newsth.live/compeer

International Phonetic Alphabet: /kɒmpɪə/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject ‘Text & Context’

From Page One

India and Uzbekistan agree on uranium deal

A joint statement said they agreed to expand cooperation in field of critical minerals through the implementation of joint projects in geological exploration, mining, mineral processing, and the development of integrated value chains.

On trade and investment, he said issues relating to market access, banking, payment systems and connectivity will be addressed in a structured way. “The close defence and security cooperation between our two countries reflects our deep mutual trust. In the future, we will promote direct linkages, co-production, and co-development between our defence industries,” Mr. Modi said. “We believe that terrorism, extremism, and separatism pose serious challenges to the entire region.”

A Letter of Intent for the restoration and conservation of the Buddhist sites of Fayaz Tepa and Kara Tepa in Uzbekistan was also agreed upon. These ancient Buddhist monasteries in southern Uzbekistan highlight how Buddhism spread along the Silk Road and flourished in Central Asia.

The two sides announced a commercial pact was firmed up between NPCI International Payments Ltd (NIPL) and Uzbekistan’s National Inter-bank Processing Centre JSC to enable UPI apps of India to scan Uzbekistan’s national QR (UZQR) for making merchant payments in the Central Asian nation. The announcements included a grant of \$1 million for afforestation in the Aral Sea region.

788 dead, over 2,500 still missing in Nepal

Authorities also began mass burials of unidentified bodies in Chitwan, around 200 km from Rasuwa, on Saturday after collecting DNA samples so that the remains can be exhumed if the victims are identified. Madan Lama, an information officer at the District Administration Office in Chitwan, said around 170 bodies had been buried since Saturday, including 96 on the first day, after collecting DNA samples.

An Indian forensic team specialising in DNA testing and analysis arrived to support health officials in collecting samples.

India’s External Affairs Ministry said in New Delhi on Saturday that more than 275 Indians and 128 persons of Indian origin remained missing. On Sunday, it shared a list of 149 people who were rescued. The Nepal Tourism Board said 591 foreign nationals remain missing and 289 have been rescued, including 180 Indian and 89 Chinese nationals.

Earlier on Sunday, authorities warned of possible fresh flooding and urged residents in affected districts to remain on high alert as water levels rose in the Bhotekoshi River.

Prakash Pokharel, a geologist and researcher at the National Disaster Risk Reduction Management Authority, said flood warnings had been sent to people’s phones. He said the immediate risk later eased after the rain receded and a barrier lake that had formed in Gyirong county in Tibet fully drained.

The flood, triggered by a glacial collapse, left hundreds missing on the Tibet side, where Chinese authorities reported 16 deaths and 546 people unaccounted for. It remains unclear whether some of those missing on the Chinese side are Nepali citizens. Asked about the status of Nepali citizens in the disaster-hit area of Tibet, Mr. Rai said China has provided a list that will be updated.

The disaster had struck on Wednesday when a glacial collapse near the Nepal-China border in Rasuwa district triggered a massive surge of water, mud and debris through the Bhotekoshi and Trishuli river systems.

‘Hindutva does not envision a Bharat without Muslims’

A person who believes Muslims have no place in the country would cease to be a Hindu, says RSS chief at New York event; he says RSS service activities do not discriminate on the basis of religion

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

Rashtriya Swayam-sevak Sangh (RSS) chief Mohan Bhagwat on Saturday said that Hindutva does not envisage a Bharat without Muslims, asserting that a person who believes Muslims should have no place in the country would cease to be a Hindu.

Addressing an event in New York City, where he spoke with leaders from different communities and religions, Mr. Bhagwat said that Muslims, during a dialogue with him, had questioned him about the RSS’s vision of a “Hindu Rashtra” and whether Muslims would be driven out of the country. “I said ‘no’, that is not Hindutva. If any Hindu thinks that there should be no Muslims in Bharat, he will not remain Hindu,” he said.

Mr. Bhagwat stressed that while people may follow different religions, humanity remains one. “We live in a society where religions may be different, but humanity is one,” he said, adding that India’s tradi-



Faith forum: Mohan Bhagwat attends the ‘Universal Oneness celebration’ at New York’s Madison Square Garden on Saturday. PTI

tion had been to provide shelter to people irrespective of their religious identity.

He also cited the RSS’s service activities to underline his claim that the organisation does not discriminate on the basis of religion. According to him, around 1.3 lakh service projects are being run by RSS volunteers with the help of the public.

Recalling an incident in Dadri, Haryana, where two aircraft from Muslim-majority countries collided, Mr. Bhagwat said RSS volunteers were among the

first to reach the site. As all passengers had died, the volunteers helped arrange funerals and assisted relatives in identifying the victims, he said.

Talks with minorities
He said the organisation’s approach was rooted in the belief that “we” and “ours” should replace the narrow focus on “me” and “mine”. “Where there is ‘me’ and ‘mine’, there is no solution. ‘We’ and ‘ours’ is the solution,” he said.

Mr. Bhagwat also referred to the RSS’s dialogue with members of minority

communities, saying that the organisation had begun engaging more extensively with Muslims and Christians in Bharat after 2018. “Dialogue is the first step, and service is another step,” he said.

Invoking the example of Ramakrishna Paramahansa, the RSS chief said the spiritual teacher had practised different religious traditions, including Islam and Christianity. He quoted him as saying: “As many ways, as many thoughts. All lead to one way.”

Mr. Bhagwat said the idea of the unity of humanity was embedded in India’s traditional thought as well as in the Constitution. He argued that social change could not be achieved through politics alone and called for local initiatives based on selfless service, dialogue and unity.

“Things cannot be achieved through politics alone. Sorry to say, but the fact is that politics has now become a game of self-interest. Our experience in India is that we have to start with society, and we have started it,” he said.

Govt. plans to wrap up trade agreement with Chile this year

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

India is committed to concluding a “balanced and mutually beneficial” trade deal with Chile this year, the Commerce and Industry Ministry said following a meeting between Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal and Chile’s Vice-Minister of International Economic Relations Paula Estévez Weinstein.

The meeting took place on August 26 in Santiago, Chile, to advance negotiations on the India-Chile Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA). India and Chile had started negotiations last May following the signing of the Terms of Reference on May 8, 2025.

“India remains committed to concluding the CEPA negotiations within this year, with the aim of delivering a balanced and mutually beneficial framework that provides equitable and commercially meaningful outcomes for businesses on both sides,” the Ministry said on Sunday.

India’s exports to Chile stood at \$1.2 billion in 2025-26, up about 5.8% from the previous year. Im-

Both sides stressed the importance of building on the growing India-Chile relationship

ports from Chile, on the other hand, stood at \$5 billion – 93% higher than in 2024-25.

“The shared identity of India and Chile as members of the Global South, along with their common strategic vision, provides a strong foundation for deepening bilateral economic cooperation and advancing shared prosperity,” the Ministry said.

Both sides emphasised the importance of building on the strong and growing India-Chile relationship and ensuring that the CEPA translates into “concrete and commercially meaningful” opportunities for businesses on both sides.

“The Commerce Secretary highlighted the immense potential for enhanced economic cooperation in sectors including healthcare, pharmaceuticals, energy, minerals, agriculture, machinery and engineering,” the statement said.

Three, including two police officials, injured in Patna encounter

Amit Bhelari
PATNA

A suspect and two police officials were injured during an encounter between the police and criminals along the Son river in Patna early on Sunday. The clash occurred during an operation targeting individuals extorting local boatmen, the police said.

While one of the criminals sustained a gunshot injury in his leg, a Sub-Inspector was injured after a bullet hit his arm and a Station House Officer sustained head injury.

A total of 62 rounds were fired during the confrontation, according to Patna Senior Superintendent of Police (SSP) Kartikey Kumar Sharma. “On August 30, the police re-

ceived information about illegal mining during which boatmen were being intimidated and extorted. Following this, a special police team was formed,” he said. “When the police team signalled the suspected criminals, who were heading by boat to collect travelling money, to stop, they opened fire on the police.”

The injured criminal has been admitted to Patna Medical College and Hospital, the SSP said.

In the operation, a large quantity of illegal weapons and cartridges were recovered, including three country-made pistols, one rifle, one country-made carbine and 25 live cartridges. “Further probe is being conducted by the police,” Mr. Sharma said.

PM pays tribute at Shastri Memorial, plants tree with Uzbekistan President

Press Trust of India
TASHKENT

Prime Minister Narendra Modi paid floral tributes at the Shastri Memorial in Uzbekistan’s capital on Sunday, honouring the legacy of former Prime Minister Lal Bahadur Shastri by planting a tree along with Uzbek President Shavkat Mirziyoyev.

Shastri, India’s second Prime Minister, died in the Uzbek capital on January 11, 1966, just hours after signing the historic Tashkent Declaration to end the 1965 India-Pakistan War.

His “timeless call of ‘Jai Jawan, Jai Kisan’ continues to inspire generations,” the External Affairs Ministry said, adding that his life “embodied simplicity, courage and unwavering devotion to the nation.”



In homage: Prime Minister Narendra Modi pays floral tributes to Lal Bahadur Shastri at the memorial in Tashkent on Sunday. ANI

Mr. Modi and Mr. Mirziyoyev also jointly planted a tree in the Presidential Palace garden under India’s *Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam* initiative and Uzbekistan’s ‘*Yashil Makon*’ green efforts, the Ministry said in a post on X. “The gesture reflects the shared commit-

ment of India and Uzbekistan towards nurturing a greener and more sustainable future,” it said.

The tree-planting ceremony came after the Prime Minister held delegation-level talks with the Uzbek President at the Kukсарой Presidential Palace as part

of his two-day state visit to Uzbekistan. The two countries agreed to elevate their bilateral Strategic Partnership to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership, setting a bilateral trade target of \$5 billion by 2030.

Uzbek honour to Modi
Mr. Mirziyoyev also conferred Uzbekistan’s highest honour for foreign leaders, the Oliy Darajali Do’sstlik Order, on Mr. Modi for his contribution to strengthening the friendship between the nations. Earlier in the day, he attended a yoga session by the Yoga Federation of Uzbekistan and met members of the Indian diaspora.

Later, Mr. Modi arrived in Kyrgyzstan, where he is to attend the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation summit.

Punjab govt. staff demand the withdrawal of notices over strike, plan mass leave on Sept. 8

Press Trust of India
LUDHIANA

The protesting State government staff, under the banner of the Punjab Sanjha Mulazam Manch Committee, on Sunday decided to intensify their agitation and go on mass leave on September 8 if notices issued to them over the recent Statewide strike are not withdrawn. The move follows a meeting of the bodies representing the protesting employees in Ludhiana. After a three-hour discussion, it was decided that if their demands are not met, they will go on two-day mass casual leave again on October 21-22.

The committee has given the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) government time till September 7 to withdraw the show-cause notices seeking explanation for “unauthorised” absence on the day of the strike. Earlier, in a letter to all administrative secretaries and heads of departments,



Over 3 lakh government staff went on a Statewide strike on August 27 to press the AAP government to accept their demands, including release of pending dearness allowance, affecting public services. ANI

the State Personnel Department directed notices be issued to those staff who remained “unauthorised absent” and ensure disciplinary action against them as per rules.

Over 3 lakh government employees went on strike by taking mass casual leave on August 27. Over 3.50 lakh pensioners also participated in the strike. The protesters have been demanding the release of pending 18% dearness allowance, implementation of the Old Pension Scheme

and regularisation of contractual employees.

The unions unveiled a campaign titled ‘Return of the Chief Minister from Chandigarh Secretariat to Satoj Village (CM Bhagwant Mann’s native village)’, symbolising the demand to push the CM out of the Secretariat until their demands are met.

More protests planned
At the meeting, it was decided to gherao the native residences of AAP Ministers and MLAs on Septem-

ber 12-13. The residences of the remaining Ministers and AAP MLAs will be gheraoed on September 19-20. They said the stir will be peaceful even if barricades are installed to stop them.

Replying to a question, the leaders said the Punjab government should not issue show-cause notices or deduct one day’s salary of employees who participated in last week’s strike.

The leaders announced that on September 30, they will hold an ‘Employees’ Assembly’ and invite MLAs of all 117 constituencies, as well as the 13 Lok Sabha MPs of the State, to Chandigarh to clarify their stand on their issues.

The leaders also alleged that the AAP government has “fooled the people with false slogans and is making a mockery of employees’ feelings”.

A ‘Maha Rally’ will be held in Sangrur on October 10, in which thousands of employees are expected to participate, they said.

Manipur CM backs NRC, but says shutdowns not the way

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

Manipur Chief Minister Yumnam Khemchand Singh on Sunday said he favoured updating the National Register of Citizens (NRC) in the State, but insisted that shutdowns and blockades were not the way to seek the exercise.

The Campaign for Just and Fair Delimitation, an umbrella group of 14 civil society organisations, threatened a 24-hour shutdown from midnight on August 31 if the Centre did not defer the Census exercise and start the NRC process in the State. The group also said it would time its next phase of agitation with the Manipur Assembly session beginning September 2.

Diverging demands
The Meitei and Naga communities want the NRC to be updated before the Census is undertaken to weed



Urging people to adopt forms of democratic agitation, CM Yumnam Khemchand Singh warned against attempts to create disorder. ANI

out “illegal immigrants”, specifically people from across Myanmar.

The Kuki-Zo groups are against the NRC, arguing that using 1951 as its base year would be unfair to the hill tribes.

“We are committed to fulfilling the aspirations of the people of Manipur. Calling a shutdown will not serve any purpose and will instead create more hardship for the people,” the Chief Minister said in Imphal before leaving for New Delhi to meet top Cen-

tral leaders and discuss major issues, including the NRC.

Urging the Campaign for Just and Fair Delimitation and others to adopt other forms of democratic agitation, Mr. Singh warned that those who break the law or attempt to create disorder would face stringent action.

Home Minister Govindas Konthoujam said Manipur was prepared to conduct the NRC exercise within the constitutional and legal framework.

Four armed men killed in Meghalaya encounter

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

Four armed men, allegedly members of an inter-State gang, were killed in an encounter with the Meghalaya Police early on Sunday morning. The incident occurred around 4 a.m. near Songsak in East Garo Hills district, when the four opened fire upon being asked to stop at a checkpoint. The police claimed its personnel retaliated, and the four died in the exchange of fire.

One of the gang members was allegedly involved in the August 23 shooting of an Assam-based businessman.

“The bodies of the four men were taken for post-mortem. Further investigation into the incident and the criminal cases linked to the group is under way,” a Meghalaya-based police official said.

BJP chief’s ideation session focuses on Gen-Z outreach

Some leaders suggest avoiding the term ‘Gen Z’ and instead using the broader term ‘youth’ or references to specific age groups; party decides to galvanise its existing voter base and cadres

Nistula Hebbar
NEW DELHI

BJP national president Nitin Nabin’s brainstorming session on Saturday on the party’s engagement with Gen Z included suggestions to abandon the term altogether and simply refer to the cohort as the “youth”, as well as initiating a simultaneous outreach to the party’s older voters.

The meeting in New Delhi, under a youth outreach initiative headed by Mr. Nabin, was attended by around 45 young leaders with party general secretary Smriti Irani and Chhattisgarh Minister O.P. Choudhary as committee members.

According to sources, participants were invited to share their views on how the party could improve dialogue and participation among young people.

Several attendees argued that it would be incorrect to treat all young people as a homogenous, single category, stressing that different groups of youth have distinct aspira-



The meeting under the youth outreach initiative was headed by BJP national president Nitin Nabin in New Delhi. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

tions and concerns.

Sources said some participants suggested avoiding the term “Gen Z” and instead using the broader term “youth” or references to specific age groups.

The “horizontal solidarity” among the age cohort witnessed during the recent Cockroach Janta Party (CJP)-led protests over the NEET exam paper ‘leak’ was one thing, said an attendee, but that did not mean that all young people shared the same life experiences or even aspirations. “Young people in Tier-two cities and villages will have different ideas about life, their opportuni-

ties and what they think on various issues,” they said, advocating for a graded engagement with different kinds of youngsters.

A number of participants underlined the need for differentiated engagement strategies and communication methods for various categories of young people.

One participant noted that while greater engagement with the youth is essential, the party must take care that older supporters and long-time party backers do not feel neglected or sidelined. Another suggested that energising the party’s veteran workers is just

as important as expanding outreach among youth, and that efforts should also be made to strengthen cadres’ confidence in the leadership.

The 45 participants in the meeting have reportedly been divided into five or six groups. Gujarat Deputy Chief Minister Harsh Sanghavi and Chhattisgarh’s O.P. Choudhary are among those tasked with leading the groups. Participants have been asked to submit their recommendations within the next seven or eight days.

All participants have been asked to submit their recommendations within the next seven or eight days.

According to sources, the recommendations gathered from these 45 leaders will be considered for implementation in future party programmes. Preparations are also under way for youth-focused activities during the coming “Seva Sankalp Mahotsav”, which will mark 25 years of Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s public service journey.

Bihar Cong. leaders plan Delhi protest for removal of in-charge, State chief

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A group of Bihar Congress leaders has written to party president Mallikarjun Kharge, stating that they will stage a peaceful sit-in outside the party headquarters, Indira Bhavan, in New Delhi on September 8, unless the Bihar unit in-charge Krishna Allavaru and State president Rajesh Kumar are removed.

The proposed protest comes amid discontent within the Bihar Congress following its poor performance in the 2025 Assembly election, in which the party won six seats, down from 19 in 2020.

In a letter dated August 15, the workers alleged “disorder” in the Bihar Pradesh Congress Committee during the Assembly election and accused Mr. Allavaru of acting arbitrarily in the distribution of ticket.

Anand Madhab, former chairperson of the Congress Manifesto Committee for the 2020 Assembly election, said a delegation had met Mr. Kharge and other senior leaders on November 3, 2025, to raise concerns over the functioning of the State unit.



Bihar Congress national in-charge Krishna Allavaru and State president Rajesh Kumar. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

“We discussed how genuine workers were denied tickets and people from other parties got tickets. They promised to pay heed to us, but since then there has been no redress,” Mr. Madhab said.

The delegation submitted a representation to Mr. Kharge during the meeting and was assured that the complaints would be examined and action taken after the election, the letter said.

“More than 10 months have passed, and the Bihar Congress is going from bad to worse. Therefore, we are left with no other option than to protest before the headquarters,” Mr. Madhab said.

Senior Congress leader from Bihar, Kishore Kumar

Jha, supported the concerns raised by the workers, but said their grievances could be addressed through discussions. “They are dedicated Congress workers, and the party high command should listen to their grievances,” Mr. Jha said.

The protesters include former Bihar Congress vice-presidents Jamal Ahmed and Rajkumar Rajan, AICC member Nagenendra Paswan, former MLA Chhatrapati Yadav, former BPCC secretary B. Akhtar, and former MLA Anil Kumar Singh.

The signatories said their campaign was aimed at saving the party organisation in Bihar and urged the leadership to meet them before September 8.

OBC groups seek unique code for castes in Census

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A national OBC conference on Sunday demanded that the Union government make caste enumeration mandatory in the nationwide Census and assign a separate “unique code” to every caste. Conducting a Census without these measures would be a waste of public money, and the exercise should be halted until a nationwide consensus is reached on the issue, OBC leaders said.

The conference was chaired by former IAS officer and chairman of the Backward Classes Intellectual Forum T. Chiranjeevulu, and All India OBC Students Association president G. Kiran Kumar.

Without assigning a unique code to every caste, the speakers said, the Census could not be scientifically sound. “Just as separate columns are provided for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, separate columns should also be created for OBCs and the General Category,” several speakers said.

The speakers also cautioned the government that a nationwide movement could follow if their demand was ignored.

National law varsity yet to take shape in Uttarakhand

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The recent student protests at some National Law Universities (NLUs) over institutional accountability have put the spotlight on Uttarakhand, where 15 years after its Assembly approved a law to establish an NLU, the State does not have a single functional law university.

The delay stands out when compared with the two other States created in November 2000 – Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand. While Chhattisgarh established the Hidayatullah National Law University in Raipur in 2003, Jharkhand set up the National University of Study and Research in Law in Ranchi in 2010.

Former Uttarakhand Chief Minister Harish Rawat said students of the State were suffering because of the delay in setting up an NLU campus. “This issue has been caught in the BJP’s petty internal politics but students are paying a price.”

The Uttarakhand legislature passed the National Law University Act in 2011. Fifteen years later, the proposed institution has neither a permanent campus nor students. Its location has shifted repeatedly: from Bhowali in Nainital district to Pantnagar in Udham Singh Nagar and Ranipokhari near Dehradun and now Haldwani is under consideration.

The uncertainty over Uttarakhand’s NLU site reached the High Court, which in 2018 directed the State government to establish the university. The court also said that academic sessions need not wait for a permanent campus and could begin from a government building or rented premises. In 2019, then Chief Minister Trivendra Singh Rawat laid the foundation stone at Ranipokhari for what was projected as the country’s 23rd NLU. Seven years later, the university remains non-functional.

Justice Bhuyan calls for appointing ‘brilliant minds’ from legal academia as judges in SC

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

As student bodies across premier national universities object to Chief Justice of India Surya Kant’s remarks and refuse to have him over for their convocations, Supreme Court judge Justice Ujjal Bhuyan on Sunday pushed for the activation of presidential power to directly appoint “distinguished jurists”, including legal academicians, as judges in the top court of the country.

“While our Constitution has a provision for appointment of a jurist as a judge of the Supreme Court, no jurist has been appointed so far to the Supreme Court though the Constitution has completed more than 76 years,” Justice Bhuyan pointed out at the 13th convocation of the National Law University, Delhi.

Justice Bhuyan said that as important as the right to question was the tolerance to disagreement. “A democratic society cannot be built on the edifice that



Supreme Court judge Justice Ujjal Bhuyan says a ‘distinguished jurist’ could be a great value addition to the Bench. PTI

everyone will think alike,” he said.

Bar Council row

The comments from the Supreme Court judge follow a recent debacle by the Bar Council of India, which ordered State Bar Councils to bar the professional enrolment of the 2026 batch of NALSAR students for objecting to have CJI Kant over as the chief guest for their convocation over his oral comments in court using terms such as “cockroach” and “parasites”. The BCI had to retract the order after public pres-

sure. “Tolerance is not merely a matter of personal courtesy. It is a constitutional value. A democracy becomes meaningful not when everyone speaks the same language of thought, but when different voices can co-exist, be heard and be treated with dignity,” Justice Bhuyan said.

The judge said the maturity of a democracy was reflected not merely in how it responded to opinions that were difficult, unpopular or inconvenient. The courage to voice unpopular opinions began

at universities, the Supreme Court judge said.

He said the 76-year reluctance to activate Article 124(3) for appointment of legal academics as Supreme Court judges in the category of “distinguished jurists” may have been either due to the feeling that there was not enough “depth in the Indian academia” or because the provision was simply not seriously taken. As a result, brilliant minds, men and women with legal scholarship, who could have significantly contributed on the Bench missed the opportunity to serve as judges of the Supreme Court.

Justice Bhuyan dismissed the oft-repeated argument that legal academics and scholars lack the practical experience that serve judges. “But this is a very shallow objection. Supreme Court is not only the highest adjudicatory body but it is the moral, legal and constitutional conscience keeper of the nation. It is above technicalities. The reason for having this provision of

distinguished jurist in Article 124(3) is to diversify the Bench with talented judges,” he said.

Who is a jurist?

In India, the judge said, the term “jurist” was being applied very loosely.

“A lawyer or a judge of repute is often described as a jurist. Certainly, a lawyer and a judge can be a jurist, and there are many such instances, but in the context of Article 124(3), it extends beyond the above two categories. A person who is skilled in law or knowledgeable in the field of law would be qualified to be termed as a ‘jurist,’” Justice Bhuyan said.

A ‘distinguished jurist’ could be a great value addition to the Bench. By his or her scholarship, he or she can make a visible contribution to the decision-making process at the top level. Participation of renowned legal academia and scholars would have a defining impact on the judicial functioning of the Supreme Court, Justice Bhuyan said.

Delay in prorogation of Parliament leading to suspicion: Ramesh

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Speculation abounds about a possible Special Session of Parliament to revive the Delimitation Bill, with the Monsoon Session yet to be prorogued, or formally ended, 17 days after the last meeting of the House.

On August 13, both the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha were adjourned *sine die*, bringing Parliament’s Monsoon Session to a close.

However, the Session is yet to end formally. It remains technically alive, allowing the government to reconvene Parliament without issuing a fresh presidential summons.

The Congress has continued to press for clarity, questioning the unusual delay. “The continued delay in prorogation is mystifying and certainly leads to suspicions that some mischief is afoot. The Home Minister does not have a super-tainted two-thirds majority and is probably engaging in mind games of bluff and bluster,” Congress communications chief Jairam Ramesh told *The Hindu*.

Party president Mallikarjun Kharge, in a letter to Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday, reiterated the party’s position on delimitation, insisting that the existing strength of Lok Sabha be frozen at 543 seats for next 15 years.

Tejashwi asks Chirag, Manjhi to fight from unreserved seats

Amit Bhelari
PATNA

Amid the verbal clash between Bihar’s two Union Ministers, Chirag Paswan and Jitan Ram Manjhi, over reservation and demands for each other’s resignation, Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD) leader Tejashwi Yadav on Sunday drew both of them to contest elections from unreserved seats. Earlier, Mr. Manjhi and his son Santosh Kumar Suman had sought a review of the reservation policy and sub-categorisation of Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes. Reacting to their state-

ment, Mr. Paswan said that if they talked about the creamy layer, then both father and son should resign as they too fall under the creamy layer. Mr. Yadav alleged that both Union Ministers were acting on Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh’s (RSS) instructions. He said both were speaking in contradictory terms to divert attention from the BJP-RSS’s agenda of abolishing reservation.

“If they hold such intense hatred for reservation, they should start contesting elections from unreserved seats; that would open their eyes,” Mr. Yadav said.

BANGALORE WATER SUPPLY AND SEWERAGE BOARD

INVITATION FOR TENDERS (Through KPP Portal Only) - 2nd Call

BWSSB invites tenders in two stage tender system from eligible contractors for the following works.

Sl. No.	Name of the Works	Amount put to Tender
		EMD Amount
Office of The Engineer-In-Chief, 2nd Floor, Cauvery Bhavan, K.G. Road, Bangalore - 560 009.		
IFT No.:BWSSB/EIC/ACE(CS & DCW)/TA/2821/2026-27		Date:29.08 .2026
1	Providing, Supply and laying of 700mm and 400mm dia MS pipeline in place of leaky 700mm and 40mm dia CI feeder line from Cantonment Railway Station to Bharath Petrol Bunk in Cantonment Road under AEE(UFW) Sub Division.	Rs. 358.74 Lakhs Rs. 5.38 Lakhs
IFT No.:BWSSB/EIC/ACE(CS & DCW)/TA/2823/2026-27		Date:29.08 .2026
2	Providing, Supply and laying of 700mm and 400mm dia MS pipeline in place of leaky 700mm and 40mm dia CI feeder line from Bharath Petrol Bunk to in Cantonment Road to AKS Conventional Hall under AEE(UFW) Sub Division.	Rs. 366.33 Lakhs Rs. 6.49Lakhs

For the above works, Last date for receipt of tenders: **14.09.2026 upto 16:00 Hrs.** The bids will be opened on: **15.09.2026 at 16.30 Hrs.**

Sd/- Engineer-In-Chief

The details regarding the tender and participatin in the e-procurement process can be obtained by logging on to <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> For further details contact the above signed office during working hours.

DIPR/CP/JA/2484/2026-27

AMARAVATI GROWTH AND INFRASTRUCTURE CORPORATION LIMITED (AGILCL)
2nd Floor, APCROA Office, Rayapudi, Thulluru Mandal, (A.P.)

E-Procurement Tender Notice

RFR No. 19/MD/CE/AGILCL/2026
Name of Work: "RFP for Consultancy Services for Re-validation and updation of the Detailed Project Report (DPR), 2019 for the Inner Ring Road (IRR), Amaravati."
The bid can be downloaded on AP e-procurement portal from **31-August-2026 15:00 hrs.** For further details, please refer to www.aapeprocurement.gov.in and www.agilcl.org
Date: 29.08.2026
Sd/- Managing Director, AGILCL, Amaravati

Telangana Trade Promotion Corporation Ltd.
(Formerly TSTPC Ltd.) (An Undertaking of Government of Telangana)
Regd. Off: 5-16-174, Shikhar Bhavan, 2nd Floor, Fath Maidan Road, Hyderabad -500 004, Telangana, India. Tel: +91 040-23237591
Email: info@tgtpc.org, <https://tgtpc.telangana.gov.in> CIN: U74991TG2014SC095847

TIN: TGTPC/DoI/IPC/Industrial Policy 2.0/2026
Date: 31.08.2026
Tender Notice Inviting Request for Proposals
(Through e-procurement portal of Government of Telangana)
Commissioner of Industries invites Request For Proposals/Bids through e-procurement portal of the Government of Telangana from reputed Consultancy organizations for - **Selection of a Consultant services for support in industrial promotion and support to the State Government in the Formulation of Industrial Policy 2.0, Aerospace & Defense Policy, Global Capability Centre (GCC) Policy, Data Centre Policy, Footwear & Lifestyle Policy, Textile and Apparel Policy 2.0, Information and Communication Technology (ICT) Policy 2.0, Electronics Policy 2.0 for the state of Telangana - Publication of Notice Inviting (RFQ cum RFP).**
(1) (a) Earnest Money Deposit: Rs. 1.00 Lakhs (Rs. One Lakh) by way of online
(b) Tendering & Processing Fee: Rs. 11,800/- (Rs. Eleven Thousand Eight Hundred Only) by way of online in favor of TSTPC Ltd, Hyderabad.
(2) RFP can be viewed and downloaded from Website: <https://tender.telangana.gov.in> NIT: TGTPC/DoI/IPC/Industrial Policy 2.0/2026, Tender ID: 729418 on 31.08.2026 from 2:00 PM onwards.
(3) Last date & time for submission of proposals online: 24.09.2026 by 5 PM.
(4) Col reserves the right to cancel this notification without assigning any reason whatsoever.
(5) For further information contact Jt. Director (IIPC) of DoI, Mob. 9640092967.
DIPR R.O.No. 479-PPCL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 Dt:31.08.2025 Sd/-MANAGING DIRECTOR

Government of Tamil Nadu
ELECTRONICS CORPORATION OF TAMIL NADU LIMITED - ANGADI

9th Floor, Sigapi Aachi Building, 18/3, Rukmani Lakshminipathi Road, Egmore, Chennai - 600 008 | GST No.33AAACE1670K4ZR
+91 44 2855 1234 | elcotangadi.in.gov.in | tenders@elcotangadi.in

NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Tender No. E-ANGADI-RC-JT02-2026-0020

ELCOT Angadi invites electronic bids for “**Empanelment of Software OEMs / Authorized Partners for Supply of Software Products, Licenses and Subscriptions through the ELCOT Angadi e-Commerce Portal**” For complete details, please visit www.tntenders.gov.in. Pre-bid meeting: **09.09.2026, 11.00 AM** at ELCOT Nandanam Office. Last date for submission of e-bids: **01.10.2026, 3.00 PM.** For queries: tenders@elcotangadi.in.
DIPR/2702/Tender/2026 **GENERAL MANAGER (PROCUREMENT)**

INBRIEF



FPIs turn buyers for second month, invest ₹30,919 crore

Foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) infused ₹30,919 crore in Indian equities in August, extending their buying streak to a second straight month, amid improving corporate earnings, resilient economic activity, stable rupee and easing geopolitical concerns. The inflow follows ₹20,200 crore invested in July, marking a sharp turnaround after four consecutive months of heavy selling. FPIs had withdrawn ₹49,340 crore in June, ₹32,963 crore in May, ₹60,847 crore in April, and a massive ₹1.17 lakh crore in March. Prior to the selling streak, they had invested ₹22,615 crore in February, according to Central Depository Services (India) Ltd. (CDSL) data. PTI

Four die after consuming spurious liquor in Patna

At least four people died allegedly after consuming spurious liquor in dry Bihar's Patna district on Sunday, a police officer said. The incident took place in Bedhna village under the jurisdiction of the Barh police station. According to the families of the deceased, the four men consumed liquor in a room, and they fell ill soon after. They were taken to the nearest government hospital, where they died during treatment. Barh Sub-Divisional Police Officer (SDPO) Ayush Srivastava said the bodies of the victims had been sent for post-mortem examination to ascertain the exact cause of death. The Bihar government imposed a total ban on the sale and consumption of alcohol in the State on April 5, 2016. PTI

Modi stresses need to keep India's youth free from drugs

Students, theatre groups must raise awareness against drug menace, says PM in his Mann ki Baat address; 35 lakh women across the country have benefited from PM SVANidhi Yojana, he adds

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has flagged the dangers of drug addiction, highlighted the economic avenues opening up for women and girls in India, including in the space industry, and lauded the cleanliness initiatives being undertaken by citizens. “Drug addiction does not just engulf a single individual. The entire family and society have to bear the consequences,” Mr. Modi said in his 137th Mann ki Baat episode on Sunday. “I would like to commend those who raise awareness against drugs and step forward to help individuals struggling with addiction.” Mr. Modi urged young musicians to produce songs that convey the message of a drug-free life, students and theatre groups to write short plays that highlight the dangers of drugs while also showing the path to recovery, and content creators to spread the message on social media in various languages. “Let us all play our part in this noble mission to

Drug addiction does not just engulf a single individual. The entire family and society have to bear the consequences

NARENDRA MODI
Prime Minister



keep India's youth away from drugs and free from addiction,” Mr. Modi said.

Women empowerment “From morning till evening, lakhs of women across the streets of our cities and towns are engaged in their work,” the Prime Minister noted. “Some sell vegetables or fruits, others run tea stalls, while some sell flowers, earthen lamps, and worship materials.” He added that, often, a lack of capital prevents such businesses from growing further. “But now, lakhs of such mothers and sisters are gaining new strength through the PM SVANidhi Yojana,” Mr. Modi said. “This aspect of wo-

men empowerment is not discussed as much as it should be. Women account for approximately 46% of the beneficiaries of the PM SVANidhi Yojana.” This, he explained, meant that around 35 lakh women across the country are expanding their businesses by connecting with this scheme. PM SVANidhi Yojana is a Central government scheme aimed at providing affordable and easy working capital loans without any guarantee to street vendors and hawkers in urban areas. “Today the flight of our daughters' dreams is soaring from the earth to outer space,” Mr. Modi told listeners of his radio programme. “And

you will be proud to know that India is bringing together thousands of daughters who are nurturing such dreams, from across the globe. This initiative is named Mission ShaktiSAT.” Through this initiative, 12,000 girl students from 108 countries are getting the opportunity to learn satellite technology and to advance in the field of innovation, he said. On August 23, celebrated as National Space Day, the second phase of Mission ShaktiSAT was launched at Gautam Buddha University in Greater Noida where around 100 female students from across the country, including remote regions, and various other countries came together. “The goal of this entire initiative is truly special: preparations are under way to send a satellite – developed entirely through the participation of female students – into lunar orbit,” Mr. Modi said. “I am confident that many of these students will carve out a distinct identity for themselves in the fields of science, technology, and innovation in the future.”

Maratha protesters wave black flags at Shinde in Parbhani

Snehal Mutha
MUMBAI



Maratha protesters waved black flags at Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde during the Shiv Sena's farmer-youth interaction programme in Parbhani on Sunday. The protest comes amid the ongoing indefinite hunger strike in Jalna district by Maratha quota activist Manoj Jarange-Patil, who is demanding Kunbi caste certificates for the Maratha community. Parbhani is part of the Marathwada division and is located 155 km from Antargali Sarati in Jalna district, the site of the protest. “MP Sanjay Jadhav and Eknath Shinde have challenged us; we will take our revenge in Mumbai. We won't waste our energy now as the boundaries of Parbhani have been sealed,” Mr. Jarange-Patil said. He had previously asked Shiv Sena MP Sanjay Jadhav to call off the event, calling it an insult to the community when the government is allegedly cancelling already issued Kunbi certificates to Marathas.

Government's defense During the event, Mr. Shinde defended the Mahayuti government's record. “Mahayuti has

The incident comes amid the ongoing indefinite hunger strike by Maratha quota activist Manoj Jarange-Patil. PTI

worked for people; we formed the Shinde committee to give reservation, we gave 10% reservation to the Maratha community, and we did this without taking quota from other communities,” he said. Mr. Jadhav quit the Uddhav Thackeray-led Shiv Sena (UBT) and joined the Shinde-led Shiv Sena with five other MPs in June. “We have been preparing for the event for the last two months; cancelling it at the last moment means facing a lot of difficulties,” Mr. Jadhav said, apologising to Mr. Jarange-Patil in case his sentiments were hurt. “We detained a total of 35 people to maintain law and order, but they were released after some time,” said Parbhani SP Pankaj Kumavat. 80 police officers, 310 police constables, and Riot Control Police (RCP) were deployed for security.

Govt. notifies IST as common time reference across India; gives 180 days for compliance

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI



The Centre is building facilities to disseminate accurate IST. GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

The Union government has notified the Legal Metrology (Indian Standard Time) Rules, 2026, mandating Indian Standard Time (IST) as the single reference for legal, administrative, commercial and other official purposes across the country. The nodal Consumer Affairs Ministry notified the rules on August 27. Still, they will come into force 180 days after their publication in the Official Gazette, giving government departments, businesses, and institutions time to align their systems. The move comes amid growing reliance on digital and technology-based systems—from banking and payments to telecommuni-

port accurate time-stamping of banking and digital payment transactions, coordination among railways, airports and other transport systems, reliable functioning of telecommunication and internet networks, precise time-keeping in power systems, upkeep of government and legal records, and coordination of emergency and other time-critical services, the Ministry said in a statement. A key feature of the rules is the emphasis on reducing dependence on foreign satellite-based time sources, which several critical systems currently rely on. The government is building infrastructure to disseminate accurate IST through Indian institutions and legal metrology laboratories. The common time reference is expected to sup-

port accurate time-stamping of banking and digital payment transactions, coordination among railways, airports and other transport systems, reliable functioning of telecommunication and internet networks, precise time-keeping in power systems, upkeep of government and legal records, and coordination of emergency and other time-critical services, the Ministry said in a statement. A key feature of the rules is the emphasis on reducing dependence on foreign satellite-based time sources, which several critical systems currently rely on. The government is building infrastructure to disseminate accurate IST through Indian institutions and legal metrology laboratories. The common time reference is expected to sup-

Study sheds light on early warning signs before eruption of solar flares

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU



Scientists found numerous small, short-lived brightening 'transient events', occurring before the onset of major flares. GETTY IMAGES

In a new study, scientists have found small, short-lived brightening in the sun's atmosphere that appear hours before a major solar flare erupts, clustering around the spot where the flare later occurs. The study was carried out by researchers from the Manipal Centre for Natural Sciences and Manipal Academy of Higher Education, along with scientists from the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO), Department of Space, and other academicians. It used simultaneous ultraviolet (UV) and X-ray observations from three payloads onboard the Aditya-L1 mission. The Solar Ultraviolet Imaging Telescope (SUIT) payload observed the sun in 11 near-ultraviolet (NUV)

filters, revealing different layers from the upper photosphere to chromosphere, according to the ISRO. “NUV wavelengths are largely inaccessible from the ground because Earth's atmosphere absorbs most ultraviolet radiation. Complementing SUIT are two X-ray instruments, the Solar Low Energy X-ray Spectrometer (SoLEXS) and the High Energy L1 Orbiting X-ray Spectrometer (HELIOS), which measure

the X-ray emission produced by energetic processes in the solar corona. Combining these data, scientists study how activity in the lower solar atmosphere is linked to energy release in the corona during the build-up to a flare,” the ISRO stated. Analysing solar flare events, the team found numerous small, short-lived brightening ‘transient events’, occurring in active regions before the onset of

major flares. “Some of these also showed corresponding X-ray signatures, indicating that they involve the release of magnetic energy... These pre-flare transient events clustered around the location where the major flare later occurred. The results suggest that repeated small-scale energy release may progressively destabilise the magnetic field in an active region, eventually leading to a large solar flare,” the ISRO said. The findings provide valuable insights into the physical processes that trigger solar flares and move scientists a step closer towards reliable flare forecasting, which will ultimately contribute to better space weather prediction; help protect satellites, astronauts, and communication systems; and other critical technologies.

Water quality deteriorating in Haryana: Cong. MLA

The Hindu Bureau
GURUGRAM

Congress MLA from Kaithal Aditya Surjewala has criticised the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) government over the “deteriorating” quality of drinking water in Haryana. Citing data presented by the government in the State Assembly during the ongoing monsoon session, Mr. Surjewala, in a press statement issued on Saturday, said groundwater in 88 of Haryana's 142 blocks had an average total dissolved solids (TDS) level above the acceptable limit of 500 mg/L in 2025, with 35 blocks recording levels of 1,000 mg/L or more. “Water quality is not improving; instead, it is deteriorating every year under the BJP government,” Mr. Surjewala said.

THE CROSSWORD+ 14886

(set by Hypatia)

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12 Doctor separating wounded and serious (6)

14 Protect Sinner — He's lost (8)

15 A scene from Tom & Jerry, possibly in a temporary rally? (4,3,6)

18 Shot group of journalists per Spooner (8)

20 Local icon's clothing fabric (6)

21 Setter in main marketplace (4,6)

22 Field manager regularly clearing sink (4)

23 Keep checking elephants on vacation in jungle (6)

24 Win back in random plan (8)

Down

1 Decline screening said overs set up in camera (8)

2 Eat bananas closer to thick tree (4)

3 Tipsy chemist bottling spirit (6)

4 European crowd introduced to very strong coffee (8)

5 Rich saloon exercises happening at identical intervals (10)

6 Pity engineer spoiling Onam (6)

8 Vanity firm is sentenced wrongly (13)

13 Initially bride needs husband: revolting to go becomes a disgrace to family (5,5)

16 Virtue of unwinding by a trip to spa which is taken frequently (8)

17 Trade banter (8)

19 Yes, this author made say, movies (6)

20 Provides automobiles without deflated tyre (6)

22 Originally France exported tuna and cheese (4)

SUDOKU

2				8			4	9
			1	2			7	6
	9			7				
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5	6	9				3	2	4
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DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★

Solution to previous puzzle

C	I	P	R	O	S			
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N	E	E						
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B	A	C	K	S	L	A	P	E
A	R	M	A	D	I	O	S	
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T	H	E	I	S	T			

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

3	6	4	1	2	9	5	8	7
5	2	9	7	3	8	6	1	4
7	1	8	6	4	5	3	9	2
8	4	1	5	7	2	9	6	3
2	5	3	9	8	6	7	4	1
6	9	7	4	1	3	2	5	8
1	3	6	8	9	7	4	2	5
4	7	5	2	6	1	8	3	9
9	8	2	3	5	4	1	7	6

CMYK

A ND-NDE

Which Nifty is right for you?

Vaishali R. Venkat

Imagine you decide to invest in equity via an index fund. But which market are you actually buying? The 50 biggest firms? The next 50 waiting in the wings? Or, a much broader basket of 500 firms? All three are called Nifty indices, but they can give your money very different rides. So, it's worth asking a simple question: Which one to choose?

It matters because choosing an index fund is not simply a question of picking the one with more number of firms or the one with 'bluechips'. Instead, you are choosing between how much of the market to own and where that exposure comes from.

Nifty 50
The Nifty 50 may give you exposure to 50 large firms but as of July 31, 2026 financial services alone accounted for 36.18%, healthcare 4.82% and power just 2.63% of the index. So, the real question for an investor is: Do you want the largest firms, the next tier of firms, a broader slice of market or a sector mix you are comfortable with?

What if you don't want to bet on which part of the market will win? The Nifty 50 gives you exposure to 50 of the market's largest firms. So, for an investor who wants to keep equity investing simple, it can be a 'perfectly reasonable' one-index approach. But there is an important question hiding beneath: are you comfortable owning mainly the firms that have already turned the market's biggest or also firms that could become tomorrow's 'giants'? That is where the Nifty Next 50 enters the picture.

Nifty Next 50
If the Nifty 50 represents the established 'giants', the Nifty Next 50 takes you one step down the ladder, bringing in the next 50 companies outside the Nifty 50. That makes it an interesting middle ground: you are still investing in relatively large companies but moving beyond the market's biggest names. For an investor who feels the Nifty 50 is too concentrated in today's 'giants' but who does not want to straddle across the entire market, the Next 50 offers a different proposition. The next query is whether you want exposure to the next set of companies in the market-cap hierarchy or prefer the wider spread offered by the Nifty 500.

Nifty 500
What if you don't want to pick a winner? This is where the Nifty 500 changes the scenario altogether. Instead of deciding whether the market's biggest companies or the next tier will do better, you are spreading your exposure much further across the Indian equity market. That can appeal to an investor who does not want to make a call on which segment of the market will lead over the next 10 or 20 years.

The trade-off is equally important: you are also accepting exposure to companies beyond the large-cap universe, which can make the ride different from a Nifty 50 fund. In simple terms, Nifty 50 asks you to back the 'giants'; Nifty Next 50 gives you the 'climbers'; Nifty 500 lets you own a much larger part of the race.

Which one to choose?
There is no single universally "best" index. However, history offers a useful reality check: diversification does not automatically mean lower risk. In NSE Indices' February 2026 Riskometer assessment, all three indices were classified as "Very High" risk, but the scores rose from 5.33 for Nifty 50 to 5.43 for Nifty Next 50 and 5.60 for Nifty 500.

So, while Nifty 500 gives you a much wider slice of the market, it has not been the least risky of the three by this measure. The choice, therefore, is less about finding a "safe" index and more about deciding how much market breadth and volatility you are prepared to accept.

(The writer is an NISM & CRISIL-certified Wealth Manager and certified in NISM's Research Analyst module)



ILLUSTRATION: SAAI

Why gold should form 10% of investment portfolio

Most investors think of portfolio in terms of equity and fixed income but buying gold is not a speculative add-on, it is a structural building block of a well-constructed portfolio

SHINES ABOVE REST

Joydeep Sen

Most investors think of portfolio in terms of equity and fixed income. Gold is an afterthought. That approach misses the point. Gold deserves a deliberate, planned allocation of about 10% of every portfolio and here is why.

A diversifier, not a bet
Long-term data shows gold behaves differently from equity and fixed income in most situations. When equity markets are under stress, gold tends to hold up or even gain. When bond yields rise sharply on inflation worries, gold does well since it is seen as a hedge against currency depreciation. This is the essence of diversification - you don't want all assets moving in the same direction at the same time.

If you run a portfolio with equity and fixed income and allocate 10% to gold, the math works out in your favour as the overall portfolio volatility drops as gold price movements are not synchronised with the other two asset classes. Risk-adjusted or volatility-adjusted return improves. This is how portfolio construction works when you combine assets that do not move in lockstep. You are adding gold as it smoothens the ride.

Global central banks have been briskly adding

Global central banks have been briskly adding gold to reserves with the driving force being the geopolitical environment

gold to reserves.

Central bank buying
Sanctions, trade tensions and a more fragmented world order have made many central banks wary of holding all reserves in U.S. Treasuries. Gold held within a country's own vaults does not carry counterparty risk the way a government bond does. This shift by central banks has been one of the steadiest sources of demand for gold over the past four years.

No trend breaking
Gold has corrected meaningfully from a peak earlier this year. Prices had run up too far too quickly, and some of that froth had to come off. What matters more is if the long-term uptrend is intact. Chartists tracking gold have a technical support line and even after this correction, that line has not been broken. A correction within an intact uptrend is very different from a trend reversal.

Rupee depreciation
Gold price is quoted in U.S. dollars and set daily by the London Bullion Market Association. The price in India is that global dollar

Gold has a inverse relationship with the U.S. dollar (USD). When the USD strengthens, gold in dollar terms tends to soften and vice versa.

price converted into rupees. Over the long run, the rupee had depreciated against the dollar and is likely to continue so. Every time the rupee weakens, it adds to rupee-denominated return from gold over and above whatever the dollar price of gold itself does. This is a tailwind that many investors overlook.

U.S. Fed rate and gold
Gold has an inverse relationship with the U.S. dollar (USD). When the USD strengthens, gold in dollar terms tends to soften and vice versa. The U.S. Federal Reserve is likely to raise interest rates which will act as a headwind for gold.

However, there is a limit to how much the Fed can hike as the U.S. is sitting on a huge pile of debt and higher rates mean higher cost of servicing it. At some point, the arithmetic of debt servicing and growth of economy forces a pause/reversal, in the rate cycle. Investors should see dollar-gold relationship as cyclical on gold's prospects.

Several routes
There are several routes to gold. Sovereign Gold Bonds, offering 2.5% an-

nual interest on top of gold's price appreciation are no longer issued afresh but existing bonds can be bought and sold in the secondary market. Gold Exchange Traded Funds are an evergreen option - you need a demat and trading account with a broker and can buy/sell units. If you do not have a demat account, Gold Funds from mutual funds (MFs) serve the same purpose and you can invest via regular MF folio, including SIP.

More recently, a new avenue has opened up: Electronic Gold Receipts or EGRs. These are SEBI-regulated securities representing direct ownership of physical gold held in accredited vaults. You buy/sell EGRs on the stock exchange, just like a share and they sit in demat account. Each EGR is a receipt against a specific quantity of physical gold with the option to convert holdings into gold bars/coins via withdrawal request subject to charges/taxes. EGRs are available in small denominations making them accessible even to small investors. For those who want transparency of exchange-based pricing along with the comfort of an actual claim on physical gold, EGRs are worth considering as part of the 10% allocation. Whichever route, the underlying point is: gold is not a speculative add-on, it is a structural building block of a well-constructed portfolio.

(Joydeep Sen is a corporate trainer (financial markets) and author)

When age matters

THINKINVESTOR

Are you interested in earning a dividend income? Should source of returns matter? The answer is your age determines preference for source of returns, especially via equity investments

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

In recent times, several stocks have traded at prices that offer good dividend yield. This leads to the question: Are individuals interested in earning a dividend income? Should source of returns matter? Here, we discuss how your age determines your preference for source of returns, especially from equity investments.

Income vs. capital appreciation
Equity investments, like bonds and real estate, offer two sources of returns - income returns and capital appreciation. Income returns arise from dividends received from the firm whose stocks you directly hold. You can also earn dividend income indirectly via net asset value if you invest in mutual funds. Note, this dividend income is reinvested and realised as capital appreciation if you invest in the growth option of a fund.

The choice of returns depends on age. If you are a working executive, your main objective is to accumulate wealth to achieve life goals such as funding child's education and buying a house.

This tilts your preference towards capital appreciation and is tax efficient; you pay taxes only when you sell a stock in direct investments or when you redeem mutual fund units. Now, goal-based investments are typically held for more than 12 months. So, if you have earmarked these investments for a life goal, the gains are likely to be taxed at 12.5% above ₹1.25 lakh in a year. This is because these equity investments will be taxed as long-term capital asset.

What if you are retired? Your active income would have stopped and you now depend on passive income to meet post-retirement expenses.

This means you need monthly income to support lifestyle expenses. Also, most mass-affluent retirees are conservative investors viz. they prefer to conserve capital and consume income. In such cases, they prefer to invest in monthly income bank deposits. Investing in dividend yield stocks may be preferred by some as an additional source of income.

Conclusion
If taxes were the only consideration, then earning dividend income may not be an economical source of returns.

This is because dividend income is taxed at your marginal tax rate. Yet, retirees may prefer dividend as a supplement to their interest income to meet their post-retirement expenses.

In such cases, think of taxes as the cost retirees are willing to incur to consume income without drawing down their investment capital - selling shares or mutual fund units to generate cash flows.

(The author offers training programs for individuals to manage their personal investments)

Personal Loans

Rates and Charges		Loan amount 5 lakh Tenure 5 years	Loan amount 1 lakh Tenure 5 years	(% of loan amount)
Name of Lender	Interest Rate (%)	EMI (Rs)	EMI (Rs)	Processing fee
Axis Bank	8.90 onwards	10,355 onwards	2,071 onwards	Up to 2%
Bajaj Finserv	10.00-30.50	10,624-16,177	2,125-3,235	Up to 4.13%
Bank of Baroda*	10.15-18.00	10,660-12,697	2,132-2,539	Up to 2% (Max. Rs 10,000)
Bank of India	10.85-16.15	10,834-12,199	2,167-2,440	Up to 1% (Min. Rs 250; Max. Rs 15,000)
Bank of Maharashtra	9.75-15.00	10,562-11,895	2,112-2,379	Up to 1% (Max. Rs 10,000)
Canara Bank	9.70-15.15	10,550-11,934	2,110-2,387	0.25% (Rs. 500 - Rs. 2,500)
Central Bank of India	11.25 onwards	10,934 onwards	2,187 onwards	Up to 1%
Federal Bank	11.75 - 18.99	11,059 - 12,968	2,212 - 2,594	Up to 3%
HDFC Bank	9.99 onwards	10,621 onwards	2,124 onwards	Up to Rs 6,500
HSBC Bank	9.70 onwards	10,562 onwards	2,112 onwards	Up to 1%
ICICI Bank	9.99 onwards	10,621 onwards	2,124 onwards	Up to 2%
IDFC FIRST Bank	9.99 onwards	10,621 onwards	2,124 onwards	Up to 3.5%
Indian Overseas Bank	10.25 onwards	10,685 onwards	2,137 onwards	Up to 0.75%
IndusInd Bank	10.49 onwards	10,744 onwards	2,149 onwards	Up to 3.5% (2% for instant personal loans for limited period)
Kotak Mahindra Bank	10.99 onwards	10,869 onwards	2,174 onwards	Up to 5%
Poonawalla Fincorp	9.99 onwards	10,621 onwards	2,124 onwards	Up to 4%
Punjab & Sind Bank	9.65-13.90	10,538-11,608	2,108-2,322	0.50%-1%
Punjab National Bank	10.25-16.80	10,685-12,373	2,137-2,475	Up to 1%
State Bank of India	10.00-15.00	10,624-11,895	2,125-2,379	Up to 1.50% (Rs. 1,000 - Rs. 15,000)
Tata Capital	10.99 onwards	10,869 onwards	2,174 onwards	Flat Rs. 49
UCO Bank	9.95 - 13.20	10,611-11,428	2,122-2,286	Up to 1% (Min. Rs 750)
Union Bank of India	8.90 - 12.65	10,355-11,287	2,071-2,257	Up to 1% (Max. Rs 7,500)

*Interest concession of 0.10% to customers opting for group credit life insurance.

Car Loans

Rates and Charges		Loan amount 5 lakh Tenure 5 years	(% of loan amount)
Name of Lender	Interest Rate (%)	EMI (Rs)	Processing fee
Bank of Baroda	7.60 - 11.35	10,043 - 10,959	Up to Rs. 2,000
Bank of India	7.60-12.55	10,043 - 11,262	Up to 0.25% (Rs. 2,500 - Rs. 10,000)
Bank of Maharashtra*	7.45-11.75	10,007 - 11,059	NIL (Limited Period Monsoon Offer)
Canara Bank**	7.45-11.45	10,007 - 10,984	0.25% (Rs 1,000 - Rs 5,000)
Central Bank of India	7.50-9.30	10,019 - 10,452	NIL (Till 31.12.2026)
HDFC Bank	8.15 onwards	10,174 onwards	Up to 0.5% (Rs. 3,500 - Rs. 8,000)
ICICI Bank	8.40 onwards	10,234 onwards	Up to Rs. 8,500
IDFC FIRST Bank	8.99 onwards	10,377 onwards	Up to Rs. 10,000
Indian Bank	7.50-9.65	10,019 - 10,513	Rs. 1,200
Indian Overseas Bank	7.55-12.00	10,031 - 11,122	NIL
Karnataka Bank	8.13-11.63	10,169 - 11,029	Up to 0.60% (Rs. 2,500 - Rs. 11,000)
Punjab and Sind Bank***	7.55-14.05	10,031 - 11,647	0.25% (Rs. 1,000 - Rs. 15,000)
Punjab National Bank	7.60-10.70	10,043 - 10,797	Up to 0.25% (Rs. 1,000 - Rs. 1,500)
State Bank of India	8.70 - 9.85	10,307 - 10,587	Rs. 500 - Rs. 2,000
UCO Bank	7.35-10.00	9,983 - 10,624	0.5% (Max. Rs 5,000)
Union Bank of India	7.50-10.00	10,019 - 10,684	Up to Rs 1,000

*0.25% interest rate concession for existing home loan borrowers and other existing customers having at least 6 months of relationship with the bank.

**50% waiver on processing fee till September 30

***Concession of up to 50% on processing fee for PSB Apna Vahan Sugam.

Rates and charges as on August 26

Source: Paisabazaar.com

Send queries on personal finance and investing to the moneywise@thehindu.co.in ID. Our experts in personal finance will respond to select queries, but will not give specific recommendations for investment in a particular mutual fund, share or fixed deposit.

CAIRO

Israeli air strike kills two persons, including a three-year-old child



REUTERS

An Israeli air strike killed two Palestinians, including a three-year-old child, in the central Gaza Strip on Sunday, health officials said. The Israeli military said it attacked and killed a Hamas militant, who advanced attacks against Israeli forces and civilians. Hamas did not comment on the military's allegation. REUTERS

SEOUL

North Korea dismisses Defence Minister in 'structural reshuffle'



REUTERS

North Korea's Defence Minister No Kwang Chol has been dismissed as part of "structural reorganisation plans" of the country's military leadership, state media reported on Sunday. Mr. No was also demoted in the ruling party leadership to "first vice-director of the Munitions Industry Department," KCNA said. AFP

CARACAS

Venezuela retains 'sovereignty' in oil deal with U.S., says Rodriguez



AFP

Interim leader Delcy Rodriguez assured the public on Saturday that Venezuela retains control of its oil under a new agreement that allows the United States significant access to it. "One thing must be absolutely clear: Venezuela retains ownership and sovereignty over its resources," Ms. Rodriguez said in a speech. AFP

TRIPOLI

Libya's rival political groups sign UN-backed election agreement



REUTERS

Libya's rival political groups signed a UN-backed agreement in Tripoli on Sunday aimed at paving the way for much-delayed presidential and legislative elections within 24 months. The deal calls for elections held "under a single executive authority and unified national institutions", which is not yet the case. AFP

Mojtaba calls for Muslim unity, says countries must identify 'real enemy'

The solution to the problems of Islamic nations is unity of words, friendship, and cooperation on the path of goodness, says Iran's Supreme Leader; he calls for national cohesion, advising citizens not to allow differences to arise among themselves

Agence France-Presse
TEHRAN

Iran's Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei on Sunday called on Muslim countries in the region to unite against the United States and Israel, in a written message issued six months on from the start of the West Asia war.

Mr. Khamenei, in power since shortly after his father Ali Khamenei was killed at the start of the war on February 28, has yet to be seen in public since his appointment, and authorities have not released any video or audio of him.

"The solution to the problems of the Islamic na-



Motorists drive past a billboard depicting Ali Khamenei handing the country's flag to Mojtaba Khamenei, in downtown Tehran. AP

tions is unity of words, friendship, and cooperation on the path of goodness," he said on Sunday as Shia Muslims marked the birthday of the Prophet

Mohammed. "Anyone, in any position, who does anything that leads to division among Muslims and creates conflict in the Muslim community, knowingly

or unknowingly, intentionally or unintentionally, has served the purpose of the enemies of Islam," he added, according to his official website.

The Supreme Leader called on the rulers of regional countries to "recognise your real enemy, understand its plan, and confront it", referring to the U.S. and Israel.

During the war, Iran targeted U.S. military bases across the West Asia including in Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, Jordan, Kuwait, Qatar and Bahrain. Relations with those nations have since soured.

Mr. Khamenei, who has

the final say on major state policies, also called on Iranian officials and citizens to put aside differences and come together against Israel and the U.S. "Again, this servant's advice to the Iranian people is to not allow any differences to arise among themselves in any way," he said, echoing remarks made in another statement on Friday.

He also called on Friday for the gradual de-dollarisation of the Iranian economy and for boosting economic production to support growth following months of a U.S. naval blockade and years of crippling sanctions that have hit livelihoods.

China, Bangladesh to start 2+2 dialogue soon: Kobir

Kallol Bhattacharjee
NEW DELHI

Bangladesh-China two-plus-two dialogue will commence in the "very near future", Minister of State for Foreign Affairs Humayun Kobir announced in Dhaka on Sunday. Mr. Kobir announced this soon after the Chinese Ambassador to Bangladesh Yao Wen called on him to discuss a number of projects including the Teesta River Comprehensive Management and Restoration Project (TRCMRP).

"The groundwork for the 2+2 engagement is currently being laid for further interactions. So yes, it will commence at a mutually convenient time in the very near future," Mr. Kobir told members of the media at the Foreign Ministry. Mr.



Humayun Kobir

Kobir, who was inducted into Ministry on August 21, said the dialogue will include diplomacy and defence verticals at the level of Minister of State and then will move to the Foreign Minister-level.

"We have not fixed any specific dates yet. However, discussions will take place at that level," he said. The announcement came two months after Prime Minister Tarique Rahman

visited China where the two sides discussed major projects including the plans on the Teesta river. Mr. Kobir described China as an important development partner and reaffirmed Bangladesh's commitment to 'One China policy'.

In his meeting with the Chinese Ambassador, Mr. Kobir discussed a number of items that were taken up during Prime Minister Rahman's China visit including the Teesta River Comprehensive Management and Restoration Project (TRCMRP).

They also discussed the China-Myanmar-Bangladesh corridor project, China Economic and Industrial Zone (CEIZ) and signing of a commercial contract for modernisation of Mongla Port.

Preparing 'massive strikes' on Ukraine's energy sector: Russia

Agence France-Presse
MOSCOW

Russia's Defence Ministry on Sunday said it was gearing up for large-scale attacks on Ukraine's energy infrastructure in a tit-for-tat response to strikes by Kyiv.

"Russian forces have begun preparations for massive strikes against facilities in Ukraine's energy sector in response to the ongoing attacks by the Kyiv regime on civilian infrastructure and on Russia's oil and energy complex," it said on Telegram.

Last winter, Moscow repeatedly hit Ukrainian power plants, devastating the country's energy sec-

Last winter, Moscow hit Ukrainian power plants, plunging millions into cold and darkness

tor and plunging millions of people into cold and darkness in sub-zero temperatures.

On Sunday, the Russian army claimed to have struck a plant in Kyiv producing asbestos and cement whose warehouses, it said, were used to store explosives, as well as a manufacturer of drones and munitions. Ukraine attacked an oil refinery with drones in northwestern Russia, causing a fire.

Turkiye, Saudi, Pak. Ministers to hold first defence pact meeting

Agence France-Presse
ISTANBUL

Turkiye will host Saudi Arabia and Pakistan for the first ministerial meeting of their new regional defence grouping on Monday, Turkish sources said on Sunday.

The Mecca Joint Defence Agreement signed earlier this month commits the three countries to mutual defence in the event of any of them being attacked.

The pact came against a backdrop of war between the United States and Iran and attacks in the region from Tehran-backed Houthi rebels.

The meeting in Istanbul

will set up a "political and defence strategic committee" involving Foreign and Defence Ministers and military chiefs, Turkish Foreign Ministry sources said. The agreement unites NATO's second-largest army, Turkiye, with the Islamic world's only nuclear-armed state, Pakistan, and the leading Gulf power in Saudi Arabia.

Pakistan is sending Deputy Prime Minister and Foreign Minister Ishaq Dar, along with the Defence Minister and the commander of the defence forces. Saudi Arabia will be represented by its Foreign Minister, the Defence Minister and the chief of the general staff, Turkish sources said.

Icelandic voters reject a proposal to restart negotiations to join the EU

Associated Press
REYKJAVIK

Iceland's voters rejected restarting negotiations to join the European Union more than a decade after previous talks ended, the national broadcaster reported on Sunday, in a referendum that pitted concerns about geopolitical stability against keeping national control of Iceland's prized fisheries.

Opponents defeated the measure by a margin of 52.8% to 47.2%, RUV reported. The capital of Reykjavik was the only area in the island nation of 400,000 people where a majority supported the referendum.

The vote on Saturday



A supporter of the 'No' campaign displays a placard against the EU ('EU - no thanks'), during a rally in Reykjavik on Thursday. AFP

was held in the shadow of repeated threats by U.S. President Donald Trump's control nearby Greenland. Although Iceland is a NATO member, supporters said European solidarity would provide greater protection if Mr. Trump ever

made similar threats toward the volcanic island. Iceland's left-leaning coalition government, elected in 2024, moved up the EU referendum it had planned for next year after Mr. Trump mistakenly named Iceland four times

while speaking about his designs on Greenland.

Prime Minister Kristrún Frostadóttir, who campaigned in support of the measure, said she hoped the result would not divide the nation.

Yes-or-no question Voters faced a simple yes-or-no question: Should Iceland resume accession negotiations with the European Union?

Turnout was high with more than 82% of the eligible 270,000 voters casting ballots.

The count through the night had the nation on edge as the "Yes" campaign took an early lead before results swung in favour of the opposition.

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REVISION PETITION No. 1472 OF 2023
(Against the order dated 16.02.2023 in Appeal Number A/1076/2023 of the State Commission, Uttar Pradesh)
CUMMINS INDIA LIMITED (PREVIOUSLY KNOWN AS "CUMMINS SALES & SERVICE INDIA LIMITED") - Petitioner
VERSUS
M/S. NAVBHARAT RICE INDUSTRIES & ORS. - Respondents
I, S.K. Diesel Sales and Service Pvt. Ltd., House No.235, B-Block, Lok Vihar Pitampura, Delhi-110 034
I, S.K. Diesel Sales and Service Pvt. Ltd., C-495, Ashok Nagar Near School, Delhi - 110068
NOTICE
(SUBSTITUTED NOTICE BY WAY OF PUBLICATION)
WHEREAS Cummins India Limited, has filed a Revision Petition No. A/172/2023 against the order dated 16.02.2023 in Appeal Number No. 1076/2013 of the State Commission, Uttar Pradesh; WHEREAS the above mentioned Revision Petition is pending before the National Commission, New Delhi and wherein you have been served as respondents; WHEREAS this Commission, vide order dated 24.07.2026, has ordered to effect service upon you by this Publication returnable on 28.08.2026.
Accordingly, you are hereby directed to appear before this Commission in person or through your counsel/authorized representative on 28.08.2026 at 10.30 a.m.
TAKE NOTICE in case of your non-appearance on the above mentioned date and time, the Petition shall be heard and decided on your default.
Dated this 25th Aug. 2026.
Ashay Varshney
SECTION OFFICER

IN THE HIGH COURT OF KARNATAKA AT BANGALURU
(SUBSTITUTED SERVICE OF NOTICE TO THE RESPONDENT)
BY WAY OF PAPER PUBLICATION
VIDE COURT ORDER DATED : 19.08.2026
CMP No. 286/2024
(VIDEO CONFERENCING / PHYSICAL HEARING)
PETITIONER'S : M/S SCENIC BEAUTY HOMES PRIVATE LIMITED,
Bangaluru-560094.
Represented By its Authorized Signatory, Nallamuthu Thangavel
(Sri) Akshay Kumar Jain V. - Advocate for Petitioner)
VS.
RESPONDENT'S : SHIV SHANKAR RAM
To, RESPONDENT
SHIV SHANKAR RAM, No.370, Main Market, Near Shiv Mandir, Badapur, South India-110044.
Shivshankarrec.india@gmail.com
...RESPONDENT/S
Whereas the above named Petitioner has filed a CMP on this Court Under Section 11(6) of the Arbitration and Conciliation Act 1996; r/w the Appointment of Arbitrators by the Chief Justice of Karnataka High Court, Scheme 1996 on behalf of the Petitioner has been registered by this Court.
Notice is hereby given to you to appear in this Court in person or through an Advocate duly instructed or through some one authorized by law to act for you, in this matter on 15/10/2026 at 10.30 AM in case you intend to contest the petition. If you fail to appear, the petition will be dealt with, heard and decided in your absence.
GIVEN under my hand and the seal of this Court, on the 19th Day of August 2026.
BY ORDER OF THE COURT
ASSISTANT REGISTRAR

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RECOGNISING EXCELLENCE

Noted commentator Mary Carillo inducted into the Hall of Fame



TENNIS HALL OF FAME

Noted tennis commentator, analyst, and former player Mary Carillo was inducted into the International Tennis Hall of Fame in the Contributor Category on Saturday. Carillo, introduced by Billie Jean King at the ceremony, won the mixed doubles title along with John McEnroe at the French Open in 1977 during a three-year career.

HAPPY TEARS

Emotional Federer breaks down during Hall of Fame speech



AFF

During his nearly 30-minute Hall of Fame speech, Roger Federer choked up a few times. It began to get tough for him halfway through, when he talked about his childhood hero, Stefan Edberg, but he called it “happy tears.” Then he was brought to tears again when he spoke about his longtime coach Severin Luthi.

THRILLING JOURNEY

It’s amazing to see yourself in a place like this, says Federer



AP

Roger Federer, who celebrated his 45th birthday three weeks ago, won eight Wimbledon titles and is only one of eight men with a career Grand Slam. He clinched six Australian Opens and one French Open, in 2009. “I’m thrilled to have made the journey here,” he said. “It’s amazing to see yourself in a place like this”.

FEDERER’S WORLD

‘Not just playing, not just winning, but creating something new’



AFF

Tennis meant the world to me. Not just playing, not just winning, but creating something new. I used to serve and volley. I played way beyond the baseline sometimes, or on top of the baseline. I would even try to sneak up on my opponents on my return, and some called it the SABR (Sneak Attack By Roger) — Federer.

Fame was never the goal, but this is one of the greatest honours: Federer

The Swiss takes a trip down memory lane after being inducted into the Hall of Fame; doesn’t forget to mention the lesser-known ‘statistical milestones’ in a light-hearted speech; says he is still writing his love letter to tennis

TENNIS

Agence France-Presse
NEW YORK

A tearful Roger Federer was inducted into the International Tennis Hall of Fame on Saturday, describing his formal entry into the sport’s pantheon as one of the “greatest honours of my life.”

The 20-time Grand Slam champion was frequently overcome with emotion as he addressed a crowd bristling with tennis royalty in Newport, Rhode Island.

The 45-year-old Swiss, who retired in 2022, paid tribute to the opponents, officials, fans, family and friends during a lengthy address that unfolded as a love letter to the sport. “This is one of the greatest honours of my life,” Federer said.

“They call this the Hall of Fame, but fame was never the goal. My goal was to spend my life doing something I love... with people who I love it as much as I do.”

In a light-hearted preamble, the eight-time Wimbledon title-winner totted up his career with



Priceless moment: Federer, gushing with pride after being bestowed with the highest honour, embraces wife Mirka. GETTY IMAGES

some of his lesser-known statistical milestones. “[It is] not the obvious stats like the number of Majors or number of weeks at No. 1,” Federer said.

“I am talking about the numbers that really paint a picture. Between 1998, when I first went on the ATP Tour, and when I retired in 2022, I wore more than 5,000 headbands. That’s more than [Bjorn] Borg and [John] McEnroe combined.

“And if you think that’s impressive, I probably

wore over 7,000 pairs of socks. That’s probably twice as many as most of my opponents because I doubled them up. But really, there’s no way to measure what it means to be here.

“It’s hard to put it into words,” Federer said, reflecting on his journey from being a 13-year-old ballboy at an ATP tournament in Basel to the pinnacle of tennis.

“I really want to thank every ball kid who ever stood through my matches

or all our matches for hours,” Federer said. “I see you. I thank you. I was you.”

Inspiration

Federer had to wipe away tears as he name-checked his idol Stefan Edberg, other tennis stars, family and support staff who had inspired him throughout his career.

“I need tissues, sunglasses and everything to protect me right now,” he joked.

“This is such a mess. It

has been an incredible journey. For me, the International Tennis Hall of Fame provides a great opportunity to not only look back but also look ahead,” he added.

“As you can tell, I am still writing my love letter to tennis. My time as a player is done, but tennis will always stand at the intersection of everything I care most about: my family, our friendships, the past 40 years, the future we are building. Tennis for me is responsible for it all.”

US OPEN

Agence France-Presse
NEW YORK

World No. 3 Jessica Pegula conquered first-round nerves to ease past Elena-Gabriela Ruse after kicking off the action on Arthur Ashe Stadium here on Sunday.

Pegula broke the Romanian’s serve twice in each set on the way to a 6-3, 6-2 triumph, but it was less straightforward than the scoreline indicated as the 32-year-old veteran felt the weight of playing first on the show court.

“I was so nervous today, always the first round of a Slam,” said Pegula, the 32-year-old and the highest-ranked American here.

“It’s an amazing honour,” she said after being handed the first match on Arthur Ashe. “It’s an honour to hold that title, walking out onto Ashe opening day, first match.”

Pegula is chasing her first Slam title. She came closest with a runner-up finish to Aryna Sabalenka at the 2024 US Open, and she fell to the Belarusian in the semifinals last year.

Pegula saved the only break point she faced, but the pressure showed as she converted just two of her 14 break point chances in the opening set.



Smooth sailing: Pegula, who earned the privilege of playing first on the Arthur Ashe Stadium, made the opportunity count. REUTERS

TOP RESULTS

First round: Men: Merida (Esp) bt Fucsovics (Hun) 6-4, 6-4, 6-2; 18-Lehecka (Cze) bt Carreno Busta (Esp) 6-1, 7-6(5), 4-6, 6-2; 26-Rinderknech (Fra) bt Shimabukuro (Jpn) 6-7(4), 6-2, 7-6(4), 6-2; Wu (Chn) bt Walton (Aus) 7-6(2), 6-2, 7-5; Majchrzak (Pol) bt Medjedovic (Srb) 6-3, 6-3, 6-3.
Women: 19-Paolini (Ita) bt Erjavec (Slo) 6-3, 3-6, 6-4; Rakhimova (Rus) bt 27-Krejciikova (Cze) 7-6(4), 6-2; 3-Pegula (USA) bt Ruse (Rou) 6-3, 6-2.

That was enough, and she was an efficient two-for-four on break opportunities in the second. She gave herself a triple match point with a crisp forehand winner to the corner; however, Ruse saved two with booming serves but Pegula secured the win

Monday’s Picks

- MEN**
- 2-Alcaraz vs Safiullin
- 3-Auger-Aliassime vs Hijikata
- 8-Shelton vs Griekspoor
- 10-Fils vs Tsitsipas
- Wawrinka vs Berrettini
- WOMEN**
- 1-Sabalenka vs Osorio
- 7-Muchova vs Kraus
- 8-Swiatek vs Wang
- 10-Anisimova vs Krueger
- 13-Osaka vs Zakharova

when the Romanian put a forehead into the net.

With the first round now spread over three days, Pegula was looking forward to a couple of days off. “I get to sit around the site and watch everybody else freak out for the next two days,” she said.

Shafali on song before bowlers choke Thailand

ASIA CUP

Press Trust of India
DUBAI

Shafali Verma was at her belligerent best before Thailand’s spinners, led by Suleeporn Laomi, triggered a collapse to restrict seven-time champion India to 159 for nine in the Asia Cup match on Sunday.

In reply, Thailand was bundled out for 65 in the 17th over. Only Nannapat Koncharenkai (41) offered some resistance before she was the last batter to be dismissed. Nandani Sharma (three for 18), Shree Charani (two for 10) and Deepti Sharma (three for zero) shared the spoils. Earlier, asked to bat, India raced to 100 in 10 overs as Shafali smashed her 19th T20I fifty off just 26 balls. The opener hit eight fours and three sixes in her 36-ball 64 and looked set to propel the team past the 200-mark when the innings unravelled.

The Women in Blue lost four wickets for 21 runs as Laomi’s drift and flight had the middle-order batters in a spin. The 28-year-old leg-spinner finished with three for 26, including two wickets off successive balls as



In smashing form: Shafali blazed away to a 36-ball 64. @BCCIWOMEN

she sent back Shafali and Richa Ghosh. Off-spinner Sunida Chaturongrattana took two for 31.

Smriti Mandhana got India off to a flying start, taking 13 off the first over with three boundaries off Phanita Maya. She raced to 19 off 10 balls before Suwan-chonrathi’s direct hit from long-on caught the India vice-captain short while attempting a second run.

Debutant Pratika Rawal was castled for 22 by a de-

livery that darted back and crashed into the leg-stump. After the team slipped to 137 for nine, Kranti Gaud made an useful 15 off eight balls, with a six and a four, to take India past 150.

The scores: India 159/9 in 20 overs (Shafali 64, Sunida 2/31, Suleeporn 3/26) bt Thailand 65 in 16.1 overs (Nannapat 41, Nandani 3/18, Shree Charani 2/10, Deepti 3/0). **Toss:** Thailand; **Player-of-the-Match:** Shafali. **India’s next match: Sept. 3** vs. Hong Kong, Dubai, 8 p.m. IST.

Struthoff’s strike extends Germany’s reign

HOCKEY WORLD CUP

Aashin Prasad
WAVRE

Winning once was good, Germany had to do it one more time. An efficient German side edged Spain 1-0 in a cagey final to claim a second successive men’s World Cup title on Sunday.

It was by no means a classic at the Belifus Arena. The finalists had derailed co-host Belgium’s journey to a home World championship decider and both boasted the meanest tournament defence. It was reflected in a tightly-fought encounter, making it a hard watch for the supporters dominated by neutrals.

Not that Germany would have minded one bit. As when it mattered, late in the third quarter, Michel Struthoff kept his calm, rounding off the Spain ‘keeper Luis Calzado to put the ball into the net for the decisive goal.

Huge feat

It was a massive achievement for head coach Andre Henning, who oversaw a massive transition with only nine returnees from the 2023 group.



Ecstatic: German players celebrate the triumph. AP

Germany looked dangerous on the counter, breaking forward from deeper areas, using the wings. After just 90 seconds, Benedikt Schwarzaupt’s drag-flick was kicked out by Calzado, but it wasn’t any indication of things to come. Spain’s defence, led by Jordi Bonastre, guarded its circle, not allowing Germany to get into shot-taking positions.

Spain, meanwhile, struggled to find its rhythm until the second quarter, and didn’t test Jean-Paul Danneberg as much as it would have liked.

Spain had three short corners in the third quarter but Pepe Cunill and Marc Miralles fired wide of the post. In the third quarter, even though Spain had

the best of the exchanges, Germany remained dangerous on the counter. But a rare defensive lapse proved costly for the Iberian nation, which Struthoff capitalised on.

Chasing the equaliser, Spain took off Calzado with less than four minutes to go, but couldn’t break down a resolute German defence and its wait for a first title continued.

For the defending champion, despite its transitional state, the record-equalling fourth crown further validated Henning’s process.

The result: Final: Germany 1 (Michel Struthoff 43) bt Spain 0. **Third place:** Argentina 2 (Tomas Domene 41, Matias Rey 59) bt Netherlands 1 (Floris Middendorp 49).

United has lift-off via Fernandes hat-trick

EURO LEAGUES

Agence France-Presse
LONDON

Bruno Fernandes starred with a hat-trick in Manchester United’s 5-2 rout of Ipswich, while Chelsea extended Xabi Alonso’s perfect start with a thrilling 4-3 win against Brighton on Sunday.

Fernandes’ display ensured United bounced back from its 2-0 defeat at Hull on the opening weekend of the Premier League season. Chelsea joins Manchester City and Hull as the only sides to take six points from the opening two games.

Jude Bellingham and Kylian Mbappe both struck as Real Madrid’s perfect start

to LaLiga continued in a 4-0 cruise against Malaga.

The results: Premier League: Chelsea 4 (Lavia 4, Neto 14, Pedro 32, Palmer 74) bt Brighton 3 (Yalcouye 35, Pedro 63-og, Gross 90+6); Leeds 1 (Calvert-Lewin 79) drew with Brentford 1 (Schade 41). Sunderland 1 (Isidor 75) bt Fulham 0; Manchester United 5 (Fernandes 40, 61-pen, 68, Greaves 56-og, Mbeumo 82) bt Ipswich 2 (Davis 29).

LaLiga: Real Madrid 4 (Bellingham 19, Herrero 26-og, Mbappe 30, Guler 90+1) bt Malaga 0.

On Saturday: LaLiga: Real Sociedad 2 (Barrenechea 4, Oskarsson 61) bt Espanyol 1 (Fernandez 45); Sevilla 1 (Sierra 66) lost to Atletico Madrid 3 (Baena 4, 33, Lookman 26).

Serie A: Juventus 2 (Gonzalez 63, Koopmeiners 88) bt Parma 0.

Bundesliga: Borussia Dortmund 2 (Guirassy 9, Konstantelias 45+1) bt Hamburg 0.



Clean strike: Fernandes caps off a break-away for United’s opener. REUTERS

INBRIEF



Abhay Singh wins 13th PSA Tour title in Malaysia

Top seed Abhay Singh clinched the Tuanku Muhriz Trophy squash, a \$15,000 PSA Challenger event in Negeri Sembilan, Malaysia on Sunday, defeating third seed Henry Leung of Hong Kong 11-7, 6-11, 3-11, 11-5, 12-10 to bag his 13th PSA Tour title in 18 finals. Abhay beat the Malaysian trio of Ameeshenraj Chandaran 7-11, 11-9, 11-7, 7-11, 11-3 in the semifinals, Md. Syafiq Kamal 11-4, 11-13, 11-5, 11-5 in the quarterfinals and Low Wa Sern 8-11, 11-2, 11-6, 11-2 in the second round following a first-round bye.



Chennai Bulls dominates the opening day of the ECL

Chennai Bulls, representing Tamil Nadu, proved its dominance by leading the team and overall standings on day one of the National-level Equestrian Champions League (ECL) at an arena near the Equestrian Crest in Molapalayam near Coimbatore on Saturday.

Team standings (100 cms & 110 cms): 1. Chennai Bulls (Tamil Nadu) 115 points, 2. Golconda Chargers (Telangana) 72, 3. Elite Equestrians (West Bengal) 63.
120 cms: 1. Pegasus Sports (Kerala) 50, Elite Equestrians 45, Bangalore Knights (Karnataka) 40.
Overall: 1. Chennai Bulls 180, 2. Golconda Chargers 121, 3. Pegasus Sports 111.

Chelsea signs Emiliano Martinez from Villa

Argentina’s 2022 World Cup-winning goalkeeper Emiliano Martinez has joined Chelsea from fellow Premier League outfit Aston Villa, the London-based club announced on Sunday. The 33-year-old has signed a three-year contract with Chelsea, following a deal worth £7.5 million, according to British media.

LIVE TELECAST

Duleep Trophy: Day 2, JioHotstar, 9.30 a.m.
T20I tri-series: Namibia vs Zimbabwe, FanCode, 5.30 p.m.
Women’s T20 Asia Cup: Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 8 p.m.
US Open: SS Select 1, 2 & JioHotstar, 8.30 p.m. & 4.30 a.m. (Tuesday)
Serie A: Unite8 Sports 1, 2 & Z5 App, 10 p.m. & 12.15 a.m. (Tuesday)
LaLiga: FanCode, 11 p.m. & 1 a.m. (Tuesday)
Premier League: SS Select 1 & JioHotstar, 12.30 a.m. (Tuesday)

Moonveil obliges in the Coromandel Gromor Deccan Fillies Championship

RACING

HYDERABAD: Trainer S.S. Attaollahi’s filly Moonveil, ridden by P. Trevor, won the Coromandel Gromor Deccan Fillies Championship the main attraction of Sunday’s (Aug. 30) races here. The winner is owned by M/s. Blazing Saddles (PF), M/s. Maloji Baburao Bhosale, Gaurav Gopalkrishnan Sethi & Sulaiman S. Attaollahi. Moonveil, who was settled in third position till the bend, was ridden out vigorously by Trevor in the straight. The filly responded well to the urgings and held off the late challenge from Madante and Vortex to claim the first classic of the Hyderabad Monsoon Races.
1. CARTER PRINCESS PLATE (1,800m): THEOS (P. Trevor) 1, Mandate (Antony Raj) 2, Sugra (Arjun) 3 and Orionale (Imran Chisty) 4. 1-1/2, Dist and 1/2. Im. 53.94s. ₹24 (w), 12 and 10 (p). SHP: 33, THP: 20, FP: 42, Q: 13, Tanala: 62. Favourite: Mandate. Owner: Mr. C. Aryama Sundaram. Trainer: S.S. Attaollahi.
NOTE:Una Paloma Blanca was declared a non-starter by the stewards after an inquiry.
2. BELMONT PRINCE PLATE (1,800m): MAJESTIC LEGACY (Antony Raj) 1, Digital Empress (Sandesh) 2, Tipped Off (Vivek G) 3 and Wesetheamesun (Rafique Sk.) 4. 2-3/4, 1-1/4 and 5-3/4. Im. 53.79s. ₹53 (w), 14, 10 and 10 (p). SHP: 23, THP: 50, FP: 295, Q: 104. Tanala: 469. Favourite: Tipped Off. Owners: Mr. Arun Alagappan rep. Arun Alagappan Racing LLP



Rewarding a champion: A representative of Moonveil’s co-owner Blazing Saddles, left, receiving the winner’s trophy from Madhab Adhikari of Coromandel International Ltd. in the presence of HRC chairman R. Surender Reddy, third from left, and steward V. Krishna Das. G. RAMAKRISHNA

& Mr. Rajendran rep. Rapar’s Galloping Stars LLP. Mr. Haider Soomar & Mr. Chandrakanth Kankaria. Trainer: Darius Byramji.
3. BHAGYANAGAR MILLION (1,400m): ECHOES OF TIME (A. Ashad Asbar) 1, Perception (Naresh) 2, Cherie Chevalier (P. Sai K) 3 and African Gold (Sandesh) 4. 3/4, 1-1/2 and 3/4. Im. 24.74s. ₹37 (w), 25, 12 and 25 (p). SHP: 40, THP: 87, FP: 152, Q: 99, Tanala: 4. 625. Favourite: African Gold. Owner: Mr. S. Ganapathy. Trainer: Aravind Ganapathy.
4. DIRECTOR GENERAL ARTILLERY CUP (1,100m): WIN ME OVER

The men’s team selection process leaves a lot to be desired

While there are 16 selectors who should take turns to pick the squads, Walmiki and Chinglensana were not invited to do so for almost two years



Under a cloud: The squad’s abysmal World Cup campaign has raised many questions. PTI

HOCKEY

Uthra Ganesan
NEW DELHI

With the Indian men’s hockey team returning a disappointing performance at the recent World Cup, questions have already been raised over coach Craig Fulton’s role and the continuation of several senior players in the side. But what has gone unnoticed is the role of selectors; specifically, the ones who selected the team. However, questioning the selectors is easier said than done, given the complete opacity around Hockey India’s selection committee and its workings. According to the Hockey India website itself, there are 16 selectors that take turns for selection duty besides the chief coaches, scientific advisors / doctors / physiotherapists and the High Performance Director. In reality, the same people have been going around for years.

Consider this: Yuvraj Walmiki and Chinglensana Singh Kangujam, the youngest of the lot, have not been informed or invited for selection duties for almost two years. Rajnish Mishra hasn’t been called since 2024 either, as has Sameer Dad. M.M. Somaya had already written earlier this year requesting to be removed as a selector after being repeatedly ignored. Sardar Singh and Rani Rampal, as chief coaches of the men’s and women’s national sub-junior sides respectively, have remained wrapped up with team duties. Mishra too has been entrusted Under-18 coaching duties along with Sardar. Asunta Lakra has been sidelined. The post of High Performance Director has been vacant since September 2024, when Dutchman Herman Kruijs’s six-month tenure got over. On the other hand, BP Govinda, Balwinder Singh and Mohd. Riaz besides RP Singh in his role as the chairman travel everywh-

ere. “I wasn’t called for selection duties for almost two years. Only when I myself called up to suggest that I travel from Mumbai for the junior women’s Nationals recently in Pune on my own was I told that I had been, in fact, already removed as a selector,” Walmiki confirmed to *The Hindu*. As per the Hockey India constitution, selectors are appointed and removed by the executive committee. In reality, the EC is hardly ever consulted. “The executive board has been completely bypassed for everything. It is frankly frustrating,” EC member Asima Ali admitted. “Many of the younger selectors had suggested putting a plan in place even before Paris, knowing that it could be the end for some senior players. But HI and the chief coach overruled everyone who opposed. Over time, we have not been called up even for domestic competitions,” one selector alleged.

South Delhi Superstarz rules the final, wins maiden title

DPL

Sports Bureau
NEW DELHI

South Delhi Superstarz won the third edition of the Delhi Premier League after easing past Central Delhi Kings by seven wickets in the final at the Arun Jaitley Stadium here on Sunday. This is Superstarz’s first men’s title. In pursuit of 183, Superstarz rode on Anmol Sharma’s 62 and Ankit Dabas’ unbeaten 62 to register victory with 10 balls to spare. The duo added 89 runs for the second wicket. Earlier, Kings, asked to bat, got off to a solid start owing to Samarth Singh’s half-century. While Siddharth Joon was dismissed in the opening over, Samarth forged an 87-run stand with Yugal Saini. Once Samarth departed



Painting the town red: Superstarz got past the finish line with 10 deliveries to spare. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

in the 10th over after making 51 off 27 deliveries, the onus was on Yugal and Jonty Sidhu to step up. Yugal chipped in with a 29-ball 32 while Jonty raced to 36 off 19 deliveries. In the latter overs, however, Aditya Bhandari failed to capitalise. Having walked in at No. 6, he

stumbled to 13 off 20 balls, depriving the men in yellow of a robust finish. **The scores:** Central Delhi Kings 182/8 in 20 overs (Samarth Singh 51, Yugal Saini 32, Jonty Sidhu 36, Vision Panchal 2/17, Divansh Rawat 3/17) lost to South Delhi Superstarz 186/3 in 18.2 overs (Anmol Sharma 62, Ankit Dabas 62 n.o., Tejasvi Dahiya 33).

Emmanuel’s noble work for a ‘Bright’ football future in Rwanda

S. Shrivathsan
CHENNAI

For 120-odd football-mad kids at Kigali in Rwanda, Chennaiyin FC’s new signing Emmanuel Imanishimwe is the “president”. Wonder why? The Rwanda international is a co-founder of the football school where the children are having a ball. In a bid for a better tomorrow, Emmanuel had set up the Bright Football Academy in the company of former National-team colleague Dany Usengimana. The kids handpicked via trials in the capital city receive training, clothing and equipment for free while those who enrol themselves at the centre on their own are charged a nominal fee. It is all about “giving back” to the beautiful game for the 31-year-old. “The person who coached me when I was young (Eric Habimana) is now heading our academy.



Positive outlook: Emmanuel is set for his maiden ISL season and is confident that CFC will do well. CHENNAIYN FC

I wanted to do something for him... I want the youngsters to be successful. That is why I am doing everything I can,” Emmanuel, set for his maiden Indian Super League, told *The Hindu*. “We select players from Kigali to come to our academy. Our sponsors and well-wishers have also contributed to this journey. We want to make it a bigger project in the future. It is not easy in terms of fund-

ing, but we will keep trying,” he added. Emmanuel’s magnanimity, though, does not extend to the pitch he competes on. “We, at Chennaiyin, want to win something. I feel that we will do something. We have good players and we are going to fight.” A ‘Bright’ beginning in Indian football is what the versatile defender is aiming for.

N R I Triple Power should score an encore in Mahabubabad Plate

HYDERABAD: The four-year-old filly N R I Triple Power, who won well in her last start, should score an encore in the Mahabubabad Plate, the chief event of Monday’s (Aug. 31) races.
1. A. KRISHNASWAMY MEMORIAL TROPHY (DIV. III), (1,200m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 40 to 65 (Cat. II), 1.00 p.m.: 1. Dyanoosh (1) Afroz K 60.5, 2. Shadow Fax (4) Mukesh K 59, 3. Tootsie Darling (6) Akshay K 55.5, 4. Vital Sign (2) B.R. Kumar 54.5, 5. State Man (3) D.S. Deora 53.5, 6. Shah Of Iran (7) Uday Kiran 52, 7. Red Hot Punch (–) and 8. Top In Class (5) B. Nikhil 51.5.
1. TOOTSIE DARLING, 2. SHADOW FAX, 3. DYANOOSH
2. GADWAL PLATE (1,200m), (Terms), Maiden 3-y-o only (Cat. II), 1.35: 1. Modin (5) Akshay K 56, 2. Noble Fella (7) Arjun 56, 3. Vinfast (2) Neeraj 56, 4. Bayone (6) D.S. Deora 54.5, 5. Gacchanmanasvin (1) M.S. Deora 54.5, 6. Goddess Of Light (4) Md. Ekram 54.5, 7. She’s A Bomb (8) Mukesh K 54.5 and 8. Vespucci (3) Mohit 54.5.
1. MODIN, 2. VINFAST, 3. BAYONE
3. A. KRISHNASWAMY MEMORIAL TROPHY (DIV. II), (1,200m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 40 to 65 (Cat. II), 2.10: 1. Perfect Attitude (1) Antony Raj 61, 2. Best Buddy (8) Md. Ekram 59, 3. Catchme If You Can (2) B. Nikhil 56.5, 4. Federer (6). Ajeeth K 55, 5. Arion One (3) B.R. Kumar 54.5, 6. Home Run (5) Akshay K 52, 7. Calabazas (7) Ajay K 51.5 and 8. Juramento (4) Surya Prakash 50.5.
1. PERFECT ATTITUDE, 2. FEDERER, 3. BEST BUDDY

4. FATEH MAIDAN CLUB TROPHY (DIV. II), (1,400m), 5-y-o and upward, rated 20 to 45 (Cat. III), 2.45: 1. Lazarus (6) Antony Raj 62, Bold Beauty (9) Santosh Raj 61, 3. Great Giver (5) Mukesh K 60.5, 4. Sunny Day (3) P. Ajeeth K 60.5, 5. Dino (7) Akshay K 60, 6. Wining Attitude (2) Afroz K 58, 7. Hoping High (1) Mohit 54.5, 8. Exclusive Luck (8) B. Nikhil 54 and 9. Silver Lining (4) Uday Kiran 54.
1. DINO, 2. LAZARUS, 3. HOPING HIGH
5. FATEH MAIDAN CLUB TROPHY (DIV. I), (1,400m), 5-y-o and upward, rated 20 to 45 (Cat. III), 3.20: 1. Emperors Charm (8) A.A. Vikrant 62, 2. Tiger Ruby (6) Mukesh K 62, 3. Tiger Ruby (6) Surya Prakash 61, 4. Knotty Seniorita (5) Kuldeep Sr. 60.5, 5. Sargent (7) Imran Chisty 59.5, 6. Sadiya (4) P. Ajeeth K 56, 7. Dhanadeepa (9) B. Nikhil 54.5, 8. Noorain (10) Md. Ismail 54.5, 9. Shubhrak (3) Rafique Sk. 54 and 10. Politics (1) Arjun 50.
1. EMPERORS CHARM, 2. FIRST LADY, 3. SARGENT
6. A. KRISHNASWAMY MEMORIAL TROPHY (DIV. I), (1,200m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 40 to 65 (Cat. II), 3.55: 1. Pacific Heights (3) Kuldeep Sr. 61, 2. China Town (2) Surya Prakash 59.5, 3. Mystical Dawn (6) P. Ajeeth K 58, 4. Turiya (4) Abhay Singh 54, 5. Dontblockmyway (5) Afroz K 53.5, 6. Petra Act (9) D.S. Deora 52.5, 7. Shooting Star (7) Md. Ekram 52, 8. Daring Spirit (8) Akshay K 51.5 and 9. Normul (1) B. Nikhil 50.
1. DARING SPIRIT, 2. MYSTICAL DAWN, 3. PACIFIC HEIGHTS



Marquez. AFP

Marc Marquez wins Aragon MotoGP

Agence France-Presse
ALCANIZ (SPAIN)

Marc Marquez claimed victory at the Aragon MotoGP on Sunday, with Pedro Acosta finishing second and Marco Bezzecchi third. Seven-time MotoGP champion Marquez has a strong record at the MotorLand circuit and climbed to second in the overall standings behind Jorge Martin, who came fifth. It was Marquez’s fourth win of the season, all of those coming within the last six races as he reignited his title bid in spectacular fashion.

Devbhoomi Uttarakhand Hub of Growth and Investment



Policy
Reforms



Financial
Incentives



Institutional
Support

Under the visionary leadership of PM Narendra Modi and the impeccable governance of CM Pushkar Singh Dhami, policy reforms, financial incentives, and institutional support have made Uttarakhand a robust ecosystem for MSMEs and startups



ALL PICS: DPIR, UTTARAKHAND GOVT



I congratulate the Uttarakhand government on the remarkable progress achieved in the last few years through sustained policy push and focus on key sectors such as tourism and renewable energy. The state has made significant strides in infrastructure, setting new benchmarks for sustainable growth. U'khand's commitment to harnessing its natural resources and promoting tourism will bolster its economy and showcase its potential on the global stage.

Narendra Modi,
Prime Minister

The investment-related agreements made with the industry groups during the investor conference are now rapidly coming to the ground. This is also creating new employment opportunities in Uttarakhand. We are providing all possible assistance to set up industries. With strong infrastructure and peaceful environment, Uttarakhand has emerged as the choice of investors.

Pushkar Singh Dhami,
chief minister

The Uttarakhand government has unveiled a comprehensive action plan to bolster the Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSME) sector, with a focus on positioning the state as a global hub for startups, green industries, and high-quality local products. The new MSME policy emphasises sustainable, inclusive, and employment-generating enterprises, while ensuring ease of doing business for investors.

MSMES AT THE CORE OF STATE ECONOMY

Micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) are the backbone of Uttarakhand's economy, driving employment, local enterprise and value creation. The government's renewed focus on the sector is encouraging startups that harness local resources, alongside investments in renewable energy, green industries and clean manufacturing. By strengthening infrastructure, easing business processes and promoting local enterprise, these initiatives are attracting fresh investment, expanding manufacturing and creating new employment opportunities. Together, they are enabling MSMEs to contribute more strongly to economic growth, livelihoods and inclusive development across the state.

POLICY PUSH AND ACTION PLAN

To accelerate economic growth, Uttarakhand is strengthening both new and existing enterprises through technology

upgradation, easier access to finance and markets, streamlined procedures and investment incentives. The One District One Product (ODOP) and One District Two Products (ODTP) initiatives, supported by GI-tagging, are helping showcase the state's distinctive products, strengthen local value chains and expand market opportunities. Aligned with national programmes such as Startup India, Stand-Up India, Make in India and MUDRA, these efforts are attracting investment, encouraging entrepreneurship and strengthening the "Make in Uttarakhand" identity in wider markets.

INCLUSIVE AND SUSTAINABLE GROWTH

The government is committed to ensuring that growth in the MSME sector is inclusive, providing special support to women entrepreneurs, the Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe communities, and entrepreneurs with disabilities (Divyang). To assist these groups in scaling their businesses and accessing new opportunities, additional financial incentives, subsidies, and dedicated helplines are being introduced.

STRENGTHENING INSTITUTIONAL SUPPORT

District Industry Centres (DICs) are being modernised to provide technical facilities, project preparation, and advisory support to

Financial incentives and subsidies

The new MSME policy provides a range of financial benefits to enterprises:

- ▶ Stamp duty reimbursement of upto 100% based on the category
- ▶ Capital subsidy of up to 50% on plant and machinery
- ▶ Extra capital investment subsidy of upto 5% under 'Priority' categories and upto 10% under 'Most Priority' categories
- ▶ An additional 5% subsidy for SC, ST, women, and divyang entrepreneurs
- ▶ Interest subsidy reimbursement of up to ₹21 lakh, depending upon the category
- ▶ Reimbursement of electricity duty for five years for new enterprises with a sanctioned load of up to 500 KW
- ▶ Recognition through ZED certification
- ▶ To encourage quality manufacturing, MSMEs are being offered certification under the Zero Defect Zero Effect (ZED) scheme. Units certified under gold, silver, and bronze categories receive recognition along with a monetary award of upto ₹75,000 per unit

entrepreneurs. A single-window clearance system is being streamlined to ensure faster approvals.

Additionally, an Investment Promotion and Facilitation Centre has been established at the Directorate of Industries to serve as a one-stop solution for investors and businesspersons. Special helpline services for women and differently-abled entrepreneurs are also being introduced.

FOCUS ON SKILL DEVELOPMENT AND MODERN TECHNIQUES

The policy also emphasises the need to equip young entrepreneurs with modern skills. To this end, the state is collaborating with reputed government and non-government organisations to provide training in:

- Manufacturing techniques
- Product design and packaging
- Marketing and branding strategies

MARKETING AND GLOBAL OUTREACH

The Uttarakhand Handloom and Handicraft Development Council is being engaged to promote state products in both national and international markets. Increased use of e-commerce platforms and commercial online portals will ensure that local enterprises gain greater visibility and a global reach. By encouraging innovation while preserving local traditions, the state aims to establish itself as a hub for sustainable and inclusive industries.

STATE'S NEW TOURISM SECTOR POLICY



INCENTIVES PROVIDED UNDER THE POLICY

The policy provides the following incentives to eligible tourism units:

- ▶ Capital subsidy for hospitality (accommodation-related projects)
- ▶ Capital Subsidy
- ▶ Incentives for marketing and promotion
- ▶ Incentives for training and skilling
- ▶ Interest subvention
- ▶ Incentive for waste treatment
- ▶ Incentive for generating bookings through State Online Travel Agency
- ▶ Capital subsidy for investments in tourism products and services
- ▶ Subsidies for projects and units not eligible for capital subsidy
- ▶ Incentive for high-value premium hospitality
- ▶ Incentives for foreign tourists
- ▶ Organisation of MICE, art, social and cultural events, fairs and festivals
- ▶ Incentives for promotion of Heli transport
- ▶ Exemption on electricity duty
- ▶ Exemption on stamp duty

The geographical, cultural, and environmental diversity of Uttarakhand has positioned it as one of the most visited states in North India. The number of tourists visiting Uttarakhand has consistently increased from ~22 million in 2014 to ~39 million in 2019 and registered a CAGR of 11.97%. A recent World Tourism and Travel Council (WTTC) report has pegged India as the 7th largest tourism economy globally in terms of absolute size and further forecasts the sector to grow at 7% between 2017 and 2027. The state of Uttarakhand is expected to match this trend in terms of tourist arrivals.

The state's new Tourism Policy envisages to chalk out a sustainable development strategy for tourism sector in the state. The role of the State Government and its Departments is envisaged to revolve around policy, regulation and promotion of tourism; while provision of services like accommodation, tourist facilitation, transportation, organisation of tours, activities, events, etc. will be the purview of the private sector, with State playing an enabling role.

LEVERAGING PRIVATE SECTOR INVESTMENTS

The policy underscores the fact that future tourism development in Uttarakhand would also benefit from private sector capital and expertise. In this regard, the government places immense faith in private-public sector relationships to further the cause of tourism development. For this to take effect expeditiously, the State would:

i) reduce their role in areas where private

sector participation is encouraged (such as development and provision of accommodation), and
ii) enhance ease of doing business (investor facilitation) by strengthening single window clearance process for faster approvals of tourism entities.

ELIGIBLE TOURISM UNITS

This policy supports and incentivises both existing and planned tourism projects. For the purpose of eligibility for capital subsidy¹ under this policy, those projects / enterprises which are new as well as those going for expansion / diversification as of the date of application for subsidy shall be considered.

For eligibility for turnover-linked incentives under this policy, those projects / enterprises which are operational as of the date of application for subsidy shall be considered.

The state intends to concentrate its efforts on the following 'Focus Tourism':

Segments over the policy period:

- ▶ Nature and Adventure Tourism
- ▶ Health and Wellness Tourism
- ▶ Religious and Cultural Tourism
- ▶ Heritage Tourism
- ▶ MICE Tourism



Uttarakhand Pumped Storage Project Policy

This policy aims to set forth key objectives and mechanisms for development of Pumped Storage Projects in Uttarakhand. Pumped Storage Projects will be categorised in two main categories:

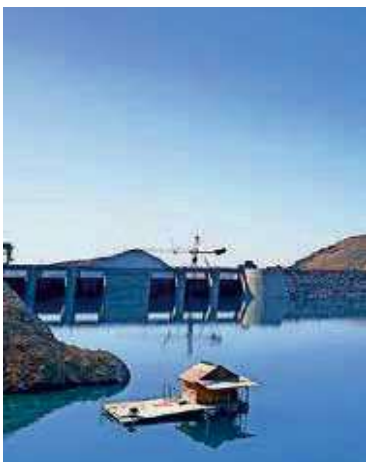
- **On-stream projects:** At least one storage located on river stream. The state government designated agency will identify on-stream projects from time to time. The projects may be allocated to CPSUs or State PSUs on nomination basis and to private developers through competitive bidding. The period of allocation and terms and conditions shall be as defined under this policy
- **Off-stream sites:** No storage located on river stream: The state government will invite developers to identify suitable sites for off-stream Pumped Storage Projects (PSPs) and submit proposals with details of their viability and storage potential. After evaluation, suitable projects will be

approved and formalised through an MoU/agreement with the developer

SUPPORT AND INCENTIVES

To encourage PSP development in state, the following support and incentives shall be offered:

- **Exemption of intra-state transmission charges:** PSP Developers shall be billed not more than 50% of intra-state transmission charges for a period of five years from the project CoD, if project CoD is before end of FY2033-34
- **Exemption of Local Area Development Fund:** Local Area Development Fund shall not be applicable to off-stream PSPs for the projects where power is purchased by state government
- **Exemption of free royalty power:** The state government shall not collect any free royalty power from Pumped Storage Projects



Policy objectives

Facilitate development of Pumped Storage Projects in the state and support state's growing energy demand in a sustainable manner.

- ▶ Harness the PSP potential in the state and encourage development of self-identified off-stream sites
- ▶ Leverage PSPs to generate public and private investment
- ▶ Encourage integration of renewable energy sources into the grid by promoting PSPs
- ▶ Leverage PSP storage to fulfil the drinking and irrigation needs of the regions wherever required and feasible

AYUSH Policy



AYUSH has remained a core part of Uttarakhand's culture and tradition over the years. The state has multiple natural and cultural endowments which make it an ideal destination for AYUSH.

Some key endowments include the presence of rare medicinal herbs, a well-established AYUSH manufacturing sector, a strong ancient community of practitioners and presence of destinations conducive for AYUSH healing.

KEY ACTIONS AND INCENTIVES

MEDICINAL PLANTS

- ▶ Promote Good Agricultural Practices (GAP), quality standards and technology such as drones for better cultivation and monitoring
- ▶ Develop cold-storage facilities and aggregation platforms
- ▶ Introduce assured buy-back mechanisms and promote medicinal-plant cultivation
- ▶ Build a distinctive Uttarakhand/ Himalayan brand for key medicinal

AYUSH MANUFACTURING

- ▶ Provide additional capital subsidies for eligible AYUSH manufacturing units and encourage cluster-based manufacturing
- ▶ Promote WHO-GMP, AYUSH premium and AYUSH standard certifications
- ▶ Establish common testing laboratories and a dedicated Homeopathic Drug Testing Laboratory
- ▶ Position Uttarakhand as a leading AYUSH manufacturing hub

HEALTHCARE

- ▶ Encourage NABH accreditation of

AYUSH hospitals and clinics through financial support and easier empanelment under state health schemes

- ▶ Strengthen government AYUSH hospitals and expand teleconsultation and digital healthcare services
- ▶ Promote Yoga as a tool for preventive healthcare and encourage private investment in AYUSH healthcare infrastructure
- ▶ Develop AYUSH Grams to involve local communities
- ▶ Provide additional capital incentives for eligible wellness centres, hotels and resorts in hill regions
- ▶ Promote AYUSH parks, yoga and meditation centres and wellness destinations through PPPs and private investment
- ▶ Undertake domestic and international campaigns to position Uttarakhand as a leading global wellness destination

EDUCATION & RESEARCH

- ▶ Incentivise NAAC accreditation and strengthen the quality of AYUSH education
- ▶ Introduce apprenticeships, internships and research programmes through collaborations with leading national and international institution
- ▶ Promote research in Yoga, Naturopathy and the integration of traditional and modern medicine
- ▶ Strengthen faculty training, professional upskilling and documentation of Uttarakhand's traditional AYUSH knowledge



Kaverappa's strikes put South in command on the opening day

The pacer runs through North's lower middle-order in a four-wicket burst; opening batter Qamran, who was reprieved twice, scores a patient 76 with his unorthodox technique

DULEEP TROPHY

N. Sudarshan
BENGALURU

Vidwath Kaverappa (four for 66) helped South Zone take the honours on day one of its Duleep Trophy semifinal against North Zone at the BCCI Centre of Excellence here on Sunday.

After opting to bat, North was shot out for 195, with opener Qamran Iqbal doing the bulk of the scoring with his unorthodox technique (76, 182b, 10x4, 1x6).

But the Jammu & Kashmir batter was reprieved twice by Ricky Bhui, who grassed a catch at first slip when Qamran was on 16 and fluffed an easy run-out just before lunch.

At stumps, South was 40 for two, having lost opener Bhui and one drop Shaik Rasheed in the space of 16 balls.

Much will depend on how the batting line-up – sans Karun Nair, who was not included in the playing XI – tackles the North pace trio of Gurnoor Brar, Arshdeep Singh and Anshul Kamboj in Monday's opening session.

On a pitch that visibly lacked pace, Kaverappa bowled a disciplined line, especially in his second



In a cluster: Kaverappa, centre, bagged all of his wickets in his second spell. ALLEN EGENUSE J.

spell where he picked up all four of his wickets (8-2-28-4).

North was in an advantageous position twice but couldn't capitalise. From 71 for one, it was reduced to 95 for four, with the highlight being the wicket of the dangerous Abdul Samad, who was caught splendidly by a diving R. Smaran at slip off leggie Shreyas Gopal.

Qamran and skipper Kanhaiya Wadhawan took North to 161 for four only

for Kaverappa to run through the lower middle-order by removing Nishant Sindhu, Abid Mushtaq and Kamboj – all of them decent batters – after left-arm spinner Tanay Thyagarajann bowled Wadhawan.

Kaverappa accounted for Qamran too, with the batter's attempted hook after walking down the pitch ending as a catch to 'keeper N. Jagadeesan.

On the adjacent ground, defending champion Central Zone fared much bet-

ter, making 266 against East Zone. Rinku Singh top-scored with a brisk 60 (88b, 8x4), and there was also a 45-run partnership for the last wicket between Aryan Panday (22, 46b, 2x4) and Yash Thakur (30 n.o., 26b, 6x4).

The scores: North Zone 195 in 59.1 overs (Qamran Iqbal 76, Vidwath Kaverappa 4/66) vs. South Zone 40/2 in 18 overs; **Toss:** North.

Central Zone 266 in 80.1 overs (Aryan Juyal 46, Rinku Singh 60) vs. East Zone; **Toss:** East.

Used injury break to become a better bowler: Kaverappa



Making it count: Kaverappa has ensured a good start to the new domestic season. ALLEN EGENUSE J.

N. Sudarshan
BENGALURU

In the eight months from July 2023 to February 2024, Vidwath Kaverappa's career was on an upward trajectory.

The Karnataka pacer was the Player of the Series in Duleep Trophy (15 wickets in two games), played for India-A against South Africa-A and England Lions, and took 25 wickets from five matches in the 2023-24 Ranji Trophy at an average of 20.16.

But the 2024-25 season was a washout, troubled as he was by a stress fracture in his shin, and played just two First Class games.

In 2025-26, he was fit, but was not an automatic choice when V. Vyshak and Prasidh Krishna were available, missing out on the Ranji Trophy semifinal and final, against Uttarakhand and Jammu & Kashmir, respectively.

However, with a four-wicket haul for South Zone on the opening day of the 2026-27 Duleep Trophy semifinal versus North

Zone, Kaverappa signalled his desire to make the upcoming campaign count and return to his best.

"I am not really over the moon or something like that," the 27-year-old told reporters on Sunday at the BCCI Centre of Excellence. "I'm just taking one game at a time and not thinking too far ahead. I know the kind of bowling I can produce. So I cannot relax or be complacent with this."

Kaverappa admitted that the injury came at a wrong time in his career, but stated that he used the break to become a better bowler.

"I just thought about what best I can do and what I can add to my arsenal. And that's how I added a little bit more strength, and made a few corrections to my action."

Between then and now, Kaverappa said that he was a lot more mature.

"I am more in tune with my bowling. I am not chasing things that don't work. I just focus on things that work and use it at the best possible time."

Robinson rocks as England wins series

PAKISTAN IN ENGLAND

Agence France-Presse
LONDON

England clinched a series victory over Pakistan with a thumping 194-run win in the second Test at Lord's here on Sunday.

Pakistan, set an improbable target of 389, was dismissed for 194 on the fourth day to hand England an unbeatable 2-0 lead in the three-match series.

Pacer Ollie Robinson tormented Pakistan again, taking two wickets in four balls, before express fast bowler Jofra Archer dismissed Pakistan captain Babar Azam to leave the away team at 14 for three.

While Robinson also accounted for Shan Masood and Mohammad Rizwan in back-to-back overs, Saud Shakeel (97) restored some self-respect for Pakistan



Robinson. GETTY IMAGES

before he holed out to fast bowler Josh Tongue, who polished off the tail.

Pakistan was much happier in the first hour, with the 36-year-old Mohammad Abbas making it to the Lord's honours board for the first time after bowling England out for 208.

The scores: England 290 & 208 in 54.2 overs (Lawrence 54, Abbas 5/57) bt Pakistan 110 & 194 in 50.5 overs (Shakeel 97, Robinson 4/24).

Kairav, Rehan, Shiv and Aruthran book berths in IAME Asia Finals

MOTORSPORTS

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

Kairav Roberson (MSPORT), Rehan Khan Rasheed (Momentum Motorsports), Shiv Neel (NKRA by KKM) and Aruthran Prabhu (Kartkrew Motorsports) emerged overall winners in the senior, junior, mini and mini under-10 categories of the inaugural IAME Series India 2026 at the Madras International Karting Arena here on Saturday night.

Kairav, who topped all sessions, completed his dominance by crossing the line first in the super heat and final.

Rehan sealed the junior title, taking the second spot in super heat and winning the final.

Shiv secured the mini crown despite finishing second in the finale, as he had a points advantage over Rudra Gokulnath going into the decider.

The four champions booked tickets to the IAME Asia Finals in Macau (December 11 to 13).

Kartkrew Motorsports clinched the senior and under-10 titles while Momentum Motorsports (junior) and NKRA by KKM (mini) were the other winners.

The results (provisional):
X30-125cc: Seniors: Final (8 laps): 1. Kairav Roberson (MSPORT) 8:16.115s; 2. Vansh Benani (Kartkrew Motorsports) 8:59.062s; 3. V.V. Viswajit (Kartkrew Motorsports), 9:09.842s.
Super Heat (14 laps): 1. Kairav 11:41.664s; 2. Jaden Hadriel (MSPORT) 12:04.984s; 3. Vansh 12:06.116s.
Juniors: Final (8 laps): 1. Rehan Khan Rasheed (Momentum Motorsports) 8:48.336s; 2. Abhishikt Barse (Crest



Dashing: Rehan, right, took home the junior title after coming up trumps in the final.



Doing enough: Shiv earned the top prize in the mini class despite finishing second.



On top: IAME Series India 2026 overall winners Kairav, Aruthran, Shiv and Rehan. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Motorsports) 8:57.420s; 3. Adithya Prathap (Momentum) 9:17.334s.
Super Heat (12 laps): 1. Barse 10:13.092s; 2. Yashvinraam Rajamanickam (Momentum) 10:20.418s; 3. Rehan 10:21.017s.
X30-60cc mini class: Final (6 laps): 1. Rudra Gokulnath (NKRK

by KKM) 6:50.889s; 2. Shiv Neel (NKRA) 6:51.738s; 3. Ridhaan Anil Kumarr (Red Rabbit Racers) 7:12.822s.
Super Heat (9 laps): 1. Shiv 8:20.451s; 2. Rudra 8:20.474s; 3. Ridhaan 8:26.484s.
Mini under-10: Finals (6 laps):

1. Aruthran Prabhu (Katkrew) 7:07.114s; 2. Ayansh Patil (MSPORT) 7:29.061s; 3. Abdur Rehman (Momentum) 7:43.208.
Super Heat (9 laps): 1. Ayansh 8:25.730s; 2. Aruthran 8:30.493s; 3. Guru Tharun (Kartkrew) 8:31.356s.



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R. Kaushik

Even before November 1999, a host of exceptional wicketkeeper-batters had graced the international scene, not least India's own Farokh Engineer and the wonderful Andy Flower from Zimbabwe. But from the time a left-hander from Western Australia stormed the Test firmament at the Gabba in Brisbane nearly 27 years back with a bruising 81 on debut, against a shell-shocked Pakistani outfit, wicketkeeper-batters have been looked at in an entirely different vein.

Adam Gilchrist rewrote the dynamics of Test batsmanship. He was a destructive opener in limited-overs cricket long before he played his first Test, and reeled off numerous wondrous knocks, including in the final of the 50-over 2007 World Cup when, with a squash ball for company, he bludgeoned his way to 149 against Mahela Jaywardene's Sri Lanka in a decisive effort that took Australia to a hat-trick of titles. But it was in the red-ball game that Gilchrist set stall as a pioneer, providing not just meaningful heft to the Australian batting but scoring runs at such a furious clip that opponents were often ducking, unsuccessfully, for cover.

For the most part of his glittering career that encompassed 96 Tests, the left-hander had the luxury of batting behind a grand top six that used different methodologies to subjugate bowling attacks in all parts of the world. The sight of Gilchrist, the destroyer supreme, striding in purposefully at No. 7, was dispiriting or exhilarating, depending on which side of the fence one was. Gilchrist seldom disappointed; when he scored his runs, he did so with not just panache and chutzpah but also with a violent streak that damaged bowling figures as well as egos. How could anyone bat with such unchecked aggression at No. 7? How could someone fuse a no-holds-barred approach with such consistency (as an average of 47.60 at a strike-rate of 81.95 will unequivocally testify to)?

Gold standard

Gilchrist will remain the gold standard among wicketkeeper-batters, the platform from which the likes of Mahendra Singh Dhoni, more than anyone else, launched himself into the stratosphere. Gilchrist's towering presence kept an entire

generation - or more - of Aussie stumper-batters out of international reckoning. India, however, found a judicious balance; while Dhoni's aggression in front of the stumps and his brilliance behind it precluded a dynamic new force breaking through, India were

Despite the vast array of batting riches at India's disposal, head coach Gambhir has identified Jurel as a dependable batting option, and the man from Uttar Pradesh has comprehensively justified that faith

compelled to find a place, if only as a specialist batter, for Dinesh Karthik, the ebullient little right-hander from Chennai who was more than good enough to hold his own as a batter.

Karthik wasn't the first Indian gloveman to play as a specialist batter. Nearly four decades before him, Budhi Kunderan donned that role, even opening the batting in England in 1967 alongside designated wicketkeeper Engineer. A couple of decades on, Chandrakant Pandit played as a middle-order bat with Kiran More slotting in as the wicketkeeper. Such was Karthik's great natural ability - which he didn't maximise, he will acknowledge - that in the Dhoni era, India fielded him as a full-fledged opener overseas, and with no little success. Alongside Wasim Jaffer, Karthik formed an excellent opening combine in Bangladesh and England in 2007, bringing up his only Test ton across the border and bettering that effort by emerging as India's highest scorer in England, when they last won a Test series there by a slender 1-0 margin.

Karthik played his last eight Tests down the order, sometimes when Dhoni wasn't available (including through retirement) and he donned the big gloves, and at others when he played alongside the Jharkhandi as a pure batter. Just one half-century in his last 14 Test innings meant he played the last of his 26 Tests in August 2018; his Test average of 25 was decidedly underwhelming, given his supreme gift as a batter, but that can happen when one is overeager and anxious to not just justify their selection but also state their case for a longer rope.

India now have a profusion of excellent wicketkeeper-batters across formats - Rishabh Pant, of course, tops that chart, especially when it comes to the red-ball variant, but there are a host of others that can't be ignored. Among them are Sanju Samson and Ishan Kishan, exclusive when it comes to the white-ball version. And Dhruv Jurel, the 25-year-old from Agra whose first Test cap came as a wicketkeeper against England in Rajkot in February 2024 when Pant was out after his horrific road accident of 14 months previously and KS Bharat had played himself out of the XI with poor efforts in the first two Tests in Hyderabad and Visakhapatnam respectively.

The generational talent that Pant is, he kept almost exclusively from the time he made his Test debut in Nottingham in August 2018 and made a stunning 114 in his third appearance at the Oval till his single-car accident in December 2022

Jurel — a blend of versatility and fortitude

The decision-makers continued to invest their belief in him and the batter has responded in style.

Towards the end of June, he was a part of the India 'A' squad that travelled on the 'shadow' tour of Sri Lanka for two unofficial 'Tests'



AP

when India were suddenly forced to scramble for a replacement. Bharat, from Andhra, won the early nod for the home Tests against Australia in February 2023 and donned the big gloves in the final of the World Test Championship against the same opponents that June. KL Rahul was nominated the first-choice stumper for the two Tests in South Africa towards the end of the year, more to provide stability and class to the lower order in a line-up from which very few had played in South Africa previously. Bharat reclaimed his spot behind the sticks against England at home and played himself out of the XI following scores of 41, 28, 17 and 6 which meant that in seven Tests and 12 innings, he only averaged 20.09, a definite no-no given that the wicketkeeper's was no longer a single-discipline specialised slot.

Out went the call to Jurel for the third Test in Rajkot with the series finely poised at 1-1, and it was immediately apparent that India had hit upon a gold mine. The right-hander made a poised 46 on debut, and upped the ante in the next match with scores of 90 and 39 not out, the first ensuring that India didn't end up conceding a massive lead and the second taking them home in a tense run-chase when he and Shubman Gill put on 72 for the unfinished sixth-wicket stand.

This was in February 2024, when one wasn't sure when Pant would be available for selection though in a characteristic show of gumption and guts, the stocky left-hander was far ahead of the timelines the doctors had tentatively outlined for a possible comeback to competitive cricket. Pant was ready for international cricket in September that year, making a remarkable recovery from a series of potentially life-threatening injuries to smash 109 on his comeback Test in Chennai against Bangladesh. Suddenly, Jurel faced an uncertain future. Despite an impressive start to his Test career, he had to bow before the irrepressible force that Pant was, though it was always on the cards that he could slot in alongside Pant, if not necessarily ahead of him.

In six of his last nine Tests, Jurel has occupied a specialist batter's position between No. 4 and No. 8 (and that only

because Akash Deep was employed as a nightwatchman at the Oval last August). On the three occasions when was the designated wicketkeeper, Pant was unavailable through injury after breaking his right foot in the Manchester Test against England in July last year. Despite the vast array of batting riches at India's disposal, head coach Gautam Gambhir has identified in Jurel a dependable batting option, and the man from Uttar Pradesh has comprehensively justified that faith with two hundreds and a fifty in those nine Tests and 15 innings.

Jurel's coming-of-age moment, if it can be called that, transpired in Ahmedabad last October with Pant still to recover from the broken foot. In India's only innings against West Indies, he uncorked an excellent 125, then followed it up with 44 in the next Test in Delhi. With Pant returning to action against South Africa in November, Jurel continued on as a batter alone though like the rest of his colleagues, he had a series to forget with outings of 14, 13, 0 and 2 in a disastrous 0-2 result that has comprehensively dented India's hopes of making a third WTC final in four cycles.

But instead of pressing the panic button and looking elsewhere, the decision-makers continued to invest their belief in him and Jurel has responded in style. Towards the end of June, he was a part of the India 'A' squad that travelled on the 'shadow' tour of Sri Lanka for two unofficial 'Tests', ostensibly at the insistence of Gambhir because of his felicity against the turning ball. Jurel warmed up nicely for the Test series to follow with scores of 141 not out, 14 and 53, and it was no surprise that he was picked for the first Test in Galle, when he weighed in with 51 and 7 in a winning cause.

In Colombo last week, Jurel went one better with an unbeaten 115 during which he brought his technical expertise and his mental fortitude into play. He also kept wickets for a while when Pant was recovering from a blow to his right shoulder sustained while batting, and when he went back to the outfield, took a terrific running catch from point to get rid of Lahiru Kumara in Sri Lanka's first

innings. At every stage in every role, he has looked the part, making his presence felt with total commitment and a never-say-die spirit without seeking recourse to the flashy and the flamboyant.

Jurel was chosen for Sri Lanka for his ability to play spin with finesse, and it is hard now to see him being overlooked during the November Test tour of New Zealand where the challenges for batters will be vastly different. At No. 6, behind Pant, he has the technique to tackle the second new ball if that is what he is confronted with. Ravindra Jadeja behind him in the batting order and the possible return of Washington Sundar from injury mean he is a right-handed option around a plethora of left-handers, and while that alone can't be a qualification, he has shown that he can hold his own against bowling of any kind in any conditions.

India are fortunate that in Jurel, they have a three-in-one cricketer with his entire future ahead of him. As a batting average of 40.68 from 12 Tests proves, he is every bit

deserving of the show of confidence. A place in the starting XI in Wellington in November is no more than he deserves; one can rest assured that Jurel will be short on neither preparation nor fire when 'Play' is called at the Basin Reserve.

THE GIST

Jurel's coming-of-age moment, if it can be called that, transpired in Ahmedabad last October with Pant still to recover from the broken foot. In India's only innings against West Indies, he uncorked an excellent 125, then followed it up with 44 in the next Test in Delhi

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GETTY IMAGES

How a star with an extreme magnetic field could prove space is not empty

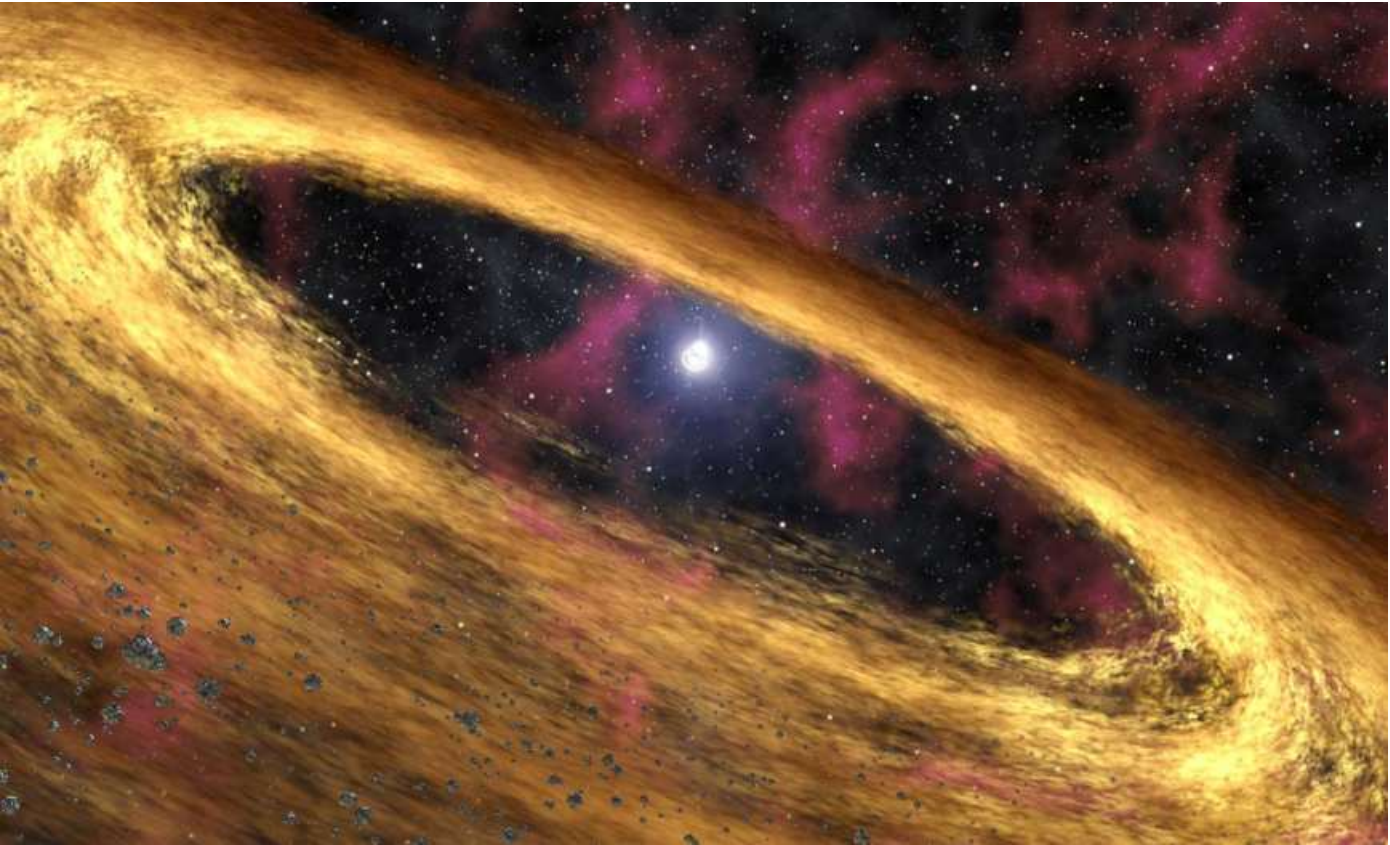
The work could pave the way to show that the ‘nothingness’ of space is actually a complex and active medium, and help scientists refine their maps of the universe

Vasudevan Mukunth

Quantum physics has made numerous strange predictions, and scientists have checked and confirmed many of them. But one of the strangest ones persists unresolved. In the 1930s, the German physicists Werner Heisenberg and Hans Heinrich Euler proposed that empty space is not really empty. Instead, they predicted that in the presence of a magnetic field, the vacuum of space would behave like a crystal, changing the properties of light passing through it. The trouble with testing this prediction – called vacuum birefringence – is that the magnetic field has to be extraordinarily strong. In a study published in *Nature* on August 5, astronomers from Australia, Canada, Japan, South Africa, Taiwan, and the U.S. reported it had observed such birefringence using two satellites and a telescope in Australia, almost confirming the prediction at long last. The work could prove ‘nothingness’ is actually a complex and active medium and also potentially help scientists refine their maps of the universe.

Staggering numbers

In classical physics, a vacuum is absolute nothingness. But in quantum electrodynamics (QED) – which is a theory in quantum physics – a vacuum is a soup of virtual particles: pairs of electrons and anti-electrons that constantly pop in and out of existence, and so quickly that they cannot be observed. Normally, these virtual particles have a negligible effect on light. But when a magnetic field nearby becomes strong enough, it changes how the short-lived charged particles can move, so they respond differently to light depending on the direction in which its electric field is vibrating. This part of space will then behave like a calcite crystal when light passes through it, splitting it into different paths depending on its electric field. (As an electromagnetic wave, light consists of electric and magnetic fields travelling through space.) For vacuum birefringence to become noticeable, the magnetic field has to be around 88 trillion times stronger than the earth’s magnetic field, and more than 500 million times as strong as the ultra-powerful magnets in the world’s largest science experiment, the CERN supercollider. These are staggering numbers far beyond the abilities of current technologies, so physicists have been looking for proof of vacuum birefringence in outer space, where objects called magnetars generate the



An artist's impression of the magnetar 4U 0142+61. In May 2022, the IXPE satellite had hinted at vacuum birefringence around this dead star. NASA

universe’s most extreme magnetic fields. Sometimes the core of a dead star can collapse to form a neutron star. Neutron stars with powerful magnetic fields are called magnetars. **Railroading polarisation** The international team focused its attention on one magnetar named 1E 1547.0-5408, located 14,700 lightyears away. As independent experts Ekaterina Sokolova-Lapa and Joern Wilms wrote in a commentary accompanying the team’s paper, “1E 1547.0-5408 belongs to a rare subclass of magnetars that also emit pulses at radio wavelengths”. By combining X-ray and radio frequency measurements, then, the team could piece together the geometry of the magnetar’s magnetic field. If the vacuum of space were truly empty – as in classical physics – the X-rays from the magnetar would reach the earth with a low degree of polarisation. But the team found the opposite: the NASA Imaging X-ray Polarimetry Explorer (IXPE) satellite in particular detected very high levels of polarisation, up to 80% in some instances, which is the smoking gun of vacuum birefringence. As X-rays leave the magnetar and move through the surrounding space, QED predicts that their electric field will have to lock itself into one of two directions – a condition that unmagnetised space does not impose – thus polarising the light.

Since these directions are defined by the direction of the magnetic field, the X-rays’ polarisation is effectively railroaded along the magnetic field lines. And as the X-rays travel away from the magnetar, their polarisation will stay fixed even as the magnetic field becomes less and less able to ‘hold on’. According to the team, the amount of polarisation dropped as the energy of the X-rays increased, which QED predicts as well. The team was also able to elucidate that the magnetar rotated along an axis that aligned almost perfectly with its magnetic poles, like a top spinning upright – a detail that informed the team’s models of how the X-rays from the magnetar would look with and without vacuum birefringence. The models that did not account for the phenomenon fit substantially worse with the telescope data than those that included it. **Direct observation** Other than IXPE, the team had also used the Neutron Star Interior Composition Explorer instrument onboard the International Space Station and the Murriyang radio telescope in Australia. The finding takes a big step towards bolstering space’s character as a complex medium that both gravity and magnetism can manipulate. On a final note, the team wrote in its paper that its next goal is “to more

directly probe the nature of the ... polarisation”. And this, the commentary noted, requires “coordinated astronomical campaigns that observe multiple magnetars and cover a wider part of the electromagnetic spectrum”. The current finding is indirect because the astronomers recorded polarised light and inferred from that that it had passed through extremely magnetised space. **Not yet proven** As Sokolova-Lapa and Wilms put it, the high polarisation reported in the study only proves vacuum birefringence if the team’s model of the magnetar’s geometry is correct. If, instead, its axis of rotation and magnetic poles are further apart, the X-rays could have been polarised by plasma on the magnetar’s surface. A paper published in *The Astrophysical Journal* by researchers from Italy, Spain, and the U.K. has already raised doubts about the alignment. Physicists are also interested in the vacuum resonance: a distinctive dip in the polarisation – from one of the two allowed directions to the other – at a specific energy level. The international team itself reported a dip but said it was too noisy to be dispositive. But one way or another, the dark voids between the stars we see when we look up are far from dead, buzzing with activity. (mukunth.v@thehindu.co.in)

THE GIST

▼ In the presence of strong magnetic fields, a phenomenon called vacuum birefringence can make the vacuum of space behave like a crystal and polarise light passing through it. ▼ Using NASA’s IXPE satellite, NICER instrument, and Australia’s Murriyang radio telescope, researchers observed highly polarised X-rays from magnetar 1E 1547.0-5408, matching predictions made by quantum electrodynamics (QED). ▼ The evidence depends on models of the magnetar’s geometry, and some scientists suggest the observed polarisation could instead be caused by plasma near the star; further observations of more magnetars are needed for a direct confirmation.

BIG SHOT



A worker at a robusta coffee bean plantation in Sao Gabriel da Palha, Brazil. A new study has challenged the widely held belief that robusta coffee is more resilient to climate change than other varieties, with its lead author in an interview calling it an ‘Internet myth’ based on flawed research that overlooked the crop’s drought intolerance and other vulnerabilities. REUTERS

WHAT IS IT?

Nancy Grace Roman Telescope



A computer generated model of the Nancy Grace Roman Telescope. NASA

Reuters

NASA is preparing to launch its next flagship space observatory — one scientists plan to use to investigate some of the universe’s biggest mysteries, including dark energy and dark matter, while also testing gravity at vast scales and hunting for planets beyond our solar system. The Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope is a roughly \$4-billion project. At the time of writing, it was planned for a Sunday launch from the NASA Kennedy Space Center in Florida. The observatory will be lofted into orbit aboard a SpaceX Falcon Heavy rocket. The telescope is named after the late Nancy Grace Roman, NASA’s first chief astronomer. It is a follow-on to the Hubble Space Telescope, launched in 1990, and the James Webb Space Telescope, launched in 2021, and has capabilities that can expand on the knowledge gained by those pioneering observatories, both of which also still operate. The telescope’s

main survey will take more than a year, per Roman’s senior project scientist Julie McEnery. “The survey will contain over two billion galaxies and enable us to study how the structures in our universe — the stars, the galaxies, the clusters of galaxies — grew and evolved. We’ll also measure how our universe has expanded over time,” she said. After launch and separation from the rocket, the telescope will travel towards a location called Lagrange point 2, about 1.6 million km from the earth. Webb also resides at this location. U.S. President Donald Trump tried during both his first and second terms to reduce or eliminate funding for Roman but the Congress preserved it.



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